MARKETING FRAMEWORKS EXPLAINED



Business Explained

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“Marketing is a race without a finishing line.”

Philip Kotler

Business Explained

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INTRODUCTION TO MARKETING STRATEGIES

DEFINITION OF MARKETING

You must clearly understand what marketing is and isn't before we can get into the specifics of marketing strategy. All business activities to attract customers and sustain relationships fall under marketing as a discipline. Writing thank you notes, playing golf with prospective clients, promptly returning calls and emails, scheduling coffee or dinner meetings with clients and networking with potential or past clients are all examples of activities that can be included in the task.

At its basic level, marketing aims to match a business's goods and services with potential clients. Profitability is eventually ensured by matching products to customers' needs. "Marketing management" is defined by marketing gurus Philip Kotler and Kevin Lane Keller as "the process of selecting target markets and acquiring, retaining, and expanding the customer base through the creation, dissemination, and communication of superior customer value".

According to them, marketing is about determining and addressing societal and human demands. When eBay noticed that some of the things customers wanted most couldn't be found, it developed an online auction clearinghouse, which is one of the simplest good definitions of marketing: "meeting needs profitably." IKEA started making knockdown furniture after realizing that consumer desired high-quality furniture at significantly lower costs. These two businesses proved marketing savvy by converting a personal or social need into a lucrative economic opportunity.

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WHAT MARKETING ISN'T

Marketing is more than advertising, public relations, or creating a website or email campaign. It also involves all preparation work done in advance to help your customers and sales team. Ideally, it should drive your entire company, guiding your product development and distribution strategies.

WHAT EXACTLY IS MARKETING STRATEGY?

Let's define what we mean when we say "marketing strategy." Numerous definitions are frequently used for this seemingly simple term, so it is best to describe how this book defines it. Marketing strategy is a process that defines how firms and organizations understand their markets and how they influence the action of profitable consumers.

That seems sufficient, doesn't it? To put it another way and to keep things straightforward, marketing strategy is all about:

- Recognising the customers for your goods and services.
- Being aware of your strategy to inspire them to make a profit.
- Recognising similar efforts being made by your competitors.
- Knowing how you'll evaluate your marketing efforts and modify your strategy in the future.

The goal of a company's marketing plan is to reach and convince potential customers to buy its goods and services. The following are parts of a marketing strategy:

- **Research:** Examining target markets, rivalry, pricing triggers, consumer purchasing patterns, and more.
- **Positioning:** Differentiation in value promises, packaging design, conversion message, and other areas.

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- **Promotion:** The marketing of goods and services using connections, content, and experiences to persuade customers to take profitable actions.

- **Measurement:** demonstrating value, learning from success and failure, and iterating future work to meet marketing objectives.

Let’s examine a few more definitions of marketing strategy from professionals in the field.

Creating, conveying, and financially delivering value to a target market are the three pillars of a successful marketing strategy, according to Philip Kotler, co-author of the textbook Marketing Management. Kotler continues, “Product management is the process of generating value. You must also communicate this value, that is, brand management. Finally, this value must be provided to the customer, commonly called Customer management. Therefore, you are involved in three businesses: customer management, brand management, and product management.

According to Omer Farkash, CEO of Mayple and a marketing expert, a marketing strategy is a long-term, forward-looking approach and an overall game plan of any organization or business with the primary objective of attaining a sustainable competitive advantage by understanding customers’ needs and desires. On the other hand, content strategist Adam Barone defines marketing strategy as “the comprehensive method by which a business attracts potential clients and converts them into customers.”

The marketing strategy should include the company’s value proposition, core brand statements, and demographic information about the intended audience. Finally, Sumo’s creator Noah Kagan thinks that the question “Do you have a product or service that people want?” should be at the centre of any marketing approach. Without that, all else is irrelevant.

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IMPORTANCE OF MARKETING STRATEGY

It is crucial to have a marketing plan for your company since it enables marketers to:

- Develop an understanding of the target market, demand, and competitive differentiation that will help make product development investments viable.

- Give your business a competitive edge by arming it with information on the factors that drive consumer choices so that you can improve product positioning.

- Create a framework for marketing departments' success by identifying marketing objectives, lead and lag indicators, and areas where marketers should concentrate their efforts.

An effective and perfect marketing strategy will:

- Align your team behind a set of goals.

- Assist you in relating your efforts to the objectives of your business.

- Use distinctive value propositions to set your products apart from the competitors.

- Make it possible to discover and test what resonates with your audience.

- Encourage your team to demonstrate the value it brings to the company.

WHY DO YOU NEED A MARKETING STRATEGY?

You might believe that your business isn't an international contender. Realistically, most businesses won't or don't need to enter the Fortune 500, but even the greatest brands in the world still need to consider strategy. You might not even desire to attain that level of growth.

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That doesn’t mean you shouldn’t concentrate on strategy and make a serious investment in it. If you have customers to satisfy, you must plan strategically so that your execution—all those fun, creative aspects that drew you to the business first—influence the right people and yields the desired outcomes.

Coordination is essential to avoiding conflict and maximizing your revenues because one element of a marketing strategy affects all the others. A marketing strategy considers every facet of your selling initiatives and ensures that each supports the others while keeping your departments informed of what each is up to. You’ll be able to choose more wisely as an individual regarding particular marketing methods if you know how to develop an integrated marketing strategy.

MAKES PRODUCT DEVELOPMENT MORE EFFICIENT

A marketing strategy assists you in developing products and services with the most profit potential. This is so that marketing strategy can begin with market research, which considers your ideal target customer, what your competitors are doing, and potential future trends. You may use this data to work out the benefits customers, and customers are looking for, how much they are ready to spend, and how you can set your offering apart from the competitors.

ASSISTS IN DETERMINING OPTIMAL PRICES

Pricing your product or service appropriately is a crucial component of any marketing strategy. You could choose to adjust your rates if your market research shows that people are willing to pay more for a superior product in your category. If your target market is price-conscious and prepared to settle for a basic offering in exchange for a lower price, it can be required to sell at or below the price of the competition.

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ENABLES EFFECTIVE DISTRIBUTION

Once you know what product attributes you'll offer, your target consumer, and your price points, you may decide where you want to sell to maximize your marketing efficiency. New clients are more likely to shop online or with a smartphone, and they will most likely pay with PayPal or a credit card. Older clients may prefer to shop at retail establishments. If your market research suggests that you need to be in retail stores but lack a sales force, you can employ a wholesaler or distributor.

SUPPORTS MARKETING COMMUNICATIONS

Your market research will support your brand or the picture you want to present about your business. Without performing market research and creating an all-encompassing marketing plan, you run the risk of responding to one-off, reactive demands from advertising salespeople with messaging at odds with the brand identity you have worked so hard to create via product development. You can determine whether a particular magazine, radio station, or website meets your selling objectives by using a marketing plan.

IMPACT ON ORGANISATIONS AND COMMUNICATION

Your departments can collaborate more effectively when you have a marketing strategy because they are all following the same blueprint. For instance, your advertising team will consult with your product development team to decide what message you should deliver about your benefit. Your sales representatives will consult with those in charge of maintaining your brand's image to ascertain whether they may provide rebates, discounts, or coupons without endangering it.

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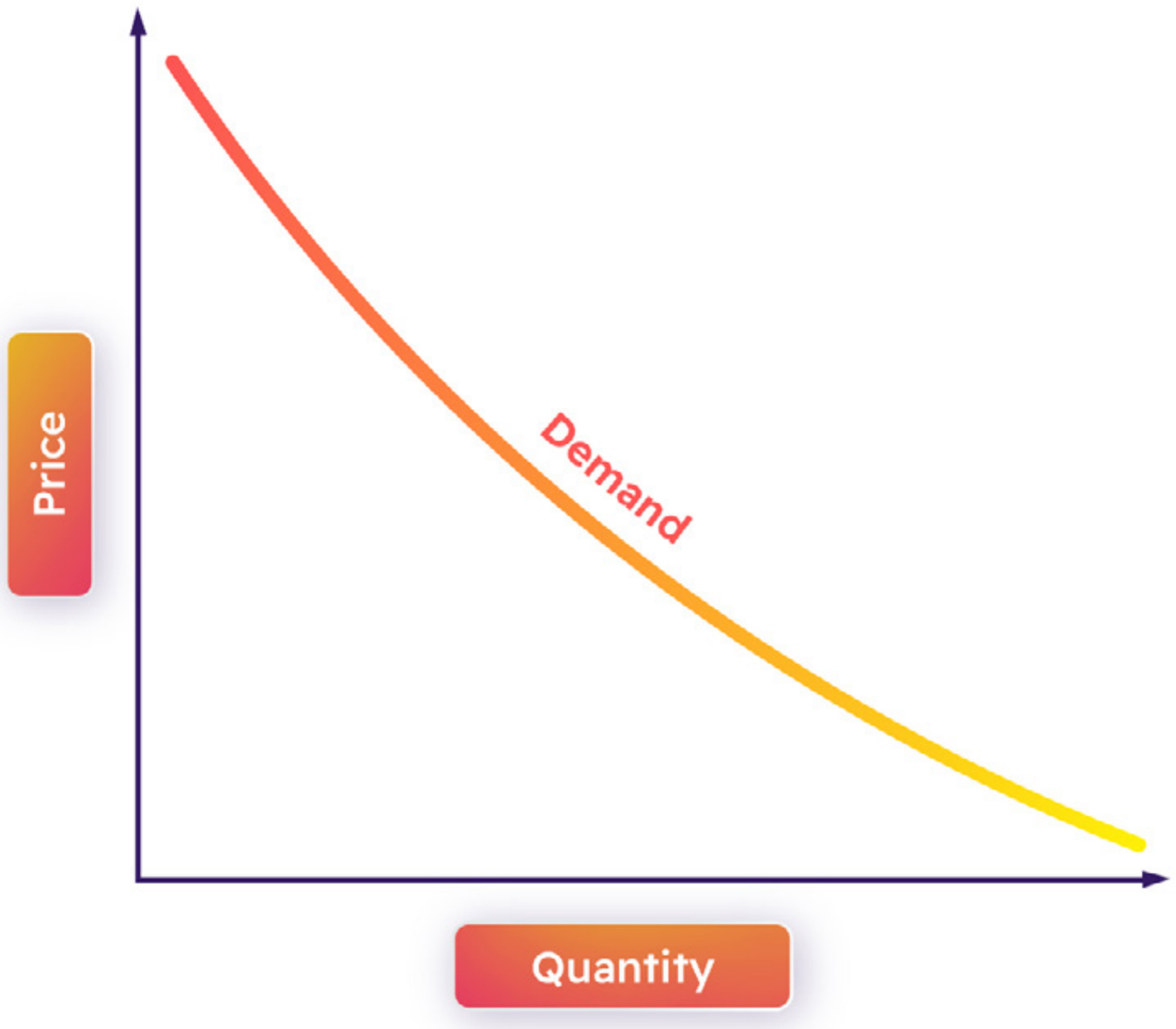
UNDERSTANDING MARKETING BASICS

SUPPLY AND DEMAND

The most basic principles of economics are supply and demand. Whether you work in academia, agriculture, pharmaceutical, or manufacturing or are just a consumer, you incorporate the fundamental idea of supply and demand equilibrium into your daily activities. The most challenging facets of economics can only be learned after mastering the fundamentals of these models.

EXPLAINING DEMAND

Although most explanations usually start by discussing the idea of supply, comprehending demand is often easier for people to understand and aids in the subsequent descriptions.



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One of the most significant distinctions between the supply and demand curves is the relationship between a good's price and demand from the consumer's perspective. Demand graphs are depicted from the consumer's perspective, as opposed to supply graphs, created from the producer's perspective.

Demand declines as a product's price rises except for a few rare circumstances. For the sake of this discussion, assume that the product in question is a television set. Many consumers will buy TVs frequently if sold for the low price of $5 each. Most people would even purchase more TVs than they need, placing one in each room and potentially some in storage.

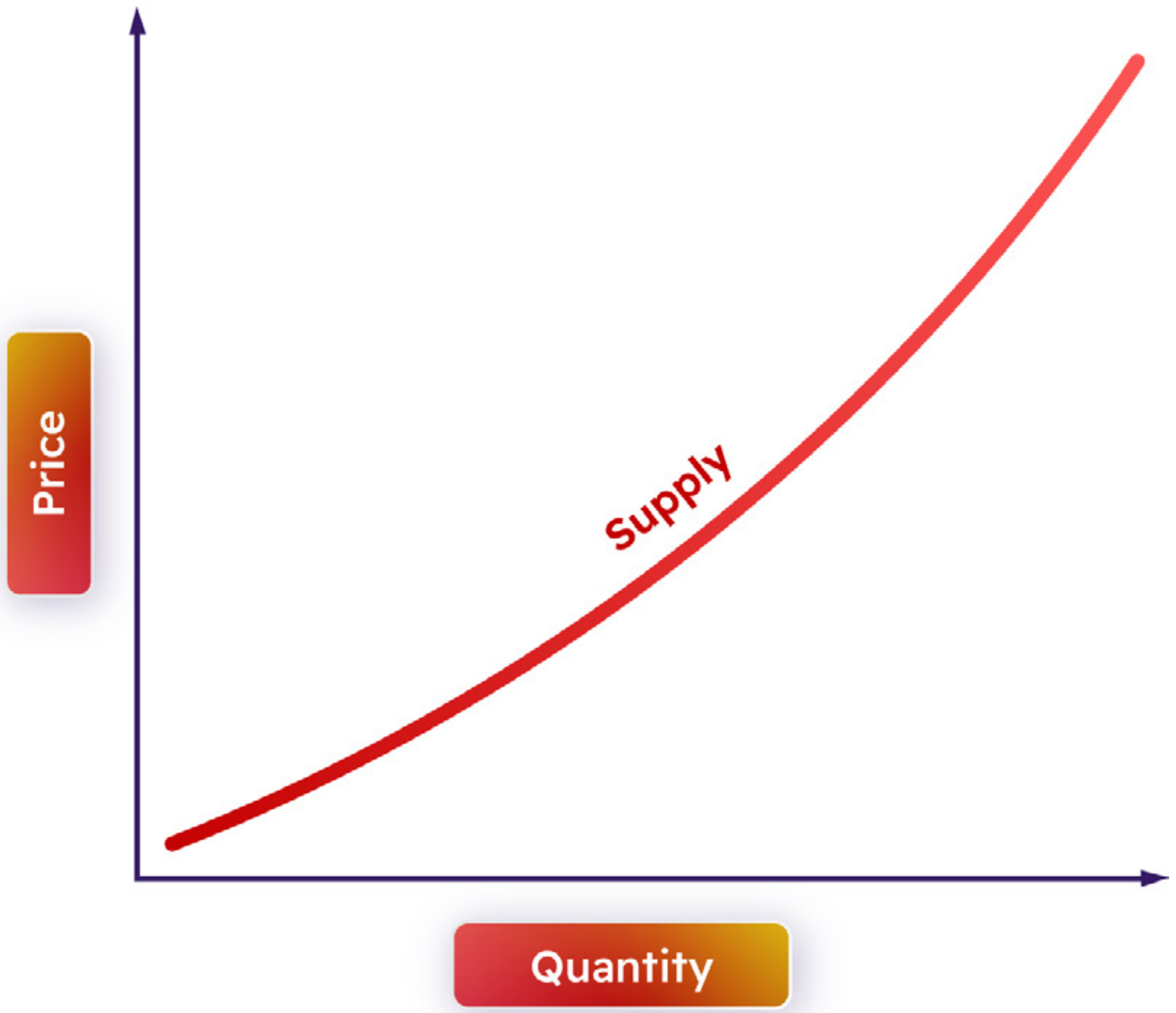
Because of the widespread accessibility of affordable televisions, demand for these goods is expected to remain high. However, if the price of a television is $50,000, then only the wealthy can afford it and it becomes a luxury item. The demand for televisions would be quite low even if the majority of people still wanted to buy them.

Of course, the instances above don't occur in real life. A simple demand model assumes numerous criteria. First, there is no product differentiation—just one kind of product sold at a single price to every consumer. Second, although having a TV offers a certain level of value, it is unnecessary in this closed scenario as it is a basic demand rather than a basic human need like food consumption. Third, there is no substitute for the product, and customers anticipate steady prices going forward.

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EXPLAINING SUPPLY

Similarly, the supply curve examines the relationship between a product's price and supply from the standpoint of the manufacturer rather than the consumer.



Producers are willing to create more of a product as prices rise to make more money. Likewise, output is negatively impacted by dropping prices since producers may not be able to recoup their input costs from sales of the finished product. Returning to the example of the television, if the input costs to make a TV are fixed at $50 plus the variable labor cost, production would become wildly unprofitable as soon as the TV's selling price falls below $50.

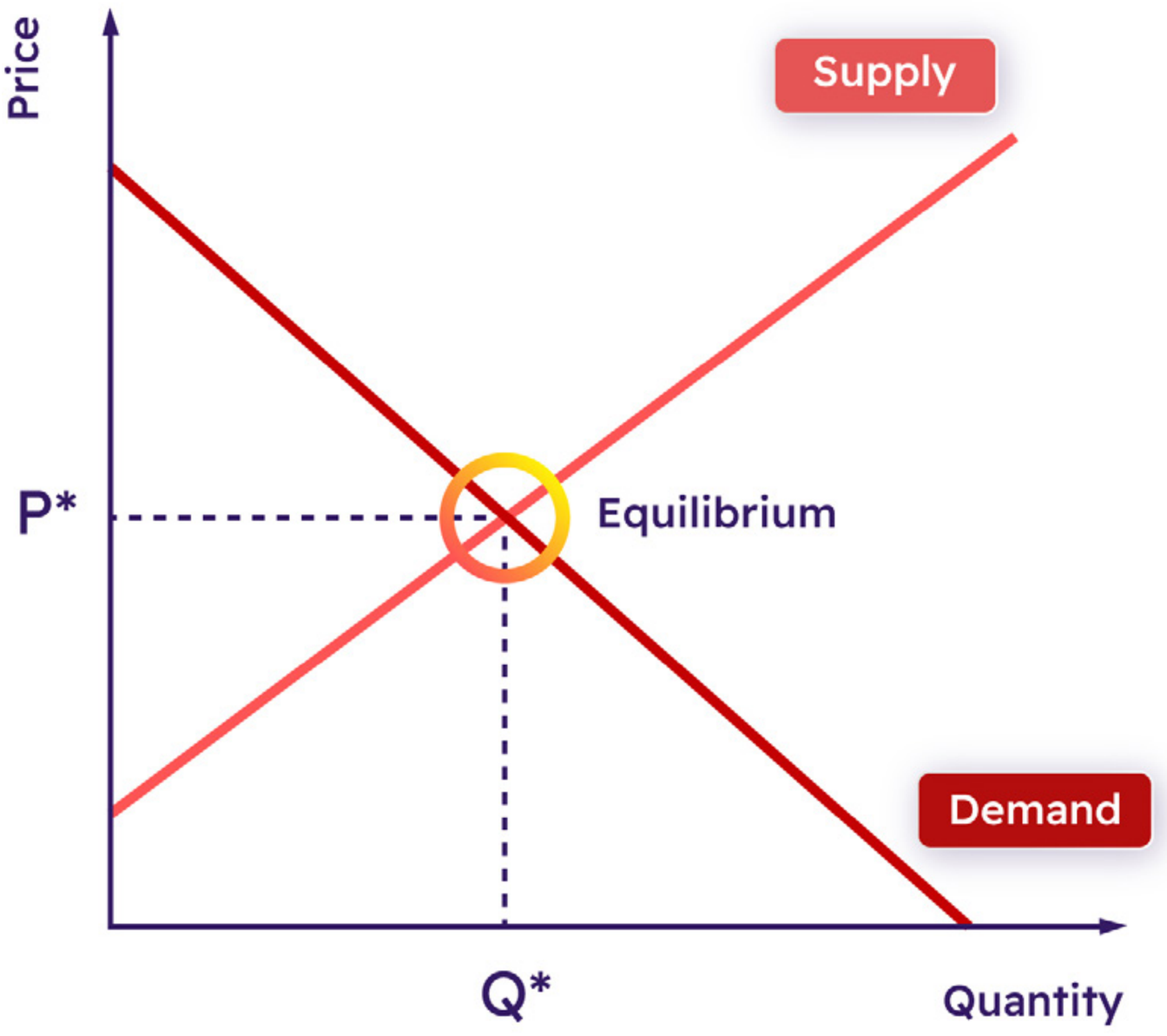
However, manufacturers are urged to work more to raise their profits when prices are higher. For instance, if televisions cost $1,000, producers could concentrate on making televisions in addition to other potential businesses. The makers would profit and be incentivized to create more TVs if all other factors remained constant, but the selling price of the TV was raised to $50,000. The supply curve must be upward-sloping because of the behavior to seek maximum profits.

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The producer acting as a price taker is a fundamental presumption of the theory. This input does not dictate product prices; the market sets them. Suppliers must simply decide how much to produce, given the market price. Optimal outcomes are not always the case, for example, in monopolistic markets. This is similar to the demand curve.

FINDING AN EQUILIBRIUM

Consumers usually hunt for the best deal, but manufacturers are only urged to boost outputs at greater costs. Naturally, “zero dollars” would be the ideal price a consumer would pay for a good, but such a phenomenon is impractical because producers could not continue to operate.



Producers should aim to maximize the price at which their goods are sold. Consumers will, however, alter their preferences and stop buying the goods if prices become too high. It is important to strike the right balance so both sides can conduct continued commercial dealings that benefit customers and producers. (Theoretically, the ideal price where producers and consumers achieve the maximum level of combined utility occurs at the price where the supply and demand lines intersect. Deviations from this point cause an overall economic cost, generally known as a deadweight loss.

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THEORY OR LAW?

The principles of supply and demand are very effective in predicting market behavior, but many other factors affect markets on both a microeconomic and a macroeconomic level. Supply and demand heavily guide market behavior but do not outright determine it. The law of supply and demand is an economic theory popularised by Adam Smith in 1776.

One way to look at the laws of supply and demand is as a guide. Even though they are only two factors that affect market conditions, they are very important. Adam Smith called them the “invisible hand” that guides a free market. However, if the economy is not a free market, supply and demand don’t have as much effect. In socialist economic systems, the government usually sets commodity prices regardless of supply and demand.

This causes problems because the government cannot always control supply or demand, as evidenced by Venezuela’s food shortages and high inflation rates in 2010. The country attempted to take over the food supply from private vendors and establish price controls but suffered crippling shortages and accusations of corruption.

Although the current economy is more global than before and macroeconomic forces can be challenging to predict, the principles of supply and demand have been repeatedly demonstrated over centuries of various market conditions. Supply and demand are useful indicators but not precise predictors.

In conclusion, advanced micro and macroeconomics theories frequently adjust the assumptions and appearance of the supply and demand curve to properly illustrate ideas like economic surplus, monetary policy, externalities, aggregate supply, fiscal stimulation, elasticity, and shortfalls. Before examining those more complex issues, the theory of supply and demand must first be understood.

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MARKET RESEARCH

Market research is the practice of gauging the potential success of a service or product by talking to potential users. With market research, a business may zero in on its ideal customer's opinion and gauge interest in its products and services.

The study might be done internally or contracted out to a firm with expertise in the field. Methods such as questionnaires, prototypes, in-depth interviews, and focus groups are all useful. Experiment participants are typically offered free final product samples or a small financial reward.
Market research is an essential part of the research and development (R&D) process when introducing a new product or service.

UNDERSTANDING MARKET RESEARCH

The success of a new product or service can be gauged with the help of market research. The findings could lead to changes in the product's design and a tweaked approach to releasing it to the public.

Included in this category is data used for classifying potential target markets. It also helps with product distinction, which is essential for targeted marketing.

Businesses largely rely on market research to understand their target market, develop products that appeal to them, and stay one step ahead of the competition. Various activities are involved in market research, and the product's intended market segment guides the data collection process. This data is then analyzed to conclude the product's ideal design and marketing strategy for the target market.

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Market research typically consists of a combination of the following:

- Primary research conducted either in-house or through contracted research firms,

- “Secondary research,” in which information is gathered from outside sources

PRIMARY MARKET RESEARCH

There are two main types of primary research: exploratory and specific.

Exploratory research is less formal and is driven by free-form inquiries. Focus groups, phone interviews, and questionnaires are all viable options for administering the questions. As a result, the corporation faces inquiries and concerns regarding a product it is working on.

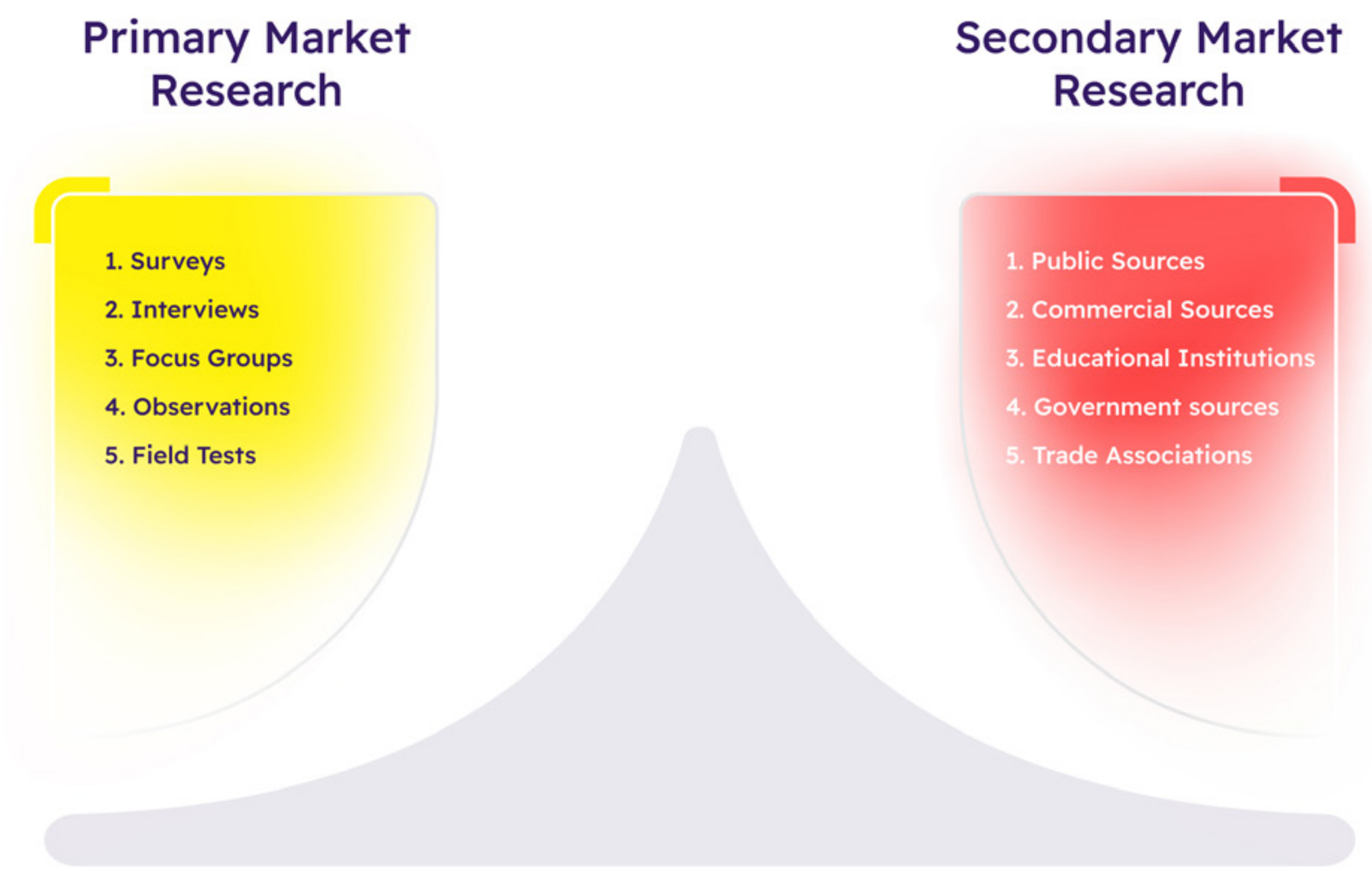
Subsequently, specific research is conducted to look more thoroughly into the difficulties or challenges uncovered by exploratory research.

SECONDARY MARKET RESEARCH

The results of previous studies on customer requirements serve as a foundation for all subsequent studies in the market. Much of this kind of study can now be done via the Internet.

Secondary research can include population statistics from government census data, trade organization research reports, polling results, and research from other enterprises in the same market sector.

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Many companies turn to market research to determine consumer interest in new products or to find out what kinds of products and services customers would like but can't currently get. A business contemplating launching might, for instance, commission market studies to determine the potential success of its product or service. If the study results show that consumers are interested, the company may confidently move forward. If not, the corporation can use the information from market research to revise the product to better suit consumer needs.

TYPES OF MARKET RESEARCH

1. FACE-TO-FACE INTERVIEWS

Since their inception, market research firms have routinely polled members of the general public by asking them questions about the newspapers and magazines they read regularly and whether they remembered seeing any particular advertisements or recognizing any particular brands within those publications. The efficacy of the ads was calculated by comparing interview data with the publication's readership. These early methods served as a basis for modern market research and surveying. While developing a solid understanding of your market, it's important to take demand, market size, economic indicators, geography, market saturation, and price into account.

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2. FOCUS GROUPS

Focus groups are groups of people selected to represent the target audience and given samples of a product or shown advertisements before being polled on their impressions of the product, the brand, and the competition.

3. PHONE RESEARCH

Telephone interviews quickly replaced man-on-the-street methods. Information could be gathered more quickly and cheaply using a telephone interviewer. For a long time, market researchers' go-to method was conducting surveys by telephone. As landline phone service declines and less accessible mobile phones become the norm, this has grown considerably more challenging in recent years.

4. SURVEY RESEARCH

Instead of holding expensive in-person focus groups, companies can save money by conducting surveys to gauge customer sentiment. Incentives such as coupons and vouchers are often included in consumer mail-in surveys. Customer satisfaction, brand loyalty, and pricing can all be better understood through these polls.

5. ONLINE MARKET RESEARCH

As more and more people move their lives online, market researchers have followed suit. A survey is still the primary method of data collection. People can sign up for surveys and focus groups at their convenience rather than being actively sought out by firms through cold calling or encountering them on the street.

Since people can take part on their own time and at their own will, the procedure is much less intrusive and less rushed.

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HOW TO DO MARKET RESEARCH?

Establishing study objectives is the first stage in doing fruitful market research. Each study needs to focus on answering a specific question. A business may conduct market research to learn about its customers' likes and dislikes, the extent to which its brand is known, or the relative success of various advertising efforts.

The next stage is to choose the participants in the study. Due to the high cost of conducting market research, businesses must avoid collecting information that is not directly relevant to their operations. The company needs to define how the data will be collected and what kinds of customers will be included in the study. The possibility of statistical mistakes or sample bias should also be considered.

The following phase entails information gathering and analysis. This should be easy if the first two steps are carried out correctly. The researchers will tally the responses to their survey, making note of each participant's age, gender, and any other pertinent information. This data is then used to create a marketing report detailing their findings.

The final phase is for company executives to act on the information gleaned through market research. Research findings could lead to a shift in focus, resulting in a new price point or an altered set of features for the product.

Additional market research may be conducted to evaluate the impact of these adjustments, and the cycle may then repeat.

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BENEFITS OF MARKET RESEARCH

Customer happiness and brand loyalty can’t be built without conducting market research. While it’s unrealistic to expect universal product acceptance, good market research may pinpoint the target audience and market for every product.

Advertising campaigns can also benefit greatly from thorough market research. For instance, if a business finds out that its customers are more active on Facebook than on Twitter, it can tailor its marketing efforts accordingly. The market could be more concerned with value than price, so the company should focus on improving the product rather than lowering its price.

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BASICS FOR THE SEGMENTATION OF INDUSTRIAL MARKET

When selling and promoting your industrial company's goods and services, have you ever considered why market segmentation is so important? Do you know how segmenting the industrial market helps with digital marketing? This section addresses these concerns by illuminating the various subsets that make up the industrial market.

DEFINITION AND FOUNDATIONS OF INDUSTRIAL MARKET SEGMENTATION

Market segmentation is a method for segmenting the many possible buyers in a business-to-business (B2B) or industrial market. It's useful for determining how to approach selling and marketing specific industrial products or services to a specific demographic. Industrial market segmentation is more difficult and sophisticated than customer market segmentation due to the intricacy of industrial products/ services and purchasing procedures.

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Market Segmentation Types

- Industry Type
- Geographic
- Business Operations
- Consumption Rate or Size
- Ownership
- Purchasing Methods
- Methods of Payment
- Ordering Time or Frequency
- Legal Aspects

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The following are examples of segmentation criteria commonly used in the industrial market:

1. INDUSTRY TYPE

Many distinct industrial marketplaces exist for business-to-business goods and services. Industry expertise grants a more well-rounded comprehension of buyer requirements and perspectives. For example, businesses that sell paper, office supplies, computers designed for businesses, and financial services target various sectors in their advertising. For these products and services, market segmentation based on the industry is critical. For instance, while hospitals and retail shops have similar computing requirements, hospitals' customers differ greatly from shops'.

Marketers may want to categorize businesses further. While commercial banking, insurance, stock trading, and savings and loan associations are all part of the financial services sector, they operate in different ways.

Selling computers to the financial services industry requires a more nuanced segmentation system due to the industry's distinct product and service requirements, such as specialized peripherals and terminals, data handling, and software requirements.

2. GEOGRAPHIC

The business-to-business market is broken down into subsets based on location. Buyers, marketplaces, and geographic locations are all possible dividing criteria. Decisions about the placement and structure of sales teams must consider geography. For example, a company that makes heavy-duty pumps for the petrochemical sector might focus its marketing efforts on the Gulf Coast, where there is a higher concentration of potential consumers, and less on New England, with fewer potential buyers. When selling products with low value-per-unit weight or volume (like corrugated boxes or prestressed concrete) or providing individualized service (like in a job shop printing situation), proximity to the customer is crucial to the business's success.

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These demographic factors are readily available to a marketer, as said. Both industry-specific and generic directories facilitate building customer lists that are specific in terms of industry, company size, and geographic location. Lots of population information can be found in government records, market research firm reports, and the publications of professional and trade groups.

Many businesses use only demographic information in their segmentation strategy for industrial marketing. While demographic information can be a great starting point for a segmentation strategy, it is far from exhaustive. In many cases, they are just the first step.

3. BUSINESS OPERATIONS

Markets in the industrial sector are also segmented according to the many functions that factories fulfill. Manufacturing facilities engage in a wide variety of tasks. Their activities, operations, and necessities are all unique. Production, assembly, distribution, retail, advice-giving, and so on are all included. Based on this metric, we may divide businesses into numerous categories: manufacturers, assemblers, processors, distributors, retailers, and service providers.

Several goods have widespread applications in the business world. Businesses involved with these items can sell to a wide variety of buyers. Because of the unique behavior patterns of these consumers, a tailored marketing approach is required.

4. CONSUMPTION RATE OR SIZE

Industries are categorized as large, medium, or tiny depending on their annual resource use and order volume. One or more specific types of consumers may be chosen as a company’s target market. Pricing and advertising plans must be tailored to specific demographics’ needs.

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5. OWNERSHIP

Ownership causes a dissimilar reaction as it requires special consideration from the company. It's up to the business to decide which customer it will focus on. An individual, a partnership, a corporation, a government agency, or any combination of the above might own companies in the manufacturing sector.

6. PURCHASING METHODS

Tender or sealed bidding, leasing, service contracts, direct purchasing, and agency-approved purchasing are all examples of the types of buying methods used by various areas of the industrial market or customer base. Products are purchased in a variety of ways by businesses.
Different formalities, ordering and execution schedules, profit margins, and general procedures are needed for the various approaches.

7. METHODS OF PAYMENT

Customers can be categorized as either "cash buyers," "credit buyers," "full payment," or "installment payments," depending on how and when they make their purchases. Payment procedures vary across industrial customers. They may be late in paying their bills, or they may not pay them at all. Important divisions Include:

I. Customers Who Pay in Cash
II. Customers Purchasing on Credit
III. Buyers with Partial Credit
IV. Fully Trusted v/s Partially Trusted Buyers
V. Full (at a time) Paying Customers
VI. Customers who pay in installments
VII. Buyers on Short- and Long-Term Credit, etc.

A proper marketing strategy should be developed to address these potential customers. Pricing strategies, in particular, have greater significance for this division.

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8. ORDERING TIME OR FREQUENCY:

Several distinct submarkets can be identified in the industrial market based on the timing of orders and the regularity of purchases.

I. **Annual Customers:**
Once a year, they place a sizable order and acquire all of the best stuff at once.

II. **Regular Customers:**
They exclusively shop for that company. They have shown to be devoted patrons.

III. **Occasional Customers:**
On occasion, they will purchase from the corporation. Customers try the company's items out of curiosity, to make a change, or because they can't get what they need elsewhere.

IV. **Frequent and Infrequent Customers:**
Consumers who shop regularly spend more frequently. They place orders repeatedly and can be counted on in several ways. Buyers who only occasionally shop with us have erratic spending habits. They are tough to forecast and may or may not make a purchase.

9. LEGAL ASPECTS:

Some businesses may use concerns over legality or authenticity as a basis for targeting specific subsets of the market. The government has restricted the company's sales to a select group of agencies. But for various reasons, it must deal (willingly or unwillingly) with consumers who are breaking the law by purchasing, possessing, or using certain items. The company can increase its bottom line by doing business with illegal customers.

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Some businesses, such as those that produce weapons and ammunition for the military or offer goods to government programs for the poor or those in other protected groups, may be enticed to sell their surplus inventory to unapproved buyers. In some cases, businesses must limit output to meet predetermined targets.

There appears to be a significant difference between marketing to legal and illegal consumers, as the former are authorized to use an unlimited amount while the latter are subject to stricter limits. Beyond that sum, they are unable to make any additional purchases. Some products are illegal for illegal customers to purchase, possess, use, or resell.

10. OTHER BASES:

Other minor behavioral factors are also utilized to divide up the business sector.
Among them are examples like:

I. Occasions
II. User status
III. Adherence Pattern,
IV. Gains Anticipated
V. Attitudes, etc.

These factors are crucial for classifying business marketplaces into subsets. Minor factors can also be used to divide up industrial markets. In addition, most of the criteria employed in consumer market segmentation can be similarly applied to industrial market segmentation. It must be made clear that these foundations are too broad and intertwined.

This is a broad categorization, to be sure. Industrial goods might be categorized on one or several bases simultaneously. Companies should prioritize the bases that are most important to them rather than trying to cover all of them.

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INFLUENCE OF INDUSTRIAL MARKET SEGMENTATION ON INDUSTRIAL MARKETING STRATEGIES

You can’t develop an effective industrial marketing strategy for your organization without segmenting the relevant industrial markets. Using market segmentation, you can choose which industries or parts of a market to focus on (targeting and positioning strategies) to determine which customers your industrial firm is most suited to service.

Therefore, you can either develop new items to introduce in existing markets, launch new products into existing markets, or explore new markets with existing products.

In addition to helping you target your products and services to a certain demographic, market segmentation may also be used to develop targeted promotional methods. Your customer’s preferred payment methods and purchasing procedures will also affect your pricing strategies.

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BASICS OF PRODUCT POSITIONING

With rising levels of consumerism comes a proliferation of businesses that aim to meet consumers' demands. Many of these firms offer essentially identical products with similar specifications, but what sets them apart is a unique selling proposition (USP) that allows them to attract a specific demographic at a predetermined price point. This is where strategic market positioning comes into play.

THE MEANING OF "PRODUCT POSITIONING"

Product positioning is a type of differentiation used in marketing to explain to consumers why your product is superior to the competition. This is where you explain what makes your product unique. Simply put, it is how consumers rate one brand relative to others in the same market.



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This advertising method allows the company to zero in on its specific market, monitor its rivals' moves to ensure it maintains its position of differentiation, and select an appropriate promotional approach from the consumers' perspective who will ultimately buy the product.

For instance:

Although both Burger King and McDonald's operate in the fast-food industry, the two chains' marketing strategies have helped them distinguish themselves.

Using this strategy, two competing brands can carve out their own space in the market while still maintaining their identities.

POSITIONING TYPES

This has implications for how the product should be positioned in the market relative to competing goods. Important categories of product positioning include:

1. PRICE

The price heavily influences a customer's decision to buy a product. A product's perceived value to consumers is heavily influenced by factors such as the nature of the product, the customer's specific needs, and the product's effectiveness in meeting those needs.

Luxury items are typically more costly and clearly labeled as such, while necessities are more reasonably priced and adequately functional. Low-priced products are more likely to be chosen by the majority of customers.

2. QUALITY

In some circumstances, the quality and longevity of the items can win out over the price wars. In cases where a product's quality guarantee exceeds the customer's price threshold, the latter can put more of their purchasing power towards acquiring a product with a higher quality ranking on the market.

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The products are all roughly the same price, but customers will choose one based on their satisfaction with its qualities. It is, therefore, not incorrect to suggest that a product is priced lower than its rivals.

3. DIFFERENTIATION

Numerous items on the market fall into the same broad category. Effectively communicating how your product stands out from the competition is a key factor in establishing your product's niche in the market.

Even within the broad category of health drinks for kids, there are many different brands that all make a claim to be the best. According to Complan, children can grow in height. Horlicks markets itself as a beverage that increases children's height, strength, and mental acuity. Bournvita makes a health claim that it aids in calcium absorption because it includes vitamin D.

4. CONVENIENCE

This is a major contributor to winning over loyal customers. Due to the difficulty of modern living, consumers are more likely to choose services that prioritize their comfort and availability.
The new positioning initial for businesses is user-friendly brand mobile applications, online retailers who guarantee product quality, and generous return policies.
Businesses can now join in the competition by creating their virtual destination tailored to the needs of their long-distance customers.

5. CUSTOMER SERVICE

One strategy for positioning a product in the market is to emphasize how easy it is to file and track the status of a complaint. When customers see that the company cares about their problems, they are likelier to choose that company.

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In the service industries, such as hospitality and teaching, having pleasant and productive dialogues with customers can be vital. These businesses flourish when people meet and network for mutual benefit.

6. TARGETED CUSTOMERS

Brands and products need to place themselves among specific demographics of consumers and appeal to them directly. Age, socioeconomic status, level of education, and even one's chosen line of work could all have a role.

To increase the product's visibility and usefulness among the target audience, it might be effective to explain the product's and brand's intended usage in the context of that audience. Different products and brands can be placed in the market through a variety of methods, as was previously indicated. Successful product positioning requires some forethought but can have a significant effect on sales and profits.

ADVANTAGES OF PRODUCT POSITIONING

This tactic is important because it paves the way for future customer segmentation methods, advertising, and other forms of promotion. In addition, there are several reasons why product positioning is such a successful marketing tactic.

1. CREATES COMPETITION

A favorable association with the product's brand can be established in the minds of consumers through strategic product positioning. The result is a more loyal consumer base, which might give you a leg up on the competition.

As a result, this brand equity can inform the development of additional marketing strategies, such as the distribution of free samples and other forms of in-kind support. Keeping up with the competition means always trying new things and watching what must be improved.

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2. BOOSTS REVENUE

When used with other analytic marketing methods, positioning can boost product sales. Giving out appropriate offers, free samples, membership benefits, etc., can aid in retaining the loyal customer base and reaching the market of other customers once the product and brand have reached a loyal customer base.

3. UNDERSTANDING OF CUSTOMER NEEDS

Establishing your brand in a certain niche requires knowing your ideal customers and their wants and demands. Product positioning best practices help businesses tell customers about the many benefits of their wares, including those not explicitly stated.



In addition, this can be utilized to learn which products and product variations are most in demand, allowing for more in-depth consideration of how to best serve the consumer base and keep them as loyal patrons.

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Overall, Brand positioning appears to be everywhere. Xerox replacing the word “photocopy” and Colgate replacing “toothpaste” are two examples of clever brand placement. This helps the company establish a dedicated consumer base and stand out.

While it’s true that position strategies need to be tweaked and updated often, when used properly and with an appreciation for their significance and a modest investment, they can do wonders for a brand’s reputation and market share.

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THE RELATIONSHIP BETWEEN THE COMPANY AND THE MARKET

Understanding the connection between the company and the market it serves is essential in today's rapidly developing business environment. This section delves into the nuanced dynamics to see how firms can best reach their target audience, cement their place in the market, and foster loyal customer connections. Companies may successfully traverse the competitive landscape and set themselves up for growth and profitability if they have a firm grasp of the underlying principles and methods involved.

FINDING YOUR IDEAL CUSTOMERS

A corporation must know its ideal customer in the market before starting a conversation with them. Market research is essential for understanding target audiences' demographics, interests, and buying habits. A company's ideal customer base can be narrowed down by studying demographics, market tendencies, and consumer habits. When businesses have a firm grasp on their target demographic, they are better equipped to reach out to them with marketing messages and products that are more likely to resonate with them.

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CUSTOMER PERSONA CONSTRUCTION

Customers within the larger target market are diverse, each with their features and goals. Creating customer personas is a common practice among successful firms. Customers' demographics, behaviors, interests, and pain areas are fictionally captured in these "personas." By creating in-depth customer personas, businesses may better understand their audience and tailor their messaging and products to meet their customers' varying needs and wants.

MAKING A SELLING POINT

A company's ability to communicate its value to the market is crucial to its success. What sets one company's products and services apart from the competition is known as the value proposition. It emphasizes the positive aspects of doing business with the company and its advantages over rivals. A strong value proposition highlights the benefits to the customer and speaks to their wants and needs. A company can stand out from the competition and win over customers by describing the benefits they provide in detail.

FORMULATING AD CAMPAIGNS

Once a business knows who its target market is and has come up with a unique selling point, it can move on to smart marketing. Finding the best ways to talk to and influence the people you want to reach is a key part of this process. Businesses have to choose the marketing methods (like print ads, press releases, web content, and social media) that will reach their ideal customers the most. A good marketing plan takes into account the specifics of the target market, sets measurable goals, and details the steps and means to reach those goals.

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PROMOTING RECOGNITION AND ACCEPTANCE OF YOUR BRAND

Creating a recognizable brand is important in establishing trust between a firm and its target market. A company's brand is its image and standing in the eyes of its target market. Differentiating your brand from rivals and gaining customers' trust requires a unique brand identity. A company's brand includes its name, logo, visual identity, messaging, and values. Companies can create a loyal customer base by always delivering on their brand's promises and participating in brand-building initiatives.

EVALUATING AND ADAPTING

Companies need to constantly assess and adjust their responses to changes in the market. To adapt to their customer base's shifting wants and demands, businesses must keep an eye on the market, listen to their customers, and keep tabs on the competition. The best marketing plans are the result of consistent monitoring and evaluation that reveals what is working and what may be improved. A company's relationship with the market can be strengthened, and a competitive edge maintained through constant evaluation and adjustment.

In conclusion, effective marketing requires an appreciation of the interplay between a product or service and its target audience. Businesses may connect with their ideal customers by determining who they're trying to reach, coming up with a compelling value proposition, crafting a targeted marketing strategy, and constructing a memorable brand identity.

Furthermore, firms may ensure their continued success and expansion in the face of an ever-shifting market by regularly assessing and revising their strategies.

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THE MARKETING MIX AND THE 7P'S OF MARKETING

The term "marketing" is used to describe the company's comprehensive approach to attracting and keeping customers.

At its core, marketing's purpose is to bring together a company's goods and services with willing buyers. Matching products to consumer needs is crucial to generating a profit. The seven Ps of marketing are people, processes, place, price, and promotion in addition to the product. The 7 Ps of marketing is the foundation of any successful advertising campaign.

How many "Ps" does marketing consist of?

The marketing mix is a time-tested method of promoting and selling a product or service. To set the stage, we can say that a company's "marketing mix" consists of all the different strategies it employs to get the word out about its wares. Product, price, place, and promotion were the traditional cornerstones of this method. But as marketing has evolved, so have the methods used. Later, People, Process, and Physical Evidence were included to make a total of 7Ps of marketing strategy.

Companies actualize the components of the marketing mix to direct marketing decisions at all levels. It helps them with the following:

- Understanding its strengths and working to improve its weaknesses

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- Increased adaptability and viability in the marketplace
- Increasing cooperation between teams and organizations

Identifying your target audience's persona is an essential first step before using the 4Ps or 7Ps of marketing. The specifics of your marketing mix can be determined using knowledge of your target market. You can't do anything at all until you have it.

7PS OF MARKETING - UNDERSTANDING THE CONCEPT

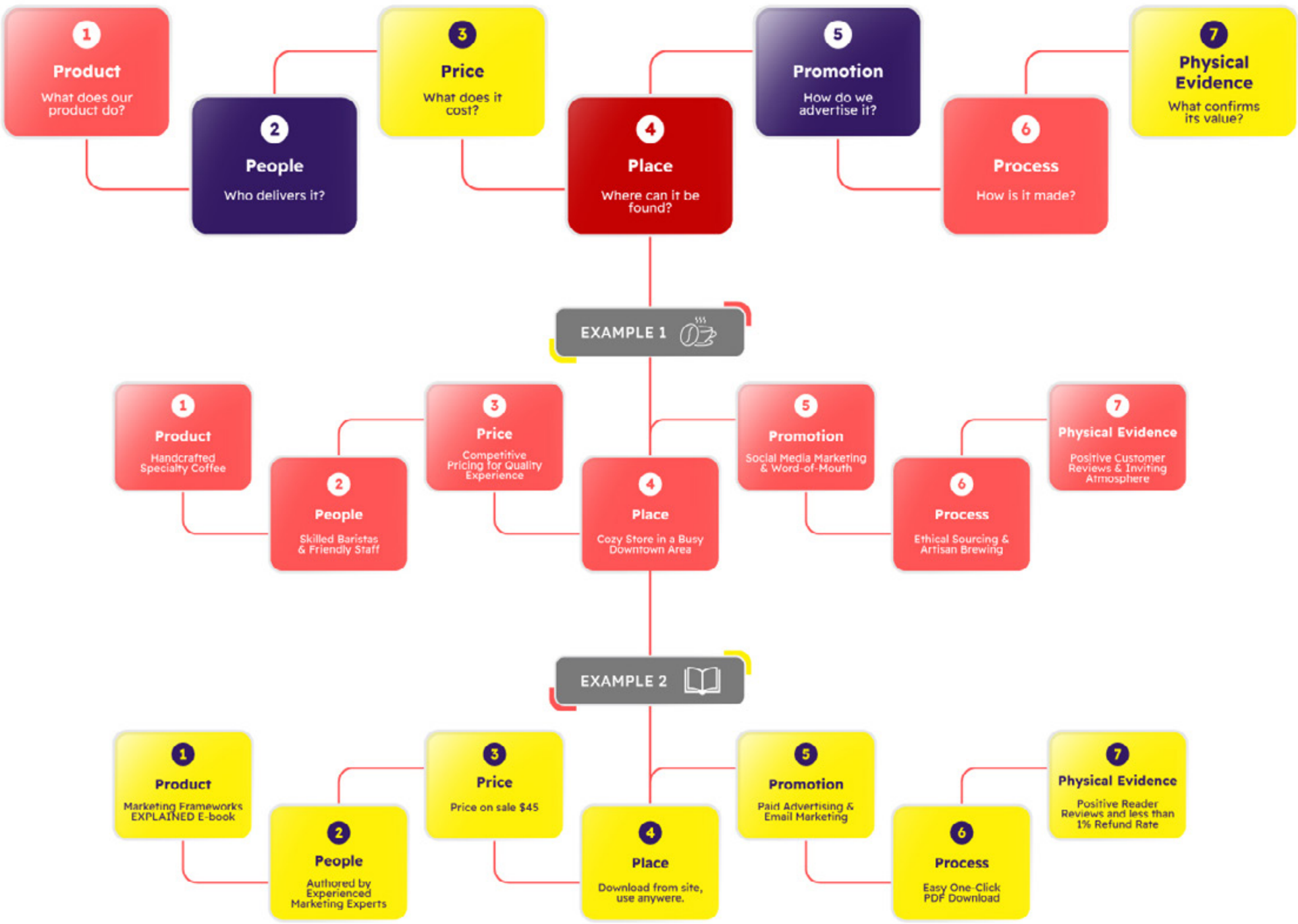
The concept of the mix has been supported by the 4 Ps of marketing strategy since the 1960s. The 4Ps, an acronym consisting of just four letters, stand for:

- Product
- Price
- Place
- Promotion

Due to shifts in the business and consumer industries, the marketing mix procedure has evolved. In 1981, Bernard H. Booms and Mary J. Bitner took McCarthy's idea and refined it into the 7Ps of marketing.
The four Ps from before were maintained, while Booms and Bitner added three more:

- People
- Process
- Physical evidence

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Let's examine the 7Ps of marketing in detail.

1ST OF 7P'S OF MARKETING - PRODUCT

The product in the marketing mix is what is actually being sold. Product-related topics include things like building quality, presentation, and reputation. If you're building a product, you should ask yourself whether or not its intended consumers actually want or need it.

There is also the life cycle to think about, which includes stages like growth, maturity, and a decline in sales. You can win this round by giving your target market a superior product to the one your competitors are offering.
In order to define product mix strategies, here are five questions to ask:

- What do consumers anticipate from a service or good?
- How will they use it, and what are they going to do with it?

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- What features are necessary to satisfy the customer's requirements?
- Is the brand name easy to recall?
- What makes your product unique compared to others on the market?

2ND OF 7P'S OF MARKETING - PRICE

The "price" in the marketing mix is the customer's propensity to spend money. Whether or not the selling price is greater than the production costs determines whether or not there will be a profit. Changing the cost of your product can have a significant impact on demand, sales, and even customers' opinions of your business.

If your rates are lower than the competition, keep in mind that some customers may associate it with lesser quality. However, if prices are set too high, losses could overwhelm gains. Where exactly is the middle ground'?
Therefore, it is important for marketers to consider the worth of the product and various pricing strategies before settling on a final price.

To get started with this aspect of the marketing mix, please review the following questions:

- Is this an affordable option?
- Is this a competitive pricing in the market?
- Should discount prices be made available?
- Do you offer installment plans?
- Is the customer subject to any credit requirements?

3RD OF 7P'S OF MARKETING - PLACE

Place describes how and where your products are shown to potential customers. And you can't discuss the place without bringing up your intended customer. For this section,

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it’s important to have a firm understanding of your ideal customer. After you have thoroughly researched your ideal customers, you will be able to identify the most efficient channels for distribution.

So, how should you position your product? In order to define this aspect of marketing, consider the following five questions:

- Where do your potential customers look for your product?
- What is the most effective strategy for identifying viable channel partners?
- What makes your approach to distribution unique from that of competitors?
- Do you need to hire a sales team?
- Are you in need of online sales?

4TH OF 7P’S OF MARKETING - PROMOTION

The promotion mix is the “who,” “what,” and “how” of the marketing mix. What is communicated, who receives it, how they are reached, and how often is it promoted? It employs methods like:

- Advertising
- Sales
- Marketing and Publicity
- Emails
- Social media

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The purpose of the promotion mix and its guiding principle is to boost product recognition and sales. The following five questions will help you determine whether or not you have a viable promotional strategy:

- How and when can you deliver your marketing messaging to your intended audience?
- How do your competitors advertise themselves?
- How do your competition's promotional strategies affect your own?

- When is the best time to advertise your product?

- Is it preferable to use social media?

5TH OF 7P'S OF MARKETING - PEOPLE

Businesses are dependent on the people who run them, right? It goes without saying that you need the appropriate people working for your company, as they are just as vital to your success as the goods and services you offer. It can be seen in things like how well employees accomplish their jobs or how they treat their customers.

Therefore, it may be challenging to define the "appropriate people" for your organization, but you should take into account the following three criteria.

- Exceptional service
- Authentic enthusiasm
- Staying receptive to feedback

Having the appropriate people working for you is a competitive advantage in the marketplace.

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6TH OF 7P'S OF MARKETING - PROCESS

Process in marketing refers to how potential customers are introduced to your goods or services. The health of your business can be guaranteed by the efficacy of your sales funnel, distribution system, or other systematic processes. To cut costs, you should also have a well-organized method. Other examples include the sequence in which tasks are completed, the number of sales leads generated, and the methods used to track and evaluate employee output.

7TH OF 7P'S OF MARKETING - PHYSICAL EVIDENCE

The 7 Ps of marketing all require physical evidence. The item could be physical or intangible, but confirmation of delivery is still required. In the real world, this manifests in things like product packaging, receipts, and customer service. Intangible physical proof is the public's opinion of a company's goods.

If you want your brand to be the first thing that people think of whenever they hear a certain word, sound, or phrase, then you need to be consistent across all of your marketing platforms.

Think of the first person you think of when you want pizza delivered quickly. The name Pizza Hut often comes up. You can see their impact on the industry right away. That is Intangible physical evidence.

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MARKETING MIX PROCESS

Delivery methods for your product or service are included in the marketing mix process. A business's effectiveness can be ensured by the use of various systems, such as a sales funnel, a distribution network, or both. To keep costs down, you'll want to have a well-organized approach.

Other examples might be the sequence in which activities are completed, the volume of questions that salespeople field, or the methods used to monitor and evaluate staff performance.

MARKETING MIX PHYSICAL EVIDENCE

Physical evidence is essential and cannot be disregarded by the 7Ps of marketing. Evidence of service delivery, whether physical or digital, is required. The product's packaging, receipt, or customer service interaction are all concrete examples. The market's impression of a company's goods is an example of intangible physical evidence.

People are more likely to remember your firm by name if you keep your brand consistent across all platforms. Who, for instance, springs to mind when you consider the fast-food industry? McDonald's is the most common answer. When they enter a room, the atmosphere changes. That's proof of intangible physical evidence.

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SWOT ANALYSIS

Analysis of a company's SWOT (strengths, weaknesses, opportunities, threats) is useful for both short-term and long-term planning. A SWOT analysis is a method for analyzing an organization's fortes, weaknesses, prospects, and dangers. An organization's, an initiative's, or an industry's strengths and weaknesses can be more accurately assessed with the help of a SWOT analysis. The company must maintain precision in its analysis by focusing on actual situations rather than hypothetical ones. Businesses should look at it as more of a suggestion than a hard and fast rule.

UNDERSTANDING SWOT ANALYSIS

A corporation, a product line, a division, an industry, or any other specified entity may use the SWOT analysis method to assess its strengths, weaknesses, opportunities, and threats. The technique helps businesses steer clear of initiatives that have historically failed and towards ones that are more likely to succeed by using both internal and external data. Companies, product lines, and industries can benefit from the insight of independent SWOT analysts, investors, and even competitors when trying to determine if they are strong or weak.

The initial application of SWOT analysis was to evaluate companies. Present-day users range from governments and NGOs to private citizens and business owners. The SWOT analysis can be used in virtually any situation imaginable.

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THE SWOT ANALYSIS'S KEY ELEMENTS

The following are the four components of a SWOT analysis. Although the specifics of each category and the findings made therein will differ from business to business, a SWOT analysis is incomplete without considering the following:



STRENGTHS

A company's strengths are the things at which it excels and which set it apart from rivals; examples include the company's well-known brand, its dedicated customer base, its solid finances, its innovative technology, and so on. One example is a hedge fund's use of a proprietary trading method that consistently outperforms the market. It then has to make a judgment on how to leverage those findings to win over fresh capital.

WEAKNESSES

Weaknesses prevent a group from reaching its full potential. A bad brand, above-average turnover, high levels of debt, an insufficient supply chain, or a lack of cash are all examples of areas where the business may use some work in order to stay competitive.

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OPPORTUNITIES

When we talk about opportunities, we're referring to favorable external conditions that could provide a competitive advantage for a business. If a country reduces its tariffs, for instance, a vehicle manufacturer can begin exporting to that country, so expanding its customer base and sales.

THREATS

By definition, threats are anything that could cause harm to a business. A wheat farm faces risk since drought can ruin or drastically diminish crop yield. Common dangers include escalating commodity prices, fiercer competition, and a shrinking pool of available workers.

SWOT TABLE

A SWOT analysis is typically depicted by analysts as a square with four quadrants, each of which focuses on a different factor of the analysis. This visual representation gives a brief summary of the company's status. While not every bullet item under a given heading needs to be of equal significance, each should provide important insights into the relative magnitude of possibilities, risks, benefits, and disadvantages.

The internal elements are often listed at the top of the SWOT table, while the external factors are listed at the bottom. Additionally, the items on the left side of the table are more favorable, while those on the right are more concerning.

HOW TO DO A SWOT ANALYSIS?

There are a number of procedures that may be taken before and after conducting a SWOT analysis, each of which will yield useful information. The following are the typical components of a SWOT analysis.

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STEP ONE: DECIDE WHAT YOU WANT TO ACCOMPLISH.

A SWOT analysis can be general in scope, but it will be more useful if it is focused on a specific goal. The decision of whether or not to launch a new product is just one possible SWOT analysis objective. A company's efforts will be more focused if they have a clear idea of what they want to accomplish by the project's conclusion. The SWOT analysis might be useful here in deciding whether or not to launch the product.

STEP 2: GATHER YOUR RESOURCES

In order to compile the many SWOT analysis tables that may be required, a corporation may need access to a wide variety of data sources. The first step for each business is to figure out what data it has access to, what data constraints it confronts, and how trustworthy its external data sources are. A corporation should know the correct mix of employees to have working on the analysis in addition to the data. It's possible that certain employees have better access to exterior influences, while others in the production or sales departments have a better handle on internal happenings. When people bring different viewpoints to the table, they are more likely to make thoughtful, original comments.

STEP 3: ASSEMBLE THE IDEAS

The group tasked with conducting the SWOT analysis should begin by making a list of potential items to consider for each of the four categories that make up the study. The following are some sample inquiries or thought prompts for each category.

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INTERNAL FACTORS

The company's internal dynamics provide rich material for the SWOT analysis's strengths and weaknesses sections. Factors that exist within the company's walls include its financial and human capital, its tangible and intangible (brand name) assets, and its operational efficiencies.

Possible queries for enumerating internal factors are as follows:

- (Area of Strength) Where do we excel?
- What is our greatest strength?
- (Weakness) What are our detractors?
- (Weakness) Which of our product lines is performing the worst?

EXTERNAL FACTORS

External elements are just as crucial to a company's success as internal ones. To compile a list of advantages and disadvantages, one can look to external factors such as monetary policies, market shifts, and supplier availability. Some questions you could ask to identify external causes include:

- (Opportunity) What market trends are visible?
- What subsets of the population are we overlooking as potential customers?
- (Threat) What is the market share of the competitors, and how many are there?
- (Threat) Are there any new rules that may have an adverse effect on our business or our products?

STRENGTHS

1. Where do we stand out from the competition?
2. How much do we have at our disposal?
3. Which products are selling well?

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WEAKNESSES

1. What areas need work?
2. Which items are failing to meet expectations?
3. Where do we need to allocate more funds?

OPPORTUNITIES

1. How can we take advantage of the latest technology?
2. Can we increase our current capacity?
3. What fresh areas can we test?

THREATS

1. Which laws are being altered?
2. To what extent are competitors adapting?
3. In what ways are consumers' preferences shifting?

To accomplish this, businesses may hold a "white-boarding" or "sticky note" session. The point is that there is no correct response and that everyone should feel safe expressing their opinions. The point is to generate as many ideas as possible in order to spark imagination and originality in others; they may always be scrapped later.

STEP 4: REFINE FINDINGS

Now that we have a list of ideas for each area, we can begin organizing them. By narrowing down all of the ideas and threats, a business may concentrate on the most promising ones. At this point, the analytic team may need to engage in some heated disagreement, possibly even including higher-ups in the process of priority setting.

STEP 5: DEVELOP THE STRATEGY

The next step is to transform the SWOT analysis into a strategic plan using the prioritized list of strengths, weaknesses, opportunities, and threats.

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The analysis group then synthesizes this information, using the bulleted list of items inside each category to provide direction on the original purpose.

A corporation deciding whether to launch a new product may, for instance, have determined that it already dominates its market with its current offering and might therefore expand into additional markets. Increased costs for raw materials, stretched supply chains, the need for more personnel, and erratic product demand could potentially outweigh the benefits. In the event that costs have decreased and market demand has become clearer in the intervening six months, the analytical team plans to reevaluate the decision.

The strengths and weaknesses of your company might be better understood with the use of a SWOT analysis. However, keep in mind that this is one of many strategies, not a prescription.

Overall, it is helpful to use a SWOT analysis as a framework for corporate strategy discussions. Group brainstorming sessions where participants debate the company's potential, risks, strengths, and shortcomings are extremely effective. The initial plan for the SWOT analysis often evolves as the session progresses to account for information that was previously overlooked.

A SWOT analysis can be used to discuss the company's overall strategy or to analyze a specific department, such as marketing, production, or sales. Before committing to the overarching plan developed from the SWOT analysis, you may understand how it will affect the sub-segments. A segment-focused SWOT analysis can provide input to a broader SWOT analysis, or the process can work in reverse.

SWOT analysis can help with planning, but it is not without its drawbacks. It is not the only method of business planning, and it should not be utilized in isolation. Furthermore, not every item under each heading is given the same weight. The disparities in importance are ignored by SWOT analysis. As a result, additional research employing alternative planning methods is required.

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STP MARKETING MODEL

Many firms nowadays make the error of starting their marketing efforts without a strategy or target market in mind. As a result, they spend time and resources on ineffective tasks.

Any company that wants to reach its target market must first divide it into segments. With the use of the segmentation, targeting, and positioning (STP) model, a powerful tool, marketers may achieve these objectives. By determining the most lucrative segments for a company's marketing mix and product positioning strategy, this STP marketing approach focuses on commercial effectiveness. Without it, marketing campaigns would be impersonal, generic, and unable to convert at a rate that most businesses would deem acceptable.

How does STP marketing work, though? How does it function? What are its benefits and drawbacks? All of these queries will be addressed in this section.

WHAT IS STP MARKETING MODEL?

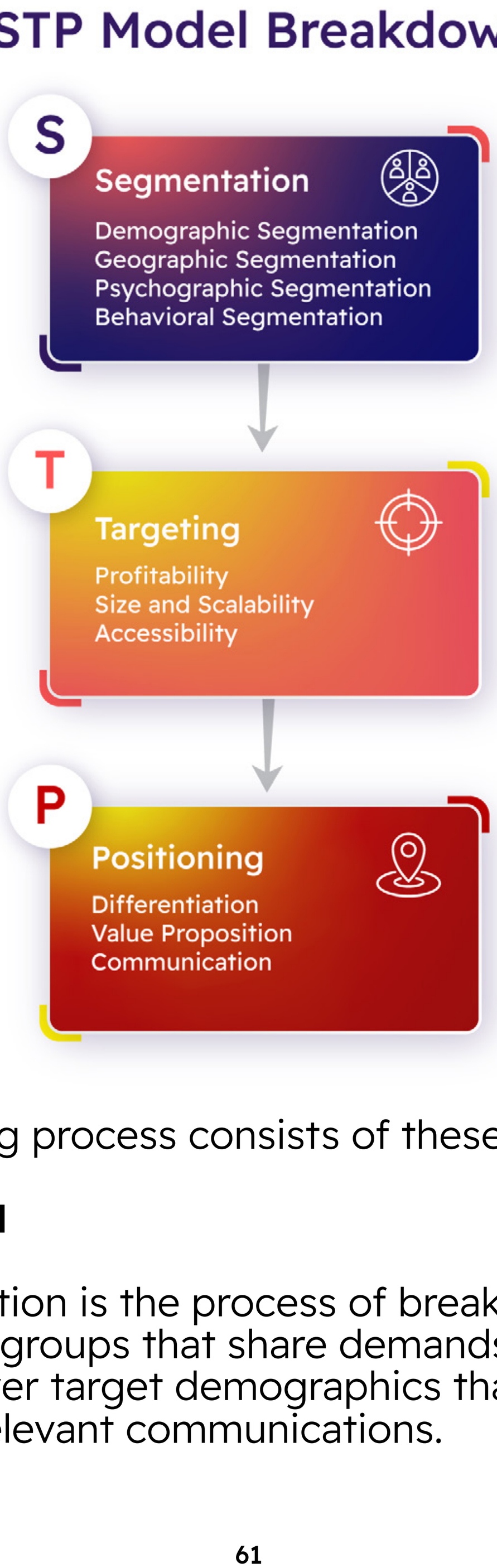
The STP marketing model, which stands for segmentation, targeting, and positioning, is a marketing framework that assists companies in identifying pertinent market segments, concentrating marketing efforts on these segments, and positioning their goods and services to stand out in the eyes of customers.

This marketing strategy has been around for a while and is still in use by businesses today because it works well to make sure that marketing initiatives are pertinent to the target market, stand out from the competition, and have a distinct emphasis.

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HOW DOES STP MODEL WORK?

The STP model is a technique that aids companies in market segmentation, targeting particular market segments with customized offers and developing a positioning strategy that highlights their distinctive value proposition.



The STP marketing process consists of these three steps:

SEGMENTATION

Market segmentation is the process of breaking a market into several customer groups that share demands or traits.
It seeks to discover target demographics that can be addressed with relevant communications.

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There are many ways to divide up a market, but the following are the most popular ones:

- **Geographic Segmentation:** This type of segmentation divides the market according to different geographical units. It could be by area, nation, city, or even neighborhood.

- **Demographic segmentation:** This method involves dividing the market based on various demographic factors. These factors could include age, gender, income, occupation, education, religion, or stage of a family's life cycle.

- **Psychographic Segmentation:** This process involves dividing the market based on certain psychological aspects. These can encompass factors like personality, values, attitudes, hobbies, or lifestyles of the consumers.

- **Behavioural segmentation:** This type of segmentation divides the market based on the behaviors of the consumer. Factors for consideration could be the knowledge, attitudes, uses, or reactions of the consumer to a product.

Instead of attempting to appeal to the entire market with a single marketing mix, the STP marketing model helps businesses segment their markets into various segments that can be targeted with various marketing strategies.
As an illustration, consider a maker of gaming mobile phones. The business might target its items at male and female customers within a specific age range using demographic segmentation. Additionally, it can divide its customer into three age groups: school-age, college-age, and office workers.

Then, it could use psychographic segmentation to separate heavy users from casual and social players and non-players. The company may also employ behavioral segmentation to target users who frequently play games on their mobile devices.

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TARGETING

Targeting is the process of assessing the allure of each market sector and choosing one or more to enter. Businesses using the STP model choose segments based on their ability to expand and provide high revenues at minimal expense
Among the considerations when selecting a segment are:

- **Profitability:** The sector you choose should be profitable, which implies that the segment's customers should be eager to purchase your goods and services.

- **Size and scalability:** The target market group shoul have room for long-term expansion.

- **Accessibility:** Sales and marketing messaging should be able to reach the segment.

For instance, the manufacturer of gaming mobile phones can assess the market segments it has identified and focus on the college-bound kids who are gaming mobile phones' primary market.

POSITIONING

Positioning is the process of giving the brand (brand positioning) or product (product positioning) a distinctive and differentiating image or identity in the eyes of the target market.

Simply said, positioning involves linking emotions, qualities, attitudes, and sentiments with a particular brand in order to influence how buyers perceive it. The brand stands out from its rivals thanks to these associations.

There are three typical methods of positioning:

- **Symbolic positioning:** Setting up shop in accordance with the customer's persona, personality, or way of life.

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- **Functional positioning:** Setting your product's location based on the advantages it offers customers or the value it adds to their lives.

- **Experimental positioning:** Focusing on the emotional connection and experience of the customer with your goods

THE IMPORTANCE OF THE STP MARKETING MODEL

The STP model is crucial because it assists firms in locating the ideal target market and achieving it through a calculated approach. Additionally, by better understanding their consumers' needs and wants, organizations can create a more specialized customer experience for their intended market. In addition, this is how it benefits businesses:

- **Helps identify the most lucrative market niche:** Out of all the available target market segments, the STP process aids firms in identifying the most lucrative segment. This is possible because firms can pinpoint each segment's needs and desires before designing their goods and services to satisfy those desires.

- **Aids in creating the correct product for the appropriate market:** The STP marketing process assists businesses in selecting the optimal product for the optimal market. It also enables companies to provide goods that customers need and want by helping them understand their target market.

- Improved placement results from the outcome of this procedure are that products are properly positioned in the market. This is so that companies may position their items appropriately by selecting the appropriate target group and understanding their needs and wants.

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- **Aids in creating the ideal marketing mix:** Based on the requirements and preferences of their target audience, the STP process aids firms in creating an ideal combination of their products, places, prices, and promotions.

EXAMPLES OF STP MARKETING MODELS

Examples are the most effective way to demonstrate the STP marketing concept. To further comprehend this idea, let's look at some examples.

- NIKE

One of the most well-known sports brands in the world is Nike. The business employs the STP marketing technique to reach its target market of sportsmen and sports fans. Segmentation: Nike divides the market into divisions based on lifestyle, sport, age, and gender.

Targeting: It aims to appeal to both professional athletes and active people.

Positioning: By offering top-notch and cutting-edge products, Nike portrays itself as a sports company that comprehends the needs of players and sports aficionados. The company's brand logo, "The Swoosh," and catchphrase, "Just Do It," convey the same message.

- MCDONALD'S

One of the biggest fast-food chains in the world is McDonald's. The business reaches its target market of families with kids who are searching for a quick and economical dinner using the STP marketing technique.

Segmentation: McDonald's divides the market into segments based on factors including location, age, income, gender, and lifestyle.

Targeting: It targets families and kids who are searching for a quick supper at a reasonable price.

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Positioning: McDonald's presents itself as a fast-food establishment ideal for busy families. It appeals to kids with its "Happy Meal" and families searching for a deal with its numerous promos.

- IPHONE

When it was introduced in 2007, the iPhone swiftly rose to the top of the smartphone industry. Apple effectively marketed the iPhone to its intended market using the STP marketing approach.

Segmentation: Apple divided the smartphone market into segments based on age, income, and lifestyle.

Targeting: The company chose to go after rich customers who wanted a high-end, fashionable smartphone.

Positioning: iPhone is positioned as a high-end smartphone used by successful and stylish individuals. It promoted the iPhone as a status symbol as well.

Overall, the STP marketing model is an effective tool that companies may use to identify the target market, create the ideal marketing strategy, and increase sales. The STP marketing approach, when properly implemented, can assist companies in raising brand recognition, cultivating customer loyalty, and boosting sales. The STP marketing strategy, however, should not be considered the only tool in a marketer's arsenal. Businesses might utilize additional marketing tactics and frameworks to get the outcomes they want.

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PORTER'S 5 FORCES

Porter's Five Forces, a methodology that identifies and analyses five competitive forces that affect every business, can be used to determine an industry's weaknesses and strengths. The Five Forces study is often used to determine an industry's structure in order to build a firm strategy. Any sector of the economy can benefit from using Porter's model to better analyze industry rivalry and increase long-term profitability. The Five Forces approach is named after Harvard Business School professor Michael E. Porter. Porter's five forces are:

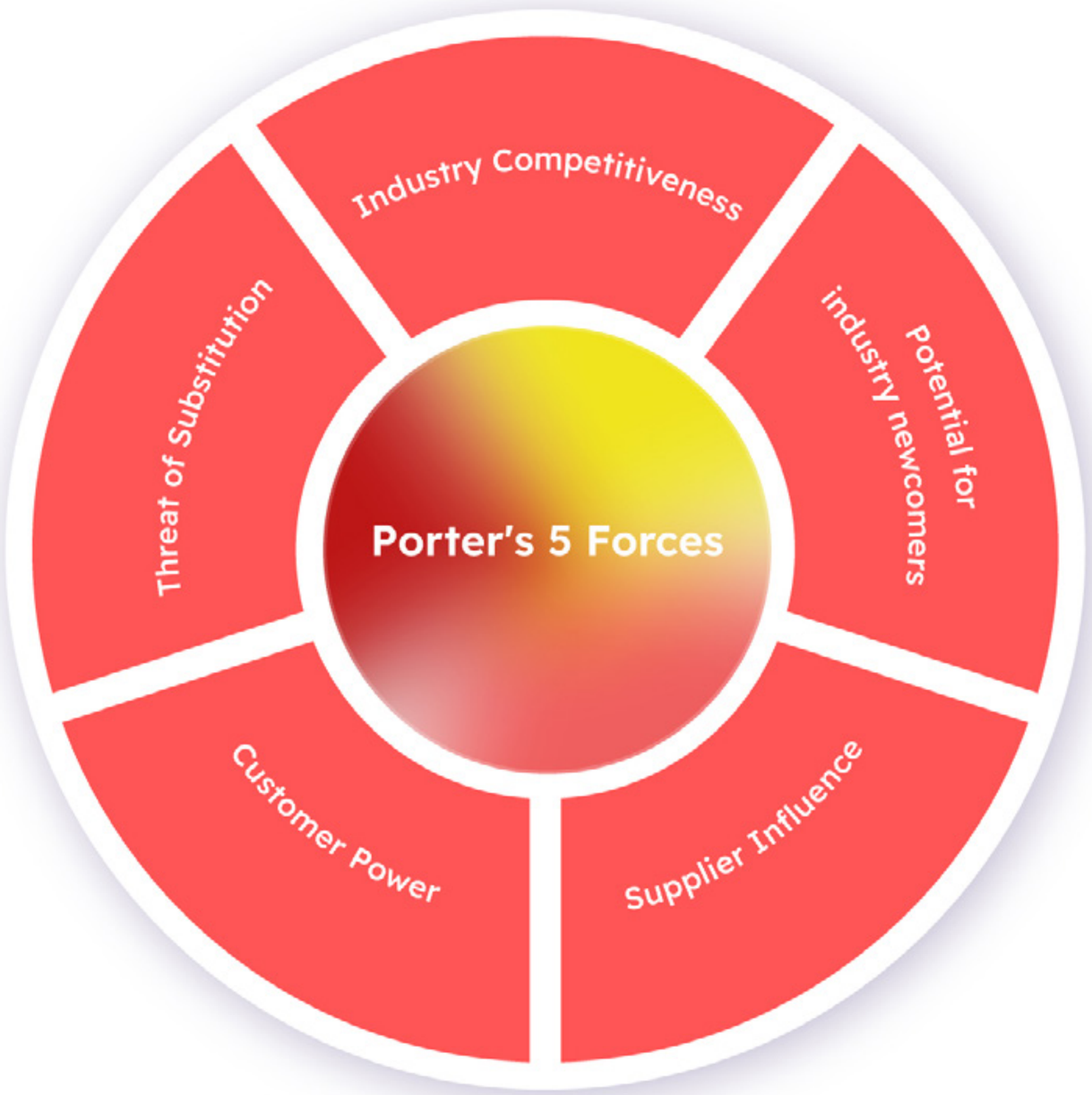
1) Industry competition
2) Prospect of new entrants
3) Power of suppliers
4) Power of customers
5) Threat of replacement products

UNDERSTANDING THE FIVE FORCES OF PORTER

A business analysis framework called Porter's Five Forces can help to understand why different industries are able to maintain varying levels of profitability. The concept was invented in 1979 by Michael E. Porter.

The Five Forces model is frequently used to evaluate a company's corporate strategy as well as its industry structure. With some qualifications, Porter identified five immovable forces that affect every market and business in the globe. The attractiveness, profitability, and level of rivalry in a market or industry are typically assessed using the Five Forces model.

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1. INDUSTRY COMPETITIVENESS

The first of the Five Forces is the firm’s competitive environment, which includes the quantity and strength of the company’s competitors. The power of a corporation diminishes as the number of competitors and the number of comparable products and services they offer increases. Customers and suppliers will turn to a competitor if they can offer a better deal or cheaper rate. A company, however, has greater negotiating power and can raise prices when there is less competition, which will increase sales and profits.

2. THE POTENTIAL FOR NEW COMPETITORS IN AN INDUSTRY

The force of new entrants into a market has an impact on a company’s power as well. An established company’s position may be considerably undermined the quicker and cheaper it is for a rival to enter its market and become a viable rival. It is appropriate for existing enterprises inside an industry with significant entry barriers since the company would be able to charge higher rates and negotiate better conditions.

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3. SUPPLIER INFLUENCE

The Porter model's second element examines how quickly suppliers can raise input costs. It is influenced by the number of suppliers of an item or service, the degree to which these inputs are special, and the cost to a corporation of switching providers. A company would be more dependent on a supplier in an industry with fewer providers.

As a result, the supplier is in a stronger position and has the ability to increase input costs and demand additional trade benefits. On the other hand, a business can maintain its input costs low and increase its profits when there are several suppliers or low switching costs between competing suppliers.

4. CUSTOMER POWER

One of the Five Forces is the power or capacity of the customer to influence price reductions. It is influenced by the quantity and value of a company's purchasers or customers, as well as by how expensive it would be for a company to find new markets or consumers for its goods.
Each consumer has greater leverage to bargain for lower rates and better deals because the customer base is smaller and more strong. It will be simpler for a business with lots of small, independent customers to raise pricing and boost profitability.

Businesses can increase their profitability by using the Five Forces model, but they must constantly check for changes in the Five Forces and modify their business plans accordingly.

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5. THREAT OF SUBSTITUTION

The fifth and final force focuses on alternatives. Threats come from substitute items or services that can be employed in place of a company's goods or offerings. Companies that make or sell products or services for which there are no direct substitutes will be able to charge more and get better conditions. Customers will have the choice to choose not to purchase a company's product when close substitutes are readily available, which might diminish a company's position in the market.

An organization can modify its business plan to more effectively employ its resources and produce higher revenues for its investors by comprehending Porter's Five Forces and how they apply to the industry.

WHAT FUNCTION DO PORTER'S FIVE FORCES SERVE?

Managers and analysts can better understand the competitive environment a company operates in and how it is positioned within it by using Porter's Five Forces Model.

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ANSOFF MATRIX

Ansoff Matrix, also called Product/Market Expansion Grid, is a two-by-two structure that management teams and the analyst community use to plan and assess expansion projects. The tool specifically aids stakeholders in conceptualizing the degree of risk connected to various growth strategies.



The matrix was created by applied mathematician and business strategist H. Igor Ansoff and was published in the Harvard Business Review in 1957. To assist more thorough analyses of the factors influencing corporate growth, the Ansoff Matrix is frequently used in conjunction with other business and industry analysis tools, including the PESTEL, SWOT, and Porter’s 5 Forces frameworks.

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UNDERSTANDING THE ANSOFF MATRIX

An essential structure taught in business schools all over the world is the Ansoff Matrix. It is a straightforward and natural method to picture the controls a management group might use to examine growth potential. On the X-axis are Products, and on the Y-axis are Markets.

Within the Ansoff paradigm, the term “markets” might mean various things. It could refer to a country or region (such as the North American market), or it might refer to specific customer categories (such as the target market or demographic).

The Matrix is used to compare the relative attractiveness of growth strategies that take advantage of both current products and markets as well as those that do not, as well as the level of risk involved in each.

The Matrix’s boxes each represent a distinct growth approach. As follows:

- Market penetration refers to the idea of boosting sales of already-existing products in an already-existing market.

- The market expansion focuses on introducing current items to new markets.

- Product development is concerned with bringing new goods to an existing market.

- Diversification entails entering a new market with completely new products.

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MARKET PENETRATION

Market penetration is, relative to other risks, the least dangerous.

Management tries to sell more of its current products into markets they are familiar with and where they already have contacts when they use a market penetration strategy. Typical methods of execution include:

- Stepping up marketing initiatives or simplifying the distribution system
- Reducing prices to draw in new customers within the market sector
- Purchasing a similar business to expand into other markets

Take into account a company that offers consumer packaged goods to supermarket chains. In order to acquire additional shelf space for various lines of its pet food items in addition to packaged food products, management may adjust pricing for a major chain in an effort to increase penetration.

MARKET DEVELOPMENT

Because it does not necessitate a sizable investment in R&D or product development, a market development approach is the second least risky. Instead, it enables a management team to capitalize on current items and introduce them to a new market. Methods include:

- Tailoring services to a different customer base or demographic
- Expanding a territory by entering a new domestic market.
- Expanding internationally by entering a foreign market

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For instance, Lululemon's management decided to aggressively enter the Asia Pacific market in order to promote its already extremely well-liked athleisure products. Even while developing an advertising and logistics infrastructure in a foreign market entails risks, the fact that they are marketing a product with a tested road map makes it less dangerous.

PRODUCT DEVELOPMENT

A company may seek to increase its share of the wallet from a certain market or target demographic if it has its ears. Consider it a play on brand loyalty, which may be attained in several different ways, such as:

- Spending money on R&D to create brand-new product(s).
- Purchasing the right to manufacture and market the goods created by another company.

- Branding a white-label product that is actually created by a third party to create a new offering.

An illustration would be a cosmetics company that manufactures and markets hair care items that appeal to ladies in the 28–35 age range. They heavily invest in the manufacture of a new range of hair care products in an effort to take advantage of the brand's success and devoted following within this group, expecting that the current target market will accept it.

DIVERSIFICATION

In terms of risk, diversification strategies are typically the most risky because they require both product and market development. Although it carries the greatest risk, it has the potential to produce enormous rewards, such as the achievement of entirely new income opportunities or the reduction of a company's reliance on a single product/market fit (for whatever reason).

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The two main forms of diversification techniques that a management team could take into account are as follows:

1. Related diversification takes place when an established firm and a new product or market have the potential to work together.

As an illustration, consider a leather shoe manufacturer who decides to make leather vehicle seats. Despite the fact that the product itself and the production process will require a significant investment in R&D and production, there are virtually likely synergies to be obtained in the sourcing of raw materials.

2. Unrelated Diversification - When diversifying, it is uncertain that there would be any significant synergies between the present business and the new product or market.

Let’s revisit the leather shoe manufacturer scenario. Consider how management might substantially invest in a consumer-packaged goods product in order to diversify and lessen its total reliance on the (very cyclical) consumer discretionary high-end shoe market.

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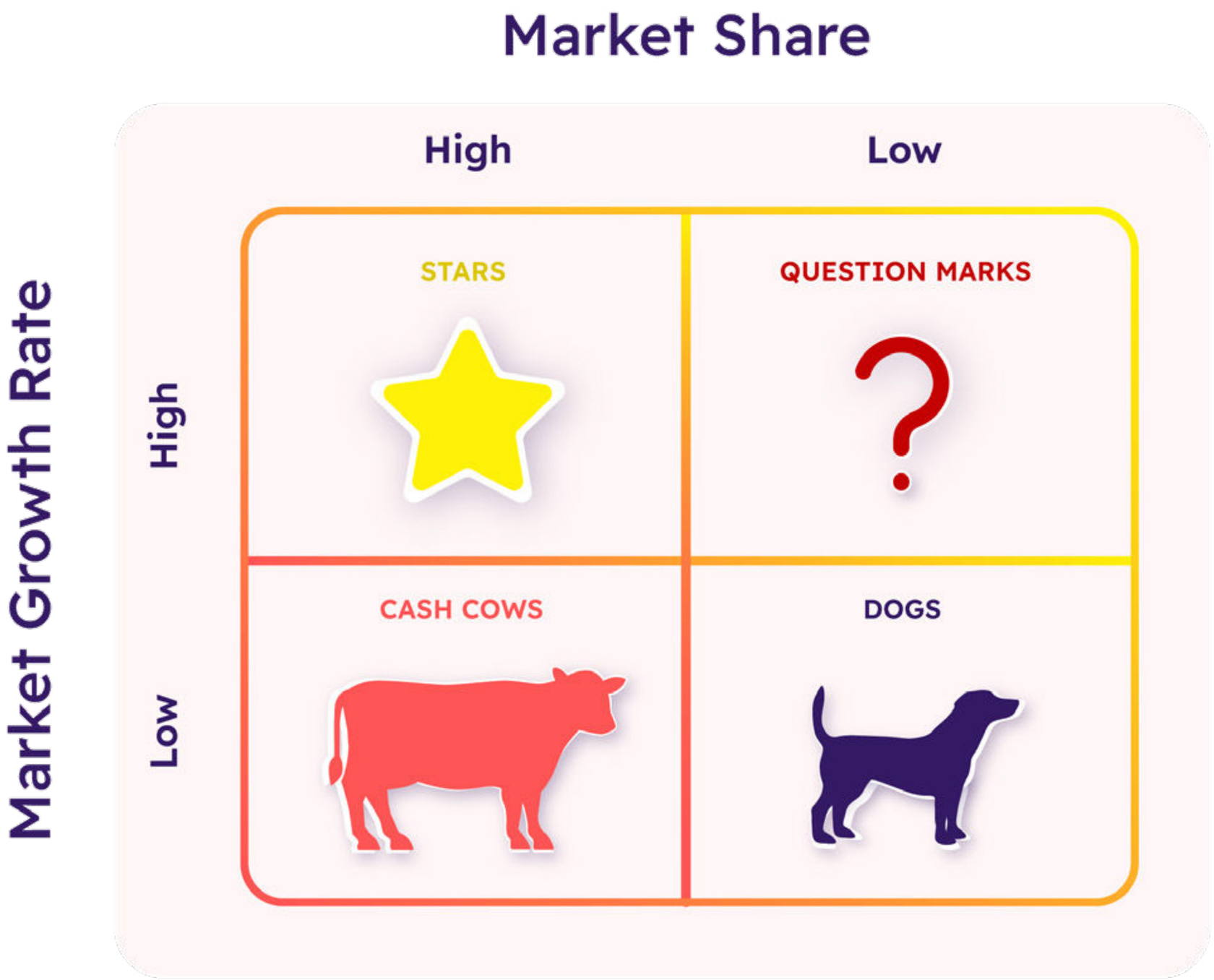
BCG GROWTH-SHARE MATRIX

A planning tool developed by the Boston Consulting Group (BCG) uses graphical representations of a company's goods and services to assist it in deciding what to keep, sell, or spend more.

The matrix displays a company's products as a four-square matrix, with the market share axis on the x-axis and the rate of market growth on the y-axis. The Boston Consulting Group first presented it in 1970.

THE BCG GROWTH-SHARE MATRIX: AN OVERVIEW

The four product classifications in the BCG growth-share matrix are dogs, cash cows, stars, and question marks. Each category quadrant possesses a distinct set of qualities.



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PETS OR DOGS

If a product has a little market share and stagnant growth, it is considered a dog and may need to be discontinued, liquidated, or relaunched. Dogs, which are in the lower right quadrant of the grid, don't generate much income for the company because they have a little market share and little to no growth. Because of this, dogs may end up being money pits that drain business resources over extended periods of time. They are, therefore, excellent candidates for divestment.

CASH COWS

Cash cows are products that are in low-growth markets but for which the company has a substantial market share; as a result, the corporation should continue to milk the cash cow. Cash cows are often the dominant products in established markets, as seen in the lower left quadrant.

These goods typically produce returns that outpace the market's rate of growth and are self-sufficient in terms of cash flow. The benefits of these products should be utilized as long as possible. Cash cows' worth may be easily determined because of how predictable their cash flow patterns are. The idea is to effectively milk low-growth, high-share cash cows for money to reinvest in high-growth, high-share stars with significant future potential.

The matrix is not a forecasting tool; it does not account for newly released, disruptive items or quickly changing consumer demand.

STARS

Star products should receive more investment because they are in high-growth areas and account for a substantial percentage of that market. Stars in the upper left quadrant produce significant income but also spend a lot of money from the company. When the market's overall growth rate slows down, a star that can maintain its position as the market leader eventually turns into a cash cow.

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QUESTION MARKS

Opportunities that have a high growth rate but in which the company does not hold a sizable market share are questionable. In the grid's upper right corner are question marks. They often expand quickly but use up a lot of company resources. Products in this quadrant should be scrutinized carefully and often to see whether they are worth keeping.

LIMITATIONS OF THE MATRIX

It should be noted that the matrix is a tool for making decisions. As a result, it may not always consider all the factors that an organization will eventually have to deal with. For instance, growing market share could cost more than the extra money made from new sales. Businesses must carefully plan for contingencies because product development could take years.

The matrix excludes mid-sized firms because it only categorizes them as low or high. When these organizations are excluded, the market isn't really reflected because they frequently make up a sizable portion of it.

The BCG matrix makes the supposition that each firm functions independently of the others. However, that isn't always the case. It's possible for some market participants, like dogs, to unwittingly increase the performance of others.

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A BCG GROWTH MATRIX EXAMPLE

We can use the growth matrix to analyze a variety of businesses in the real world. Apple (AAPL) is an excellent contender. Let's examine the products that Apple now sells in light of the matrix categories:

Star: iPhone
Cash Cow: Macbook
Question Mark: Apple TV
Dog: iPad

Nearly $316.2 billion of the company's $394.33 billion in net revenues in 2022 came from its products division. The company's services business contributed the remaining $78.13 billion.

There is no denying that Apple's most well-known product generates the majority of its sales. In this instance, the iPhone is regarded as the company's star because it generated $205.49 billion in sales for the entire year.

The company's cash cow is its Mac goods, most notably the Macbook laptop, which is one of the most popular in this category. For the fiscal year (FY), Mac product sales totaled $40.18 billion.

One of the question marks for Apple is its Apple TV streaming service, which falls under the Services category. Traditional streaming providers like Netflix, Hulu, and Disney+ dominate the industry, creating intense competition. However, competitors like Vimeo and YouTube are also eroding market share. Sales of $78.13 billion were generated by Apple's Services division in 2022.

The iPad, once the company's beloved, is now viewed as a dog. Apple's tablet continues to experience slow growth as its sales fall. Sales were $29.29 billion for the year, down from $31.86 billion in 2021.3

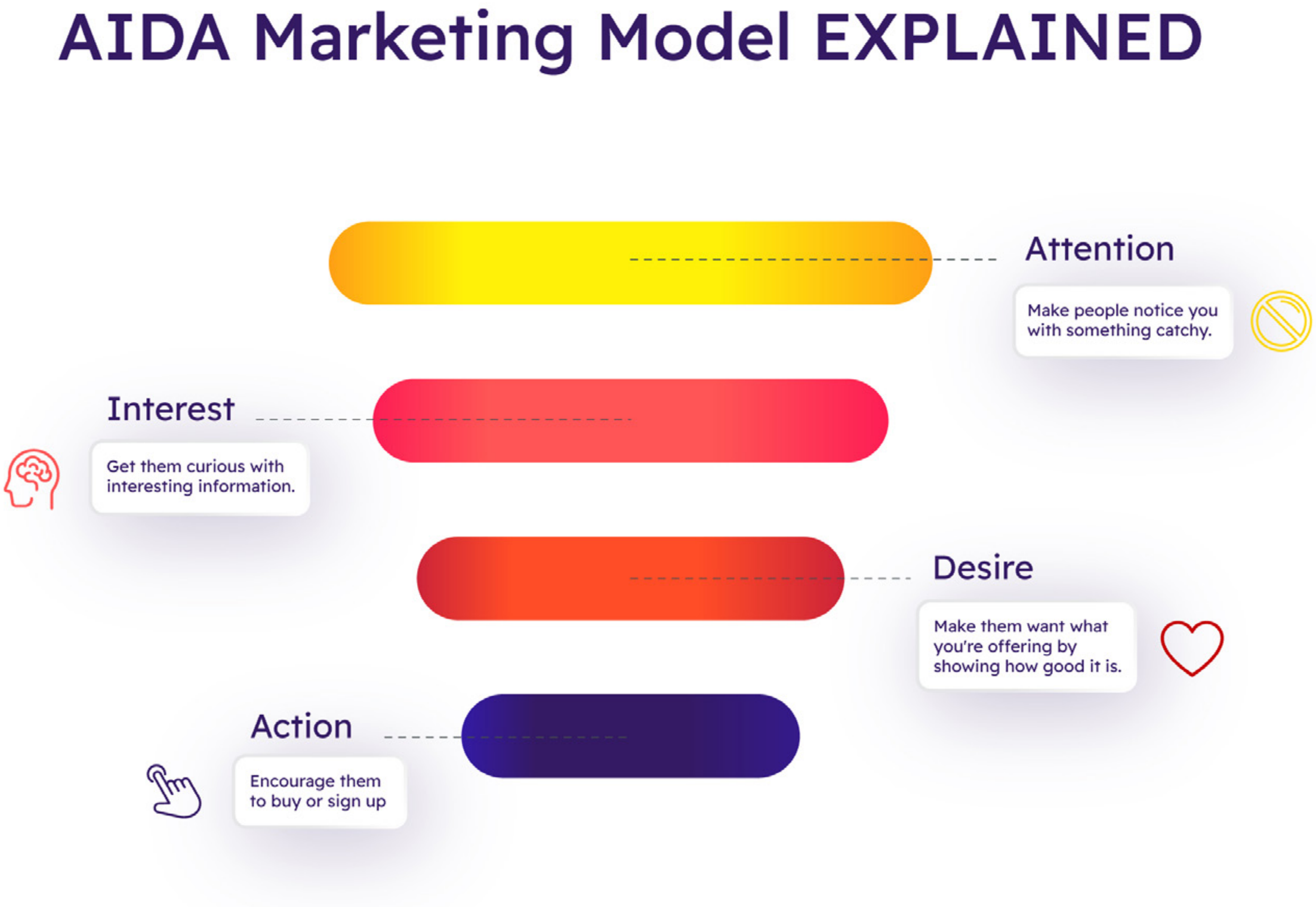
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Overall, a company management tool called the BCG Growth-Share Matrix enables firms to determine which areas of their operations should be given priority and which might potentially be dropped. A company's companies can be divided into one of four groups by building a 2x2 table along the dimensions of growth and market share: stars, pets, cash cows, and question marks.

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AIDA MODEL

The AIDA Model, which stands for Attention, Interest, Desire, and Action, is a model for the advertising effect that outlines the steps a person takes while making a purchase of a good or service.



The AIDA model is frequently employed in public relations efforts, sales techniques, and digital marketing initiatives.

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THE AIDA MODEL HIERARCHY

An AIDA model involves the following steps:

Attention: The first stage in marketing or advertising is to explore how to get consumers' attention.

Interest: Once a consumer is aware that a product or service is available, the company must try to pique their interest. As an illustration, Disney increases interest in upcoming tours by revealing the performers.
Desire: Once a customer has expressed interest in a good or service, the objective is to change their attitude from "I like it" to "I want it." For instance, the target group is more likely to desire to go if the Disney stars for the next tour promote how fantastic the event will be.

Action: The end goal of a marketing effort is to get people to take action and buy the product or service.

According to the AIDA model, Awareness triggers Interest, which triggers Desire, which triggers Action.

Let's see how to use the AIDA model by examining each level of the hierarchy.

FIRST STEP: ATTENTION

The attention component is frequently ignored by many marketers. It is presumed that consumers have already become aware of the product or service, but this may or may not be the case. Don't assume that everyone is already familiar with your goods, in any case. "Creative disruption" is one of the strongest strategies for grabbing consumers' attention since it involves upending established behavioral patterns with a message that is incredibly inventive. There are various methods for doing this:

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- Displaying adverts in unforeseen circumstances or places. This tactic is frequently called guerrilla marketing.

- Using shocking imagery in commercials to elicit shock.

- An extremely focused message. Additionally known as customization, this is.

The main objective is to inform customers that a product or service is available.

SECOND STEP: INTEREST

The hardest aspect is always piquing curiosity. For instance, this might be exceedingly challenging to do if the good or service is not intrinsically fascinating. Make sure the advertising content is organized, simple to read, and includes eye-catching subheadings and graphics. Concentrate on communicating only the most crucial message you wish to share with customers while keeping in mind what is most pertinent to your target market in regard to your product or service.

The slogan from Wendy's "Where's the beef?" advertising campaign highlighted the fact that Wendy's hamburgers had more beef than those of their rivals.

THIRD STEP: DESIRE

The AIDA model's second and third steps complement one another. It's crucial to help customers understand why they "need" the product or service you're trying to sell them as you work to increase interest in it.

Consider how infomercials offer their material; they hope to engage viewers with intriguing facts about the product as well as the advantages of purchasing it. These advantages should, in theory, pique viewers' interest in the goods.

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The way that infomercials accomplish this is by showcasing the goods in a variety of inventive settings. Explain to the audience the benefits of the good or service and why they require it.

FOURTH STEP: ACTION

Getting your customer to take the first action is the final step of the AIDA methodology. A call to action should be used to elicit an immediate response from the audience at the conclusion of the advertisement. As an illustration, Netflix employs persuasive prose to get customers to sign up for a free trial. Netflix encourages customers to join up for a free trial by emphasizing how handy and valuable their product is. Making limited-time incentives (such as free delivery) is one frequently used strategy for reaching this goal. Good advertising should create a sense of urgency that drives consumers to take action right now.

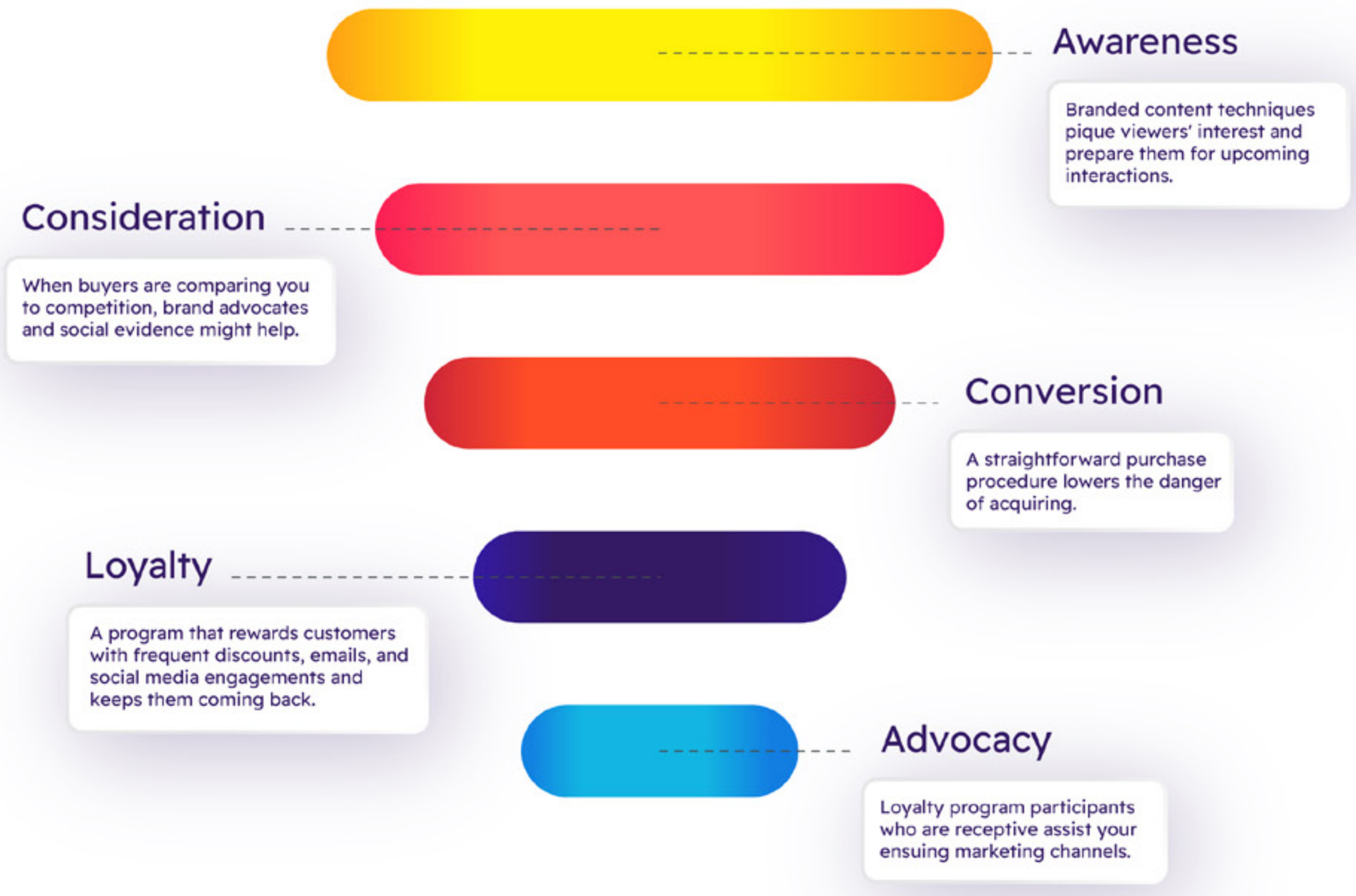
NEW DEVELOPMENTS IN THE AIDA MODEL

The AIDA paradigm is criticized by many as being overly simplistic. For instance, the AIDA model does not account for several potential points of sale. When a buyer visits an online store versus a dealership to buy a new car, marketing will be extremely different for each scenario. Consequently, there are numerous versions of the AIDA model, including the

- The AIDCAS model (Action, Interest, Desire, Confidence, Action, and Satisfaction)
- The REAN model (Reach, Engage, Activate, and Nurture)
- The NAITDASE model, which stands for Need, Attention, and Interest; Trust, Design, and Action; Satisfaction and Evaluation.

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MARKETING FUNNEL



Example: "IncredibleHappyPaws" is selling dog toys.



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The marketing funnel is a concept that visualizes the customer journey as a funnel because its shape helps demonstrate how fewer customers stick with the business as one advances through the stages. One of the most popular structures in the industry, marketing funnels, is utilized by both B2B and B2C marketing organizations. The marketing funnel typically has the following stages: Awareness, Interest, Consideration, Purchase, and Advocacy. There are, however, alternatives to this list.

When employing the marketing funnel, marketers align each stage of the funnel with their high-level strategic plans and more focused tactical initiatives. Additionally, particular KPIs that are typically related to the transition between stages, Strategies for Each Stage of the Marketing Funnel
The marketing funnel functions as a cohesive system.
This implies that for the journey to be successful, every component must function flawlessly.

Numerous factors lower friction in their marketing funnel. For illustration:

- **Awareness:** Branded content techniques pique viewers' interest and prepare them for upcoming interactions.

- **Consideration:** When buyers are comparing you to competition, brand advocates and social evidence might help.

- **Conversion:** A straightforward purchase procedure lowers the danger of acquiring.

- **Loyalty:** A program that rewards customers with frequent discounts, emails, and social media engagements and keeps them coming back.

- **Advocacy:** Loyalty program participants who are receptive assist your ensuing marketing channels.

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ADVANTAGES OF MARKETING FUNNELS

Marketing funnels streamline the consumer experience and make it simpler for businesses to implement. These solutions outline each phase in their customers' decision-making process and determine the actions they should take at each level.

Almost every customer interaction may be thought of as a marketing funnel. You need a marketing funnel whether your goal is to increase online sales, drive customers to your physical and-mortar location, or gather affiliate clicks. A funnel is a potent tool for making every stage of communicating with your customers visible.

The main advantage of marketing funnels is that they can be measured. Your funnel reveals where you're losing consumers, which might help you change your approach. For instance, you need a better brand recognition campaign if you lose customers before they ever reach the second stage.

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KOTLER'S 5 A'S OF SALES MARKETING

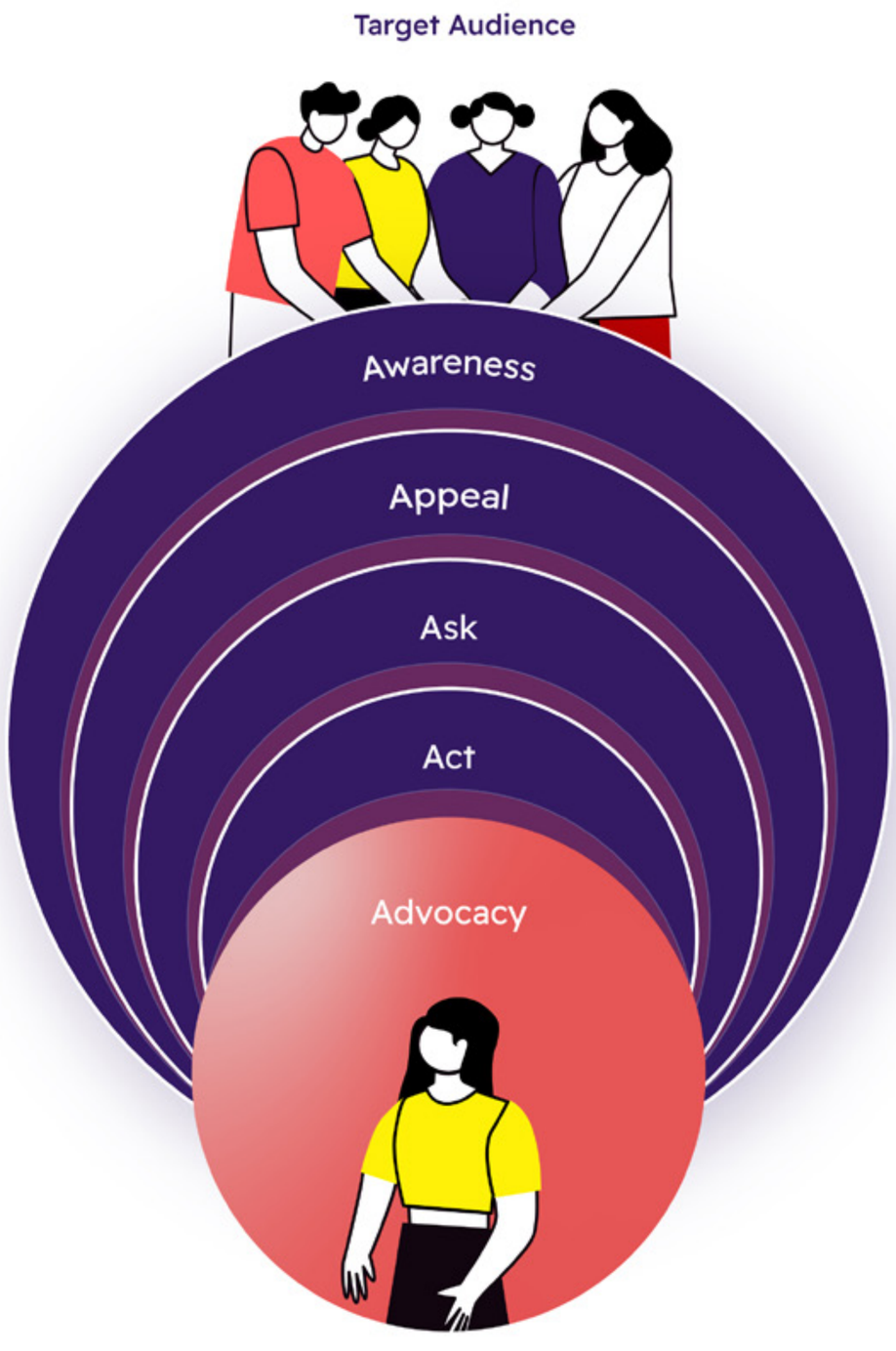
Consumer research, marketing analytics, and a framework that groups customer needs according to where they are in the sales process are frequently needed to develop a successful sales strategy. If you work in sales or marketing, learning how to map the buying process for potential customers will help you develop more effective promotional and customer-retention plans that could result in increased profits and retention rates. Kotler's five A's are one way of outlining the customer sales cycle. This section defines Kotler's five A's structure, explains each step, and offers advice on how to use it.

WHAT ARE KOTLER'S 5 A'S?

A customer's trip through the sales process is mapped out using Kotler's five A's of the customer path structure, which uses five stages.

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Kotler's 5 A's of Sales Marketing



The five stages, Awareness, Appeal, Ask, Act, and Advocacy (named after Dr. Philip Kotler), enable marketing and sales professionals to develop a map of the customer's requirements and objectives throughout the many stages of their purchasing process. They can use this map to build procedures that facilitate and enhance the customer's shopping experience.

Depending on the length and complexity of their transaction, some consumers might skip parts of the five phases while others might go through all of them. For instance, since everyday purchases frequently happen quickly and may not involve an emotional investment from the buyer, a retail customer might not go through all five stages to determine which grocery store to shop from. When customers purchase a large item, such as a car or refrigerator, or a long-lasting service, such as tutoring or lawn care, they are more likely to go through all five stages.

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KOTLER'S 5 A'S OF THE CUSTOMER PATH STAGES

Kotler's customer path cycle's steps are described in more detail below:

AWARE

When a prospective customer first learns about a company, it is called the Aware stage of the customer route. Customers typically hear about a business through paid advertising or social media posts, though they may also discover it through a personal recommendation from a current or former customer. The potential consumer may not be prepared to buy at this point, but they are still interested in the goods or services the business provides.

For instance, a parent of a middle school student might start researching local tutoring services in case their child needs assistance with math later on in the school year. They might look at websites or social media feeds, read articles that list nearby tutoring services, or get suggestions from friends and relatives. Parents may become aware of a local tutoring service if it sends direct mail or sponsors school functions.

APPEAL

At this point, a potential consumer is aware of a brand's or business's advantages and finds it intriguing. The company might be added to the buyer's list of potential vendors if its marketing efforts or website are successful. They might visit the business' website during this time to learn about its many solutions, read reviews, and look for special offers or other discounts. For instance, a prospective consumer looking to purchase a new car might browse the online inventory of an auto dealer to learn what makes and models are offered by that dealer.

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Potential customers may also participate in free company activities like webinars or promotional events, depending on the industry. The parent of the middle school student may participate in free study skills webinars offered by the tutoring business in order to obtain resources and advice from company specialists. These actions could influence the prospective customer to have a favorable opinion of the business.

ASK

A prospective customer may then research the company's goods and services in order to contrast them with the alternatives they are considering. They might use the company's website's chat feature, call or email a sales representative, or both. The prospective customer is now interested in the particular attributes and advantages of the product they have contacted the business about. For instance, a parent looking for math assistance would question the sales representative of the tutoring organization about the credentials of their tutors, the format of the lessons, and any success guarantees the business might provide.

Additionally, prospective customers could assess the business and its offerings using outside sources. They might study testimonials on the websites of consumer advocacy organizations or launch a poll in a relevant social media group. For instance, a pet owner seeking boarding in a new city might join a social media community for dog owners there and inquire about a few nearby facilities. The objective is to learn more about their possibilities and reduce their list till they arrive at the best decision.

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ACT

The potential customer purchases something from the business at the Act stage. A single transaction for a product or a subscription model, where they pay a charge for a service they use repeatedly, may constitute this purchase. If the potential customer has already spoken to a salesperson, they may decide to close the deal over the phone. Even after speaking with a salesperson, some prospective consumers choose to make purchases online. They become the company's customers after making their purchases and receiving their goods or service.

ADVOCATE

Because of their purchasing experience, the consumer now acts as an evangelist for the business. They might share company content on social media, suggest the business to friends and family, and provide testimonials or user evaluations for the good or service. The customer may upgrade their service with the business or make further purchases depending on the product or service they purchased. For instance, a customer who purchased a fundamental lawn care service from a landscaping business can be so pleased with the service that they upgrade to a premium plan.

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THE BLUE OCEAN STRATEGY

The Blue Ocean Strategy seeks to extend the market and generate new demand while also pursuing originality and cost-cutting initiatives. The Blue Ocean Strategy may be viewed as the pacifism of the group because it is about developing and capturing the many strategic planning models that already exist.

Based on a book of the same name, this strategy contends that businesses should instead explore new market opportunities and ways to reinvent their industries because “When businesses compete with one other at such a high level, the only thing that emerges is a red ocean of rivals”. In other words, stay away from direct competition and concentrate on innovation.

A blue ocean strategy aims to help businesses identify and capitalize on “blue oceans” (uncompetitive, expanding industries) while avoiding “red oceans” (overdeveloped, saturated markets). A company could anticipate more growth, less competition, and more profits by operating in a “blue ocean” market.

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The traditional management practice that concentrates on numerical crunching and competitive benchmarking is changed by this strategic planning methodology. Key components of the Blue Ocean Strategy include:

- It goes beyond mere theory. Some approaches for strategic planning are based on assumptions that don't always work out when going to market. Contrarily, the Blue Ocean Strategy was the result of a study that examined business achievements and failures across more than 30 industries over the course of ten years. It is founded on empirical evidence rather than conjecture.

- The competition is unimportant. When you choose a blue ocean strategy, your objective isn't to outperform the competitors or dominate your sector. Instead, you want to create a new operating environment within the constraints of the sector, making the competition irrelevant.

- Low cost and differentiation are compatible. According to the Blue Ocean Strategy, customers are not required to pick between affordability and value. Differentiation and low cost can both be attained if a company can determine what consumers currently value and then rethink how to give that value. We call this "value innovation."

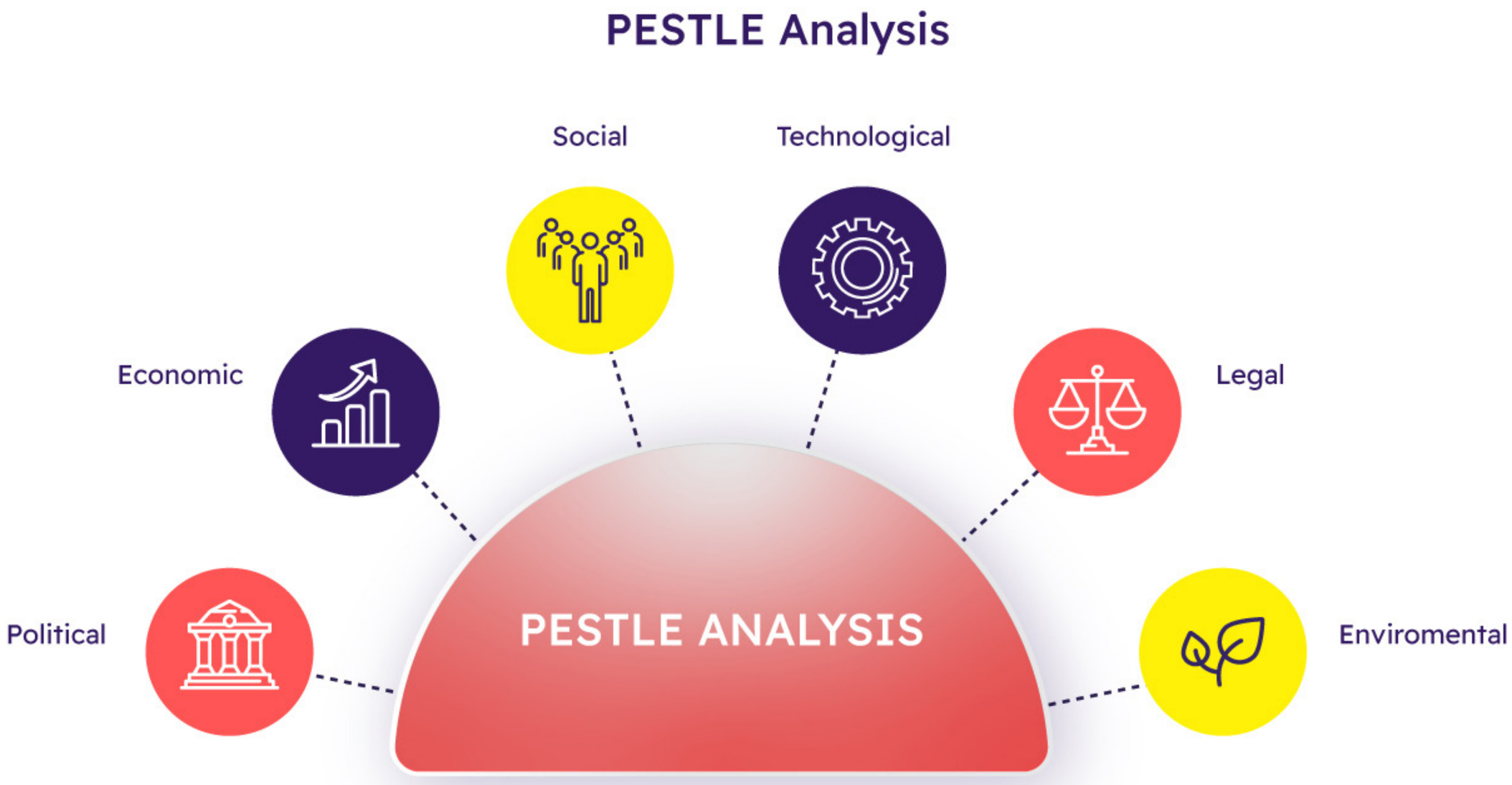
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- You have a structure in place to test ideas. The overall plan includes the Blue Ocean Idea Index, which enables businesses to assess an idea’s potential for economic success. By reducing risk in uncontested market space and identifying prospects with the most potential, this technique makes the competition unimportant and helps to improve ideasIt rests on the assumption that business structures and market boundaries can be shaped by the actions of existing firms.

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PESTLE ANALYSIS

A PESTLE study is a tool for obtaining a broad overview of the business environment. It enables a corporation to get a sense of the variables that could affect a new market or sector. Different types of firms will place a greater emphasis on various elements, and a PESTLE study will help identify risk factors for the SWOT analysis.



PESTLE ELEMENTS

- Political
- Economic
- Social
- Technological
- Legal
- Environmental

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Government regulations and sway over the economy or business are political factors. Governmental influences can include laws or economic plans. Numerous factors, such as the following, might have an impact on the industry due to the political climate:

- Trade tariffs
- Conflicts
- Taxation
- Fiscal policies

The long-term prospects in a market for a corporation are directly impacted by economic considerations. The supply and demand model may be impacted by the economic situation, which may also have an impact on how a company prices its products. Environmental aspects may consist of the following:

- Rate of inflation
- Available funds
- Rate of unemployment
- Rates of interest
- Exchange rates abroad
- Economic growth patterns

Social elements, including demographics and culture, which affect peak buying seasons, buying patterns, and lifestyle preferences, can have an effect on the business environment. Because culture and lifestyle can affect when and how individuals engage with products and services, society is crucial. Social factors may consist of the following:

- Ethics and Religion
- Consumer purchasing trends
- Demographics
- Health
- Attitudes and opinions
- Media
- Brand affinities
- Education

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A sector of the economy may be impacted by technological variables directly or indirectly. Although some industries will be more impacted by technology than others, technological advancements may have an impact on the market, consumer preferences, and purchasing power. Among the technological influences are:

- Automation
- Technological progress
- Patents
- Licensing
- Communication
- Computer technology
- Development and Research
- Technological savvy

Both a company's internal environment and its exterior environment may be impacted by legal factors. The legal and regulatory environment can have an impact on an industry's policies and practices, as well as control over employment, safety, and regulations. A legal consideration might be:

- Employment laws
- Consumer protection
- Regulations pertaining to the industry
- Governing bodies
- Environment-related laws

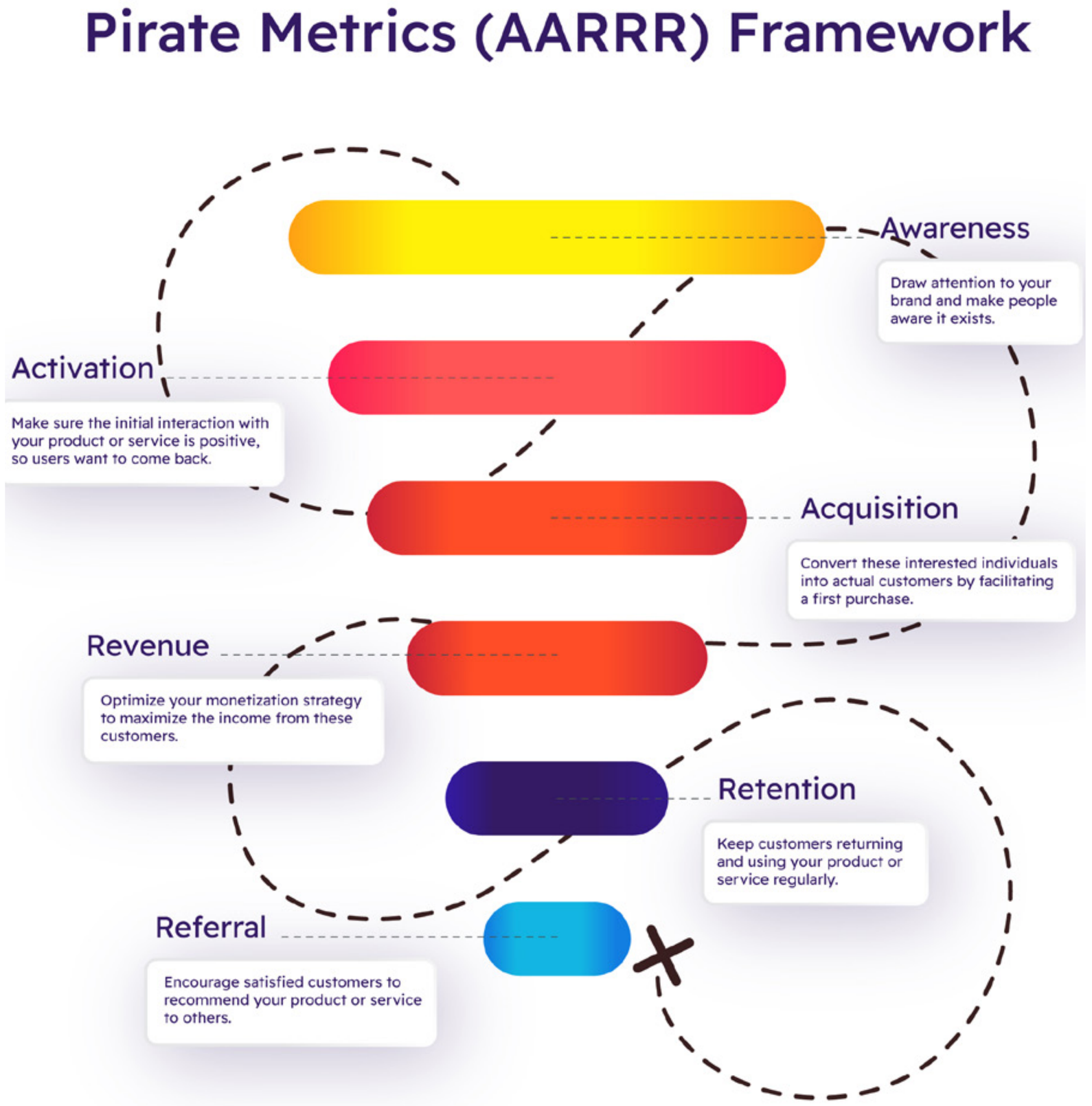
Environmental factors are all those that have to do with the physical environment and the general standards for environmental protection. Even if some businesses, like tourism, agriculture, or food production, place a greater emphasis on the environment than others, it is still necessary to be aware of how these issues may affect a variety of different industries. Environmental elements consist of:

- Climate
- Geographical location
- Consumer and stakeholder values
- Environmental offsets
- Weather
- Climate change globally

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PIRATE METRICS, AAARRR FRAMEWORK

Whether you’re in charge of business management or organization metrics, you are aware of the impact that meaningful data may have. It is possible to identify the aspects of your organization that are the strongest as well as those that require some fine-tuning by monitoring your success across key performance indicators. But how can you know which metrics are most important to you when key performance indicators appear different for every organization?



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It would be wise for the majority of organizations to set sail with Pirate Metrics, commonly known as AAARRR. Every business should utilize this collection of KPIs to assess its development and performance.

There are six metrics in the AAARRR framework:

- Awareness
- Activation
- Acquisition
- Revenue
- Retention
- Referral

AWARENESS

In the end, awareness measurements are what determine whether a potential lead will start the arduous process of becoming a lifelong customer, which is why it's critical to pay close attention to your brand's exposure and reach.
You're probably familiar with the proverb that states whether a tree makes a sound if it falls in a forest, but nobody is around to hear it. Do game-changing products or services that your company offers genuinely matter if no one can find them? Putting in the work and resources to build awareness and loyalty within your target demographic will set your company apart from the competition.

Building awareness can be started by creating a detailed marketing plan that details both your online and offline marketing initiatives. Social media, search engine optimization, email marketing, events, advertisements, and promotional materials are all great places to start spreading the word about your business. Keep in mind that individuals are more likely to buy from you if they are aware of your brand.

By monitoring awareness indicators, your company may learn more about how customers view your brand and which distribution methods work best for connecting with your target market.

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From there, you may refine your marketing strategies for the most impact.

Metrics for awareness include:

- **Website visits:** the number of daily, weekly, and monthly visitors to your website.

- **Click-through rate (CTR)** is the ratio of the number of individuals who notice a hyperlink to the number of people who click on it.

- **Impressions:** the total number of potential viewers of your content. Impressions suggest a possible reach.

- The number of individuals who saw your social media post in their feed, also known as “reach.”

- User-behavior metrics

- **Time on page:** how long visitors to a website typically stay on a particular page.

- **Bounce rate:** the proportion of site visitors who immediately leave.

- **Pages per session:** The typical number of pages that site users view before leaving.

- **Percentage of new vs. returning visitors:** This measure compares the proportion of new vs. returning visitors to your website.

- **Influencer engagement rate:** the proportion of followers of influencers who interact with the content of your brand.

- **Influencer share of voice:** The proportion of brand exposure on a given social media site that your brand receives in comparison to that of your rivals.

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- **Influencer cost per engagement (CPE):** The price paid to engage a single follower of an influencer.
- **Ad spends:** the total sum of money spent on advertising during a given time frame.

- **Ad click-through rate (CTR):** The percentage of viewers that click on an advertisement after seeing it is known as the

- **Cost per click (CPC):** The cost of acquiring a single click through an advertisement.

- Search engines, Google Analytics, your CMS, specific social media networks, and SEO tools like SEMrush are all resources you may use to uncover this information.

ACQUISITION

You can begin to consider how you drive potential customers along the sales funnel and make sure they become closed-won agreements if you have a clear idea of how the market perceives your company. Acquisition metrics become important in this situation.

You can tell whether your marketing methods are effective and bring in the proper customers by looking at your acquisition stats. One of the most crucial acquisition metrics you should monitor and assess is lead capture and conversion rates.

As we've previously discussed, having data-backed insights to support your instincts makes it a lot easier to determine the efficacy of your marketing activities. Acquisition metrics are a useful tool for gauging the efficacy of your marketing initiatives across many user bases and mediums. When you examine acquisition data, you can identify the campaigns that are generating the most leads while also identifying those that aren't.

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With useful acquisition data at your disposal, you can decide which initiatives should be given high priority and how to manage your marketing budget.

Among the acquisition metrics are the following:

- **Visit to lead conversion:** The percentage of site visitors who convert to leads

- **Contacts generated:** How many contacts you've made in a specific amount of time.

- **Leads generated:** the number of leads you've produced in a specific amount of time.

- **MQLs, SQLs, CQLs, and opportunities generated:** the number of opportunities, marketing qualified leads, sales qualified leads, and chat qualified leads you've generated in a specific time frame.

Social engagement rates

- **Shares:** how many shares you receive on a single post or across a platform.

- **Likes:** the quantity of "likes" or "favorites" you receive on a single post or overall.

- **Comments:** the number of comments you get on a particular post or overall.

- **Email click-through rate:** The percentage of recipients that opened an email and interacted with the link inside it.

- **Cost of acquisition:** The expense of obtaining a single customer.

- **Average deal cycle:** the amount of time it typically takes a prospect to go from their initial interaction with you to close the deal.

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Along with using platform-specific tools like your conversational marketing tool and social media sites, you can monitor these KPIs through your marketing automation and CRM platforms.

Since video gives viewers a chance to interact with your content and perhaps convert, it may also have an impact on acquisition metrics. However, video analytics is not just applicable to the acquisition stage.

ACTIVATION

This section is for SaaS companies that are committed to helping their customers make the most of what they have to offer. Activation metrics assist your company in determining how and where your customers are appreciating and benefiting from your solutions. It is a way to determine whether potential buyers are actively interacting with your product or service prior to making a purchase.

Making sure your customers can experience the advantages and value of your good or service and get actively involved with your brand is known as activating your customers. You can begin to understand which actions or engagements from your company are having the most effect on the customer experience by closely monitoring activation data.

Activating your customers raises the likelihood that they'll be content with your business to the point where they aren't looking for an alternative option, whether that entails changing the user interface or offering additional product walkthroughs at various phases of the buyer's journey.

On the other hand, failing to activate users will prompt them to swiftly look for help from someone else. After all, why would someone want to learn more if they don't immediately perceive the value in what you're offering? Look to activation numbers as a sign of how well you're connecting with your target users at every point of the buyer's journey to increase customer satisfaction and strengthen your bottom line.

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When it comes to SaaS offerings, where a customer can sign up for your service without speaking to sales, activation metrics are most useful.

Metrics for activation include:

- **Product qualified leads (PQLs):** This refers to the number of people who are using your product in a way that suggests they are prepared to upgrade or make a purchase.

- **Lead-to-sign-up conversion rate:** the percentage of leads that become customers.

- **Total sign-ups:** the total number of people who have signed up to utilize your product in a specific time frame.

- **Conversion rate from sign-up to PQL:** the proportion of sign-ups who later become PQLs.

- The average amount of time that elapses between a user signing up to utilize your product and fitting your definition of an active user.

You can track activation metrics both within your product and through your CRM.

REVENUE

Don’t get us wrong; having a large following on social media or a high NPS score are both excellent things to have to work in your favor. You are, however, in the business of making a profit at the end of the day. You naturally have the financial health of your company at the forefront of your mind, so revenue metrics are something you need to pay close attention to.

In the end, measuring revenue is what enables you to comprehend the profitability and monetary success of your company.

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By examining revenue by product or service, revenue growth rate, or overall organization revenue, revenue metrics give you concrete ways to achieve year-over-year growth.

Once more, qualitative information about a company's performance, such as social media followers and customer satisfaction ratings, can be compiled. However, revenue metrics are where you'll really be able to tell if your current marketing initiatives are paying off.

You can plan your budget and develop marketing strategies using data-driven decisions when you have a clear understanding of the financial performance of your goods or services. Your company's components, like resource allocation, pricing, and cost management, all require data-backed insights to be managed. You can eliminate the guesswork from these duties by using revenue metrics, which also make it simpler to set a clear course for yearly growth.

Revenue metrics include:

- **The average dollar amount** of your closed deals, or average deal size.

- **Monthly recurring revenue (MRR):** This refers to the amount of money you can anticipate making each month from both new and existing businesses.

- **Annual Recurring Revenue (ARR):** This term refers to the annual revenue that both new and current businesses can expect to generate.

- **Gross margin:** sales revenue cost minus the cost of goods sold

- **Gross profit:** The total revenue minus the cost of goods sold.

- **Net profit:** The sum of all revenues less all costs.

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- **Return on investment (ROI):** The return on investment, given as a percentage, which assesses the profitability of an investment.

- **Average order value (AOV):** The average value of an order placed by a consumer.

Your CRM and BI solutions can help you measure these metrics.

RETENTION

You've been doing this long enough to understand that a business involves more than just bringing in as many new customers as you can. Your ability to keep current consumers happy and coming back for more is equally crucial. Look to retention numbers to get a feel of how well you're serving your current customer.

Retention metrics let you understand how loyal of a customer base you've built up over the years. They also signify whether you're having problems turning one-time customers into life-long customers. You likely know that devoted customers are maybe the most important asset to your business. It's significantly more expensive to consistently recruit new customers than it is to retain old ones. Having a full picture of how well you're fulfilling existing customers is crucial to maximizing your ROI and keeping your business on the up and up.

When you're able to identify areas of improvement when it comes to retention, you can effectively raise customer loyalty AND attract new users by converting your existing customers into brand ambassadors. Retention metrics give insight into how your firm is functioning beyond the typical stages of the buyer's journey and highlight how you can keep returning consumers in your corner.

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Retention metrics include:

- **Customer lifetime value (CLV):** the average amount of revenue you receive per customer for the course of your interaction with them.
- **Retention rate:** the proportion of clients who remain with your business over a certain period of time; the inverse of turnover rate.
- **Churn rate:** how many customers your business loses in a certain time period.
- **Payback period:** how long it takes to repay the expense of gaining a customer.
- **Product usage:** how much and to what extent a consumer is utilizing your product. A high utilization rate is a sign of retention.
- **Customer satisfaction:** Do your clients feel that your product or service meets their demands in a satisfactory manner? Unhappy customers are more likely to leave your business.

Both your product and your CRM allow you to track retention KPIs.

REFERRAL

Let's speak about referral analytics while we're on the subject of converting customers into brand evangelists. Referral analytics track if current customers of your business are making the crucial transition from being merely consumers of your goods or services to ardent defenders of your organization. Referral stats show you whether your efforts at referral marketing are successful and assist you in identifying the customers who are most likely to recommend your company to their friends and family.

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You need to have efficient referral marketing techniques in place that motivate customers to spread the word about your brand if you want to enable year-over-year growth and maximize your ROI. Customers who hear about you from their loved ones or colleagues are statistically more likely to become repeat buyers. Naturally, your teams should place the highest importance on reaching this demographic.
While word-of-mouth advertising can still be effective, social media and other internet platforms have largely taken their place in today's digital world. The good news is that since the majority of interactions, engagements, and referrals occur on platforms that provide you access to useful data, referral metrics are now simpler to monitor.

For instance, it's simple to search Twitter for mentions of your company, examine that content, and determine which users are endorsing your company to their followers. The number of shares you receive might increase enormously when you provide incentives to devoted consumers to post their great experiences on their own social media networks.
Metrics for referrals include:

- **NPS score:** a measure of how likely it is that customers will suggest your good or service to others.

- **Social shares:** How frequently do your customers share your material on social media with their contacts?

- **Review counts:** the number of reviews you get over a specific period of time.

The volume of business that originates through referrals, typically through word of mouth.

- **Customer satisfaction:** If customers are happy, they are more inclined to tell others about your good or service.

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Through review sites and social platforms, you can gauge customer feedback and social media shares. NPS ratings and recommended business should be monitored in your CRM; however, doing so may call for a connection between your CRM and referral channels.

Overall, you will get a better understanding of the areas of your business that require the most attention if you divide your metrics into the pirate metrics categories. Companies can implement a growth marketing framework in this way.

The following metric categories are used in growth marketing to help you prioritize your resources and increase your results. Growth marketers execute trials using the scientific method after identifying the areas that need improvement to continuously improve their approach.

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THE HOOK MODEL

The framework was created by Nir Eyal, a professor at the Stanford Graduate School of Business and the founder of two well-known technology companies in the 2000s.

He claims that the Hook Model is the most straightforward way for companies to ultimately alter customers' behavior and foster regular routines centered around their products. The Hook Framework's central tenet is that companies should always discover methods to link a user's problem to their product, offering a solution frequently enough for it to become a habit.

As was previously said, businesses employ the four-phase hook structure to create habit-forming hook cycles. Without relying on expensive advertising or pushy marketing, this is where effective products achieve their ultimate goal of unprompted user engagement, drawing users back repeatedly.

THE HOOK MODEL: HOW DOES IT OPERATE?

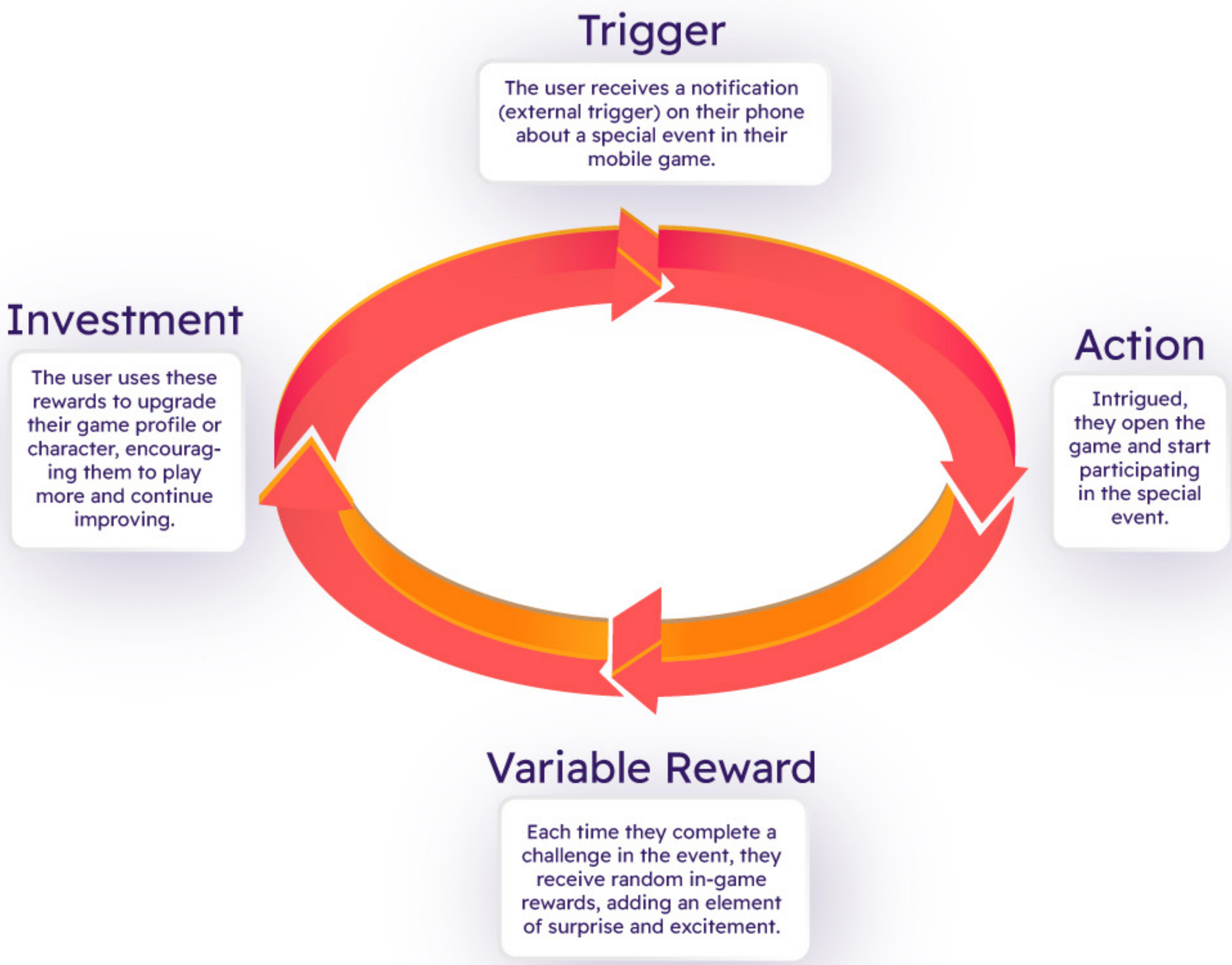
The four cycles of the Hook Model are as follows:

1. Trigger (External or Internal)
2. Action
3. Variable Reward
4. Investment

Habits are formed as a result of the customer's experience with these phases. After the cycle is finished, the customer's routines have been strengthened. Customers now place a higher value on the goods.

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The Hook Model: How it works?



This is how it works:

TRIGGER

The trigger acts as the behavior's spark plug or actuator. It can either be external or internal.

External triggers such as the app icon on a mobile device, an email, or a hyperlink on a website are examples of habit-forming technologies that begin by alerting consumers. Users develop associations with internal triggers as a result of the constant cycling of these hooks, which are subsequently linked to preexisting behaviors and emotions.

Users soon discover that every time they experience uncertainty, they become internally activated. The users' routine behaviors incorporate this internal trigger, which leads to the formation of habits.

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ACTION

The desired action happens after the trigger is engaged. Companies in this situation make use of the interplay of ability and incentive in people's behavior.

The action is frequently made as simple as feasible while simultaneously increasing the user's motivation in order to maximize the likelihood that the user will take the desired action.

The art of usability design is the primary focus of this stage of the Hook cycle. The intention is to guarantee that the user will behave as the design intends.

VARIABLE REWARDS

The ability to elicit 'wanting' in the consumer separates the Hook cycle from the Feedback loop significantly. Feedback loops are commonplace. The predicted ones, however, do not result in the desired action.

For more clarification, consider the following example: The user is not discouraged from repeatedly opening a refrigerator because of the expected response of the light going on when it is opened.

However, adding some variation, such as a surprise treat that shows up every time the fridge is opened, will pique the user's curiosity and cause them to keep opening the door. This explanation could teach us that one of the most effective strategies used by successful product or service organizations to attract customers is arranging variables in the form of varied rewards.

This kind of action is consistent with studies showing that dopamine levels rise when the brain anticipates a varied reward. Variability increases the impact, resulting in a frantic state and activation of the areas of the brain related to needs and desires.

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This is comparable to a number of well-known examples of lotteries and slot machines. But you might also notice that habit-forming technologies frequently use changing rewards from the quest.

INVESTMENT

The user is required to perform some work during this final stage of the Hook cycle. When it comes to designed behavior, this phase aims to achieve two things. The user's likelihood of performing another Hook cycle pass when faced with the following internal or external trigger is the first objective.

The second objective is to make the user pay once their brains are doped up from the prior phase's anticipation of a reward.

The user is typically asked for some combination of time, data, effort, social capital, or money as part of the investment.

The Hook cycle, however, differs significantly from a sales funnel with a predetermined ending. Consumers don't always pay during the investment phase and continue with their daily activities.

More specifically, it suggests a trigger action changeable reward that enhances the service going forward. This comes with personal rewards, and actions like inviting friends, expressing preferences, creating virtual assets, and picking up new features all help to make the service better for the user.

Each time a customer completes the Hook cycle, these investments are used to increase the appeal of the internal or external trigger, the simplicity of the action, and the excitement of the variable reward.

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STEPPS FRAMEWORK

We will examine the STEPPS framework in this section; it was developed by Jonah Berger, a marketing professor and a bestselling author. It is utilized in Viral marketing to assist you in creating messages that will turn your current members and followers into champions while inspiring new audiences to take action and convert. Any one of the phases in the framework can be used, but combining them all will have the most impact.

S- SOCIAL CURRENCY

Start by utilizing the idea of social currency if you want to convert your members into brand ambassadors and spread the word about the benefits of your organization. Humans are social animals, and we thrive on exchanging viewpoints and information that makes us unique.

Our members will share our content if we can give them the content they want to share. We trust our friends and coworkers a lot more than we trust brands, which is why this digital “word-of-mouth” sharing is so powerful.

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How then do you make use of the idea of social currency?

In 2 simple steps:

Ensure that your members feel welcome!

Spend some time with your staff and board exploring ideas for what you can produce and disseminate to give your members the impression that they are “insiders” with access to exclusive knowledge that others do not have. More members will want to share that status if we can help them feel informed and have access to in-demand information.
Highlight the uniqueness that exists inside your company
Spend some time coming up with ideas with your staff and board that will highlight the uniqueness of your company on the inside. What distinguishes your company from the competition in one specific way? What is surprising about it? What is interesting about it?

Show them rather than tell them!

Find the BEST, most effective technique to demonstrate to them. Don’t mention it to them.- If at all possible, use video to draw viewers in and make your point and value more compelling.

TRIGGERS AND EMOTIONS (T & E)

We’ve spoken about how you can use the idea of social currency to expand your association. Nevertheless, knowing how to use social currency to encourage users to share will not always be sufficient to make messages stand out. Triggers and emotions can be useful in this situation.

Any stimulus in your environment that conjures up memories of something else is referred to as a trigger. Triggers keep us talking and keep our products at the forefront of people’s minds. Even if people really enjoy your product and value, they won’t act if we can’t persuade them to think about us.

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What is a product's trigger, then? What element of the environment might serve to remind viewers of our partnership and the benefits you offer? Sure, you can send emails and promote on social media (and you should be doing all of that anyway), but how do you go above and beyond to stand out from everyone else who is doing the same thing? Spend some time discussing the following questions with your team and board:

- What environmental triggers can you name that are REGULAR and have something to do with your brand and value proposition?

- With the help of its Kit Kat and Coffee campaign, Kit Kat increased its sales from $300 million to $500 million. Customers would be encouraged to think of Kit Kat far more frequently than they did before by linking coffee and Kit Kat, not just because it sounded pleasant but also because drinking coffee is a common behavior. Create a list of all potential environmental triggers that could be connected to your brand and rank them according to frequency as you begin your brainstorming process. Can you develop a campaign or marketing around the trigger that occurs the most frequently?

- What triggers from the environment can you spot in your target audiences that relate to your brand and value proposition just as they're about to act?

- Make sure your environmental trigger can occur when your audience is about to perform the action you want them to. Consider using reusable grocery bags. A fantastic product that offers great value. How often do you forget your reusable shopping bag at home and recall it only while you are waiting in line to pay?

- Check your earlier list to see if any of the environmental triggers you listed as occurring frequently coincide with the times you want your audience to behave.

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Emotions - To help our members and supporters become advocates, we started looking at the STEPPS Framework, and the best way to accomplish that is to encourage them to share. Share our information and messages with others. Being able to leverage our present audiences to share and aid in our growth can be quite valuable if you work in marketing. Emotions enter into that situation. Simple enough: When we care, we share. We are more likely to interact with and share stuff that evokes strong emotions in us.

Therefore, don't only concentrate on the function. Concentrate on feeling when you're thinking about how to encourage your viewers to share your own ideas and material. Focusing on the three Whys is a terrific method to get at the underlying emotion. Ask Why at least three more times to get to the heart of why individuals would share.

It seems easy, doesn't it? Well, not all emotions will motivate people to communicate. It also has nothing to do with feeling good or bad. According to research, sharing is more closely associated with highly arousing emotions. Consider low-arousal feelings like contentment, peace, relaxation, and quiet as opposed to high-arousal emotions like humor, excitement, happiness, awe, or inspiration. All of these feelings are on the positive side of the emotional spectrum, but if your material makes people feel at ease and satisfied rather than thrilled, amazed, or amused, they are much less inclined to share it. Consider how you can make your material emotional but, more significantly, concentrate on triggers that elicit strong emotions if you're planning content that you want your audience to share in order to attract more viewers.

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PUBLIC AND PRACTICAL VALUE (P & P)

Let’s talk about social evidence. How frequently have you chosen to enter a restaurant in a new city because it was busy? You were not verbally informed about it, but you witnessed it. Social influence is all about the enormous impact that may be had when someone can be seen using your product.

It is wonderful when our audiences and members spread the word about our high value, but it is not always essential. People are equally as likely to use our services or publicly affiliate themselves with us if they witness others doing so.

Make it Public - Therefore, tactically, we need to make it incredibly simple to see our products’ value. What can we do to make it simple for those that interact with our members to see that they are using our services? Others will copy you if you make it simple to see. What can we offer or produce that will enable our current members to showcase their involvement with us? You will gain a lot from an hour of brainstorming with your team and discover the potential of public social proof.

Create and Share Content with Practical Value: Sharing material is often motivated by the need to find valuable knowledge. Associations are a wealth of useful knowledge. Spend some time and create a few helpful pieces of information that you can post on your social media platforms. Consider how you may utilize this to demonstrate the importance of your association’s or your membership’s knowledge. Just a heads up: reading time is limited, so concentrate on stuff that is simple to understand. Consider a list, a tip, or a brief email. Our viewers are more likely to share information if it is useful and practical.

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STORIES (S)

Stories and storytelling are last but certainly not least in the STEPPS paradigm. Content ought to be condensed into a narrative or story that is simple to understand. Making your products or brands an essential component of the narrative as well as the audience, increases the likelihood that the audience will remember your brand. Engaging stories also help brands stick in the memories of consumers.
After going through the entire STEPPS Framework. What's next?

Bring everything together.

If you already work in association marketing, you are aware that dialogue is based on stories. It's how we essentially sell without selling. However, most associations don't fully exploit the potential of narratives. Let's talk about how to use tales to our advantage and how to make the most of the STEPPS framework.

What message are we trying to convey? What main idea do we want our audience to remember? We can't just keep convincing people that joining our organization has fantastic benefits. While telling them a story that eventually meets their needs, we must entertain and engage them.

Spend some time considering how you might use the STEPPS framework to create tales that tie everything together and make use of the science behind why some organizations are effective at provoking conversation and sharing among their audiences and members.

Your audience's propensity to spread your message will increase dramatically if they get the impression that they are in on some insider knowledge. What is it about the surroundings that will cause your audience to think of you and take action?

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High-arousal emotions drive sharing much more than low-arousal emotions, and the more you care, the more you share.

Public - built for showing and fostering growth

How can you draw attention to practical value?

How can you tell a story that people will remember?

The framework’s six components don’t have to be covered in a single message. You may create an email campaign that focuses on feelings while also posting social media content with both practical and public value. Your marketing will be more effective at leveraging word-of-mouth, converting your current audiences and members into advocates, and expanding your organization if you can incorporate more of these elements into it.

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How to Boost Your Product's Virality with STEPPS?



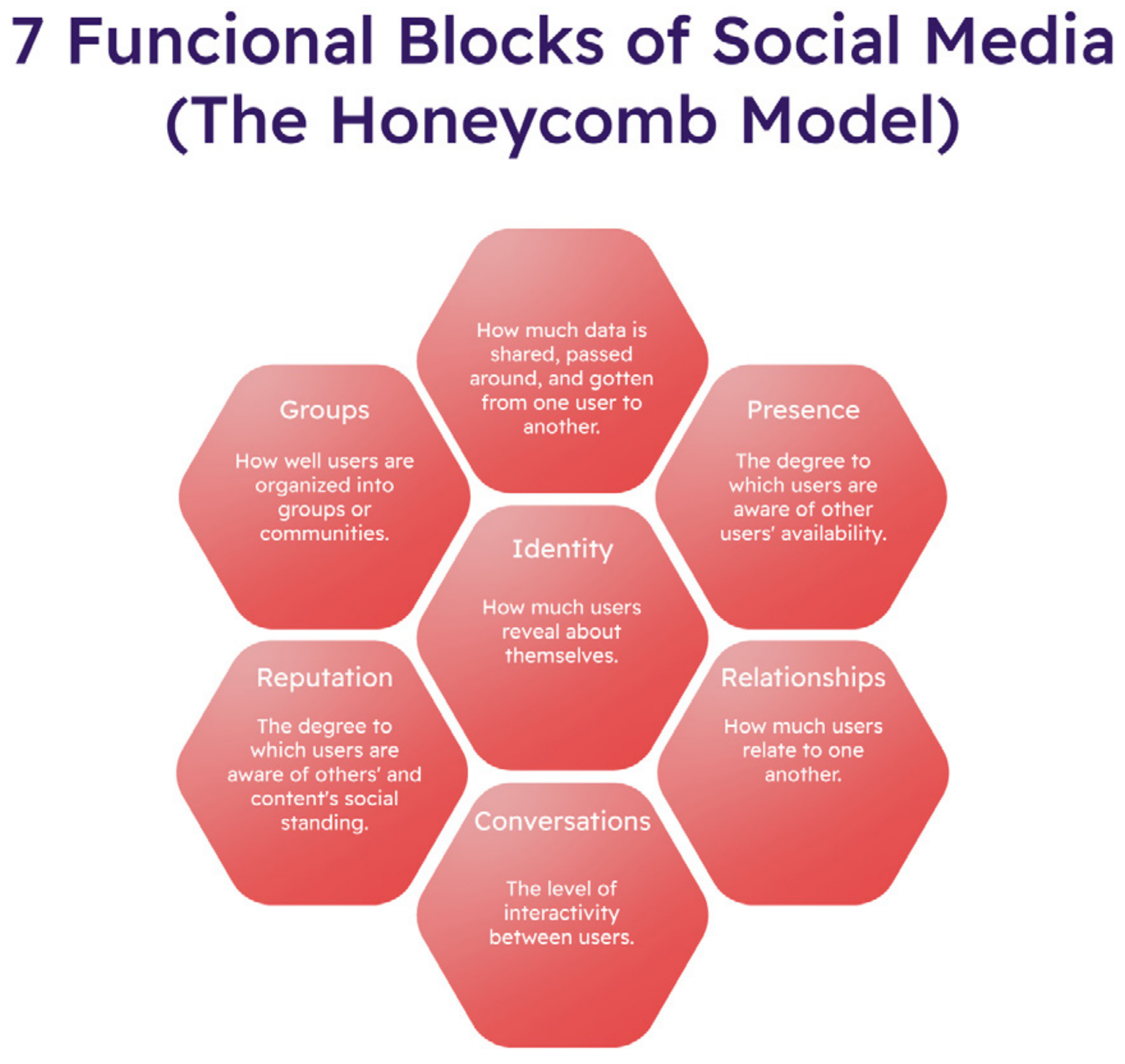
Eco-friendly Water Bottle Example



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THE HONEYCOMB MODEL

The Honeycomb model is a technique for outlining the key elements of the social media ecosystem, which all social media platforms, users, and advertisers operate inside. Here is a picture of the blocks in their honeycomb configuration.



It consists of seven blocks, each of which stands for a significant function of social interaction:

- **Sharing:** " How much data is shared, passed around, and gotten from one user to another."

- **Presence** - "The degree to which users are aware of other users' availability."

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- **Relationships** - “How much users relate to one another.”
- **Identity:** “How much users reveal about themselves.”
- **Conversations** - “The level of interactivity between users.”
- **Reputation** - “The degree to which users are aware of others’ and content’s social standing.”
- **Groups** - “ How well users are organized into groups or communities.”

To assist marketers in analyzing issues such as their social media operations, their audience, and the larger social media ecosystem in which they are operating, these seven blocks can be utilized separately or collectively.

Focusing on the most crucial aspects of how social media functions is the main way the honeycomb makes this possible. It can be used as a checklist of important strategic considerations that we can go through step-by-step when planning or evaluating. This method of structuring strategy meetings can help to guarantee that important areas are included in our assessments.

Therefore, if you were developing a social media master plan for a brand, you may ask questions such as, “How will we factor in our audience’s social media sharing habits?” and “What’s our plan for building our reputation on social?” By employing the honeycomb model in this manner, all the most crucial strategic ground is covered.

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SEVEN SOCIAL MEDIA HONEYCOMB COMPONENTS

Consider using the seven social media honeycomb-building pieces as a discussion starter during your social strategy meetings. Each one has the potential to start a variety of insightful discussions about social ecology and how your company fits into it.

However, to get you started, let's go through some instances of issues that are relevant to most organizations and Target Internet's marketer-centric descriptions of the honeycomb building blocks. These discussions should be tailored to your own brand and its circumstances.

IDENTITY

What personal information, such as name, age, gender, location, occupation, and education, do social media users reveal about themselves?
Because it is essential to how we target leads with advertising and outreach, user-provided information about their identity is crucial for social media marketing. A person is a high-potential lead for the brand to target if their social profile and/or activities indicate they have identity qualities A, B, and C.

Social media can shape a person's digital identity in addition to revealing aspects of their real-world identity. People of all ages use social media to influence how others perceive them, from kids texting friends on Instagram to business professionals posting information on LinkedIn.

Example questions:

- How closely does the identity that users present on social media match the identity that we may deduce from other sources of information?

- Should our plan change if it appears that there are glaring differences?

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- How should user data collection and processing be balanced against maintaining users' privacy?

How can social media material aid users in creating their offline and online personas?

CONVERSATIONS

How do users interact on social media? Understanding this is essential to developing a social media marketing approach that effectively contributes to user dialogues.
Social media is all about conversations, whether they take the form of comments, messages, or even likes and favorites. Social media marketers should aim to positively influence dialogues between users and their brand as well as amongst users themselves.

How much user conversation might be taking place through private social networks like Facebook Messenger or Twitter Direct Messages? These forms of communication are referred regarded as "dark social" by marketers, as in the hidden side of social media.

How should the company engage its consumers on social media? Which platforms should be utilized, and how will social media interactions for customer care be handled?
How will the brand maintain awareness of relevant public debates on social media? Managing PR threats and developing relevant social media content is made easier by keeping up with what people are saying about the company and its industry.

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SHARING

On what platforms do consumers distribute content? A significant component of what makes social media social is the sharing of videos, photographs, text, links, locations, events, and various other types of information.

Identity creation is one of the main motives behind content sharing. The likelihood of someone sharing something will be higher if they perceive it as strengthening their identity. Therefore, marketers must make sure that sharing and engaging with their content will help customers present themselves in the best possible light.
What can we learn from the content-sharing habits of our audience? What features do the materials they share have? What are the shared interests of the target market for the brand? If you can pinpoint these, you'll have a solid foundation for producing content that, from a business standpoint, is shared with the appropriate audiences.

PRESENCE

How much is a person or company active on social media, and how much are other users aware of this?

A user's presence can be made public on some social media sites. For instance, Facebook Pages automatically update with information about how long the page owner typically takes to react.

How a person's social media presence links to their presence in the real world is another facet of presence. The listing of brick-and-mortar business addresses and location-tagging are two examples of how this relationship is formed.

Example questions:

- How noticeable will our brand be on social media?
- Does this meet the expectations of the customer?

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- What information about their actual location are our customers sharing on social media?

- Could we include that data in our social media marketing plan?

RELATIONSHIPS

What ties social media users together, and how do these ties show up in their interactions on social media? Users of social media can be incredibly unrelated to each other by merely following each other's accounts, or they can be couples who communicate privately on social media and openly announce their relationship status or groups of friends who frequently utilize the group messaging and events capabilities.

B2C interactions on social media can also take many different shapes. Some users might "like" a company just to see its content in their feed, while others might utilize social messaging to contact customer support or even conduct business.

Example questions:

- How should our approach take into account how our customers interact with one another on social media?

- How would we like to interact with customers on social media and vice versa? The key is striking a balance between these two principles.

- What does a social media relationship's nature reveal about the chance that our aims will be achieved, e.g., how much more or less likely are our followers to share our material with people who they have a close relationship with?

- How does our interaction with a consumer on social media affect our relationship with them as a whole?

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REPUTATION

What can users discover about their own online reputation and the reputation of others?

Likes, blue ticks, connections, and follower counts are just a few of the many tools available on social media sites for measuring other people's reputations.

The fact that many social media users are adept at distinguishing between real signs of social repute and games driven by bots and manual manipulation throws a small curveball into this. Therefore, despite the fact that an account using interaction bots may have a better reputation score on reputation indicators like likes and comments, perceptive users may not think highly of it.

Example questions:

- What are the objectives for our company's customer reputation, as quantified by likes, follows, etc., as well as by how the brand is viewed? Which social media measures serve as the finest gauges of progress toward those objectives?

- How does the online reputation of our main rivals compare to our own? Do the discrepancies compare favorably to other performance indicators like market share?

- How does our share of voice (SOV) on social media impact our reputation?

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GROUPS

How do people create organizations and smaller communities using social media? Private social media channels are used by a larger percentage of social media users, and groups and other sub-communities are a key part of this secret, dark social community.

Some firms are better positioned to make use of this aspect of social media than others. While developing a community on social media may not come naturally to other firms, it is a valuable source of brand recognition and customer loyalty for the musician hiring site Last Minute Musicians.

Every group has a focal point, whether it is a shared need or interest. Marketers that can make their brand the focal point of an effective group gain the right to turn that group into a stand-alone marketing channel.

Example questions:

- In what social circles or sub-communities do our customers participate?

- Could a group serve as a useful marketing tool for our company? If that's the case, a community manager will need to oversee it.

IMPLEMENTING THE HONEYCOMB METHOD IN SMM

A honeycomb model is primarily a tool for comprehending social behavior. Beyond that, there isn't a prescribed way to use it, but we'd like to provide one idea that we've found to be effective: use the components of a honeycomb as a checklist to evaluate your social approach.

Go through each of the blocks and think about how your action relates to the social ecosystem when developing a new plan or evaluating a finished campaign.

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THE BULLSEYE MARKETING FRAMEWORK

The Bullseye Framework is a framework that enables you to focus on the marketing avenues that will result in long-term success for your company. It is the best way for a business entrepreneur to approach their growth marketing plan.

Developed by the astute team of Gabriel Weinberg and Justin Mares, the Bullseye's outer ring stands for all the potential development or traction channels you can use to expand your firm. Nineteen traction channels are present in the original structure. Customer interaction is included as a 20th channel in Growth Division since it is thought that the theory might use one tiny addition. The Bullseye Marketing Framework is explained here in brief:

The process of narrowing the selections to between 4 and 6 channels is represented by the center ring. These are the avenues for traction that you think could make a difference in the growth of your business during the next six months. Lastly, the bullseye is in the center circle! This is where you want to be, in case you haven't figured. You should include a channel in your long-term channel mix in the center circle once you've proven it to be a scalable route to market.

STEP 1: CONSIDER YOUR TARGET AUDIENCE

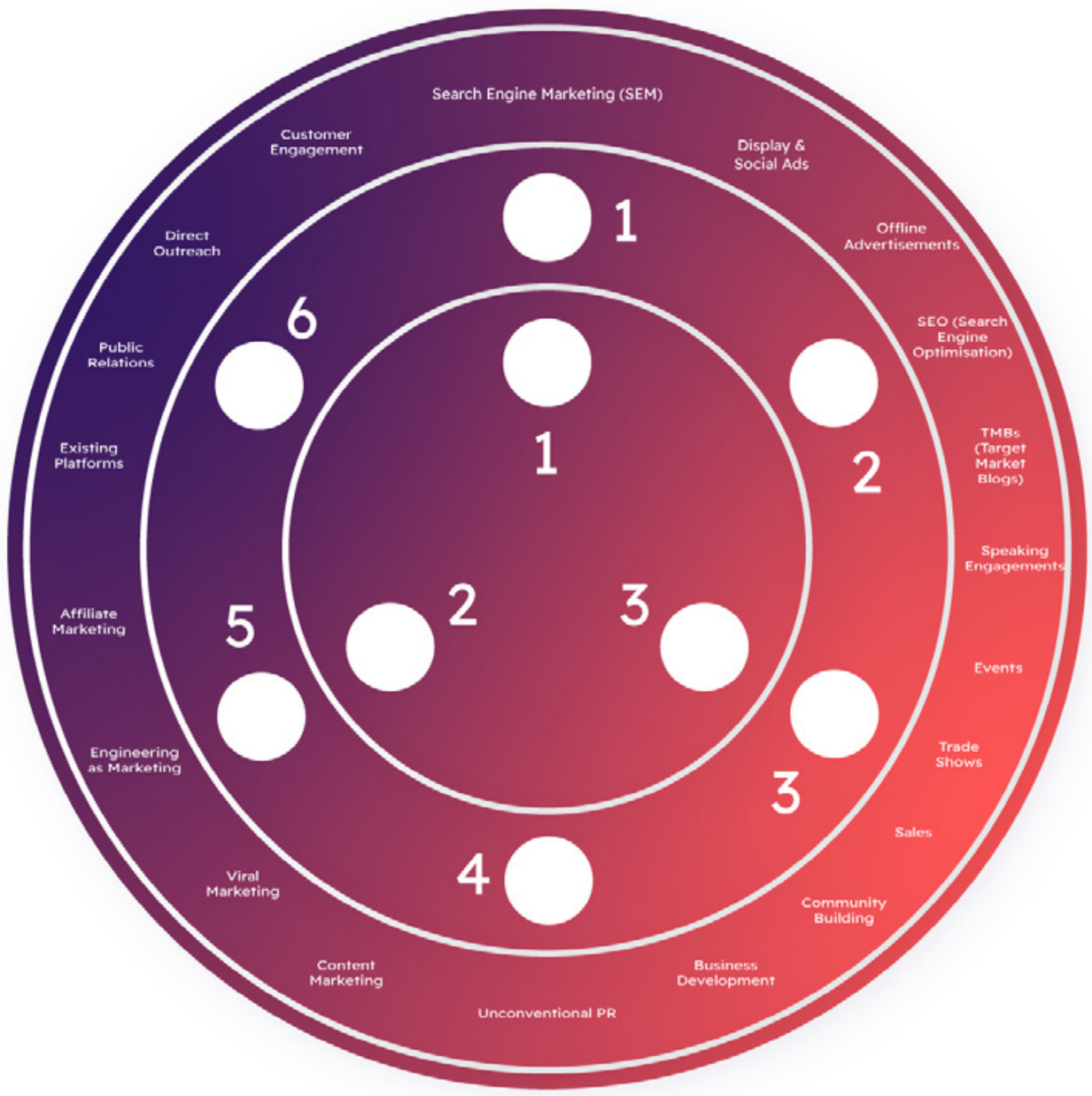
Being customer-focused is something we at Growth Division always emphasize. You must comprehend your target market before attempting to build your intermediate ring of prospective channels.

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Speaking of which, engage them! Talk to your pals who fit your persona in interviews, surveys, and other conversations. You should gather information (both qualitative and quantitative) to paint a picture of your ideal consumer persona. This should contain details about their demographics, location, problems, objectives, and any roadblocks. Before making a purchase, you should consider where the customer hangs out, gathers information, and conducts research. You'll have the skills necessary to accurately assess your traction channels thanks to all that schooling.

STEP 2: REVIEW THE TRACTION CHANNELS IN THE BULLSEYE FRAMEWORK.

Since the purpose of this section is to illustrate the Bullseye Marketing Framework, it would be helpful to examine each of the channels individually.



Keep in mind that the Bullseye Framework's goal is not to address all 20 traction channels at once. You can evaluate the available marketing possibilities, make strategic decisions, and then validate your choices utilizing the method of hypotheses and growth experiments.

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1. Search Engine Marketing (SEM)

SEM is paid search engine marketing, which includes Bing Ads, Google Ads and other search engine advertisements. People are much more likely to buy a solution when they seek solutions to specific problems they are having. High search volumes and little competition for particular keywords are favorable for the channel. It is a channel with a strong emphasis on data-based decisions that is extremely measurable and predictable. However, there is also room for originality when it comes to drafting the wording for your advertisements.

2. Display & Social Ads

On social media sites, social ads are paid advertisements. The Google Display Network (GDN) includes websites with display ads that are sponsored advertisements. These platforms' targeting capabilities allow you to precisely reach audiences with very specific demographics, which can be quite beneficial for generating top-of-funnel awareness and conversions. GDN works best as a play for raising awareness or for retargeting website visitors. To create a full-funnel growth engine, social and display ads are frequently combined with a lower-funnel SEM strategy.

3. Offline Advertisements

Advertisements on public transportation systems, large billboards, advertisements in magazines, fliers, and handwritten letters are just a few examples of offline media. If you have a large brand and want to increase awareness in a particular area or among a particular demographic, it can be a very effective form of advertising. Physical companies (like coffee shops) that want to promote in the neighborhood could be another use case.

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4. SEO (Search Engine Optimisation)

SEO is the method through which your website is made more visible in the results returned by search engines when users enter specific keyword queries. As you can expect, this can be a very technical channel and requires an organized strategy led by someone who is knowledgeable. Structure, on-site content, backlink profile, bounce rate, time on site, and social signals are just a few of the elements that search engines use to determine your website's ranking. You can start driving inexpensive, dependable, and relevant organic traffic to your website if you start checking these boxes. Working with Clade on their site's SEO was extremely successful for Growth Division. The medium to long-term benefits of SEO are enormous, but it can take some time to get started.

5. TMBs (Target Market Blogs)

This entails being cited on websites with substantial relevant traffic, particularly by having guest pieces published on them. This accomplishes three crucial things: first, it brings targeted visitors to your website; second, it establishes the author (and subsequently the business) as a thought leader; and third, it raises your domain authority through the backlink. It has a connection to digital PR and occasionally overlaps with it.

6. Content Marketing

The term "content marketing" can be used to describe a variety of material types, including blogs, videos, and infographics. A terrific channel, content can be used to educate prospects, increase conversions, and generate awareness across the whole marketing funnel. Additionally, it can help you with community outreach and SEO efforts.

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7. Speaking Engagements

In the context of startups, this channel is primarily B2B-focused; it focuses on getting team members to speak as guests at events or programs. Brand awareness can be greatly increased, and your founding teams can be recognized as pioneers in their fields.

8. Events

This was classified as “offline events” in the original Bullseye Marketing Framework but was changed to reflect today’s more digitally oriented society. Creating your own branded events for use as a touchpoint in the sales/marketing process is referred to as this channel. Events can be utilized as a conversion strategy farther down the funnel or as a top-of-funnel hook.

9. Trade Shows

Trade exhibitions in B2B marketing can be a great approach to reaching a highly relevant group of potential customers. You can gain from brand exposure, and if you send the correct staff to the event, you can spark some lively discussions that should result in a tonne of leads.

10. Community Building

Being the first thing people think of as a solution when they experience a problem can be accomplished by creating a community around the issue, your firm is fixing. A community can help you establish yourself as a reliable, go-to option. Creating a community can also be a successful strategy to test the market before launching a product, and when you do, use the community’s members as early adopters to sell to them. At Growth Division, we define organic social management as “community building” since an organic social presence that is well-maintained should resemble a community. Posting high-quality information to your audience on social media can help paid advertising or direct outreach very successfully.

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11. Affiliate Marketing

As you are enlisting other marketers to harness their audience and/or growth talents to make more sales, using affiliate partners can be a tremendously scalable and effective strategy to grow revenue. You provide an affiliate partner with a commission on each sale they make in exchange. It can be an extraordinarily powerful approach to scale swiftly for some B2C businesses.

12. Existing Platforms

The idea behind this slightly “out-there” development channel is to benefit from the traffic that other platforms generate by diverting it to your website. Utilizing Facebook or Slack group audiences or redirecting visitors from other websites and platforms are two ways to achieve this. Be cautious when organizing this growth marketing channel because it could be rather shady if not thoroughly thought out.

13. Engineering as Marketing

Building a tool to utilize as a sort of “product for prospects” is a favored channel for growth marketers. You may perceive a chance to provide people with an advantageous tool that allows you to obtain their email addresses so you may promote them. Calculators, pre-formatted spreadsheets, or improvised tools (using software like Outgrow) may be used for this. It can be profitable for B2B by creating tools that are free to collect leads or for B2C by creating quizzes or giving away “free” versions of the product.

14. Viral Marketing

A highly effective marketing channel for expanding your company is viral marketing in the B2C space or referral marketing in the B2B space. Using your present clientele and their social circles is a great way to drive targeted traffic. It’s one of the ways that, if implemented correctly, could lead to meteoric expansion.

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15. Sales

This marketing channel only targets businesses. Building a sales strategy and sales team to market your product can be quite successful, especially if the lead-generation process is well-oiled. Calling consumers directly on the phone is a salesperson's responsibility.

16. Business Development

Business development means forming alliances with other companies who are "fishing in the same (customer) pond" as you, to borrow the phrase of the Bullseye Framework. Because you have others recommending your company, partnerships have the potential to be incredibly scalable and inexpensive routes to market. Building a good collaboration, however, requires time, effort, and incentives that are in line. It is not as simple as it may seem.

17. Unconventional PR

This is about doing something a little "out there" to garner media publicity or attention, as you might infer from the name. Although it may not be the most repeatable tactic, it can nevertheless draw a lot of attention to you.

18. Public Relations

This relates to more traditional PR, in which your business seeks media attention at particular, targeted channels. This may be either paid-for or unpaid coverage. It can have a significant impact if you are strategic in your PR outreach and are able to gain visibility on a website that your target audience frequents.

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19. Direct outreach

A B2B growth channel, this is. If you have a properly targeted Customer Persona, it’s quite useful since you can gather very relevant information to reach out to. It’s one that Growth Division has had great success with for B2B firms, especially when coupled with community building, social media, and display marketing on LinkedIn.

20. Customer Engagement

This twenty-first channel is incorporated into the Bullseye Framework. This channel has a deeper funnel emphasis. The goal is to increase the lifetime value (LTV) of current customers by getting them to spend more or stay longer as customers. You may consistently re-engage and upsell customers by using email and notification mechanics.

Increasing LTV and lowering customer acquisition expenses are essential components of the growth marketer’s skill set, in our opinion.

STEP 3: MONITOR YOUR CUSTOMER ACQUISITION COST (CAC)

As soon as you have your center ring, you should start testing. But how can you tell what’s effective and what isn’t? Tracking customer acquisition costs, both overall and for specific channels, is a crucial component in determining the efficiency of traction channels.

It will let you know how effective a specific campaign is at bringing in new customers for the company.

BUT. And it’s a big but. It’s crucial that you avoid getting sucked into pitting channels against one another. The right combination of traction channels should support one another.

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Some channels, like SEM or direct outreach, will inevitably display a good CAC. The impact of your blogs, community development, or PR on the conversion rates from SEM and direct outreach, however, may not be evident in your data on that.

Therefore, before deciding what is working and what is not, it is crucial to treat each channel fairly and properly test it.

WHEN SHOULD YOU USE THE BULLSEYE FRAMEWORK?

The Bullseye Framework is a terrific tool for developing your initial growth marketing strategy, to put it briefly. As you travel from the outside circle into the center of the bullseye, it conceptualizes the process of constant testing and confirming your plan through time, which is crucial.

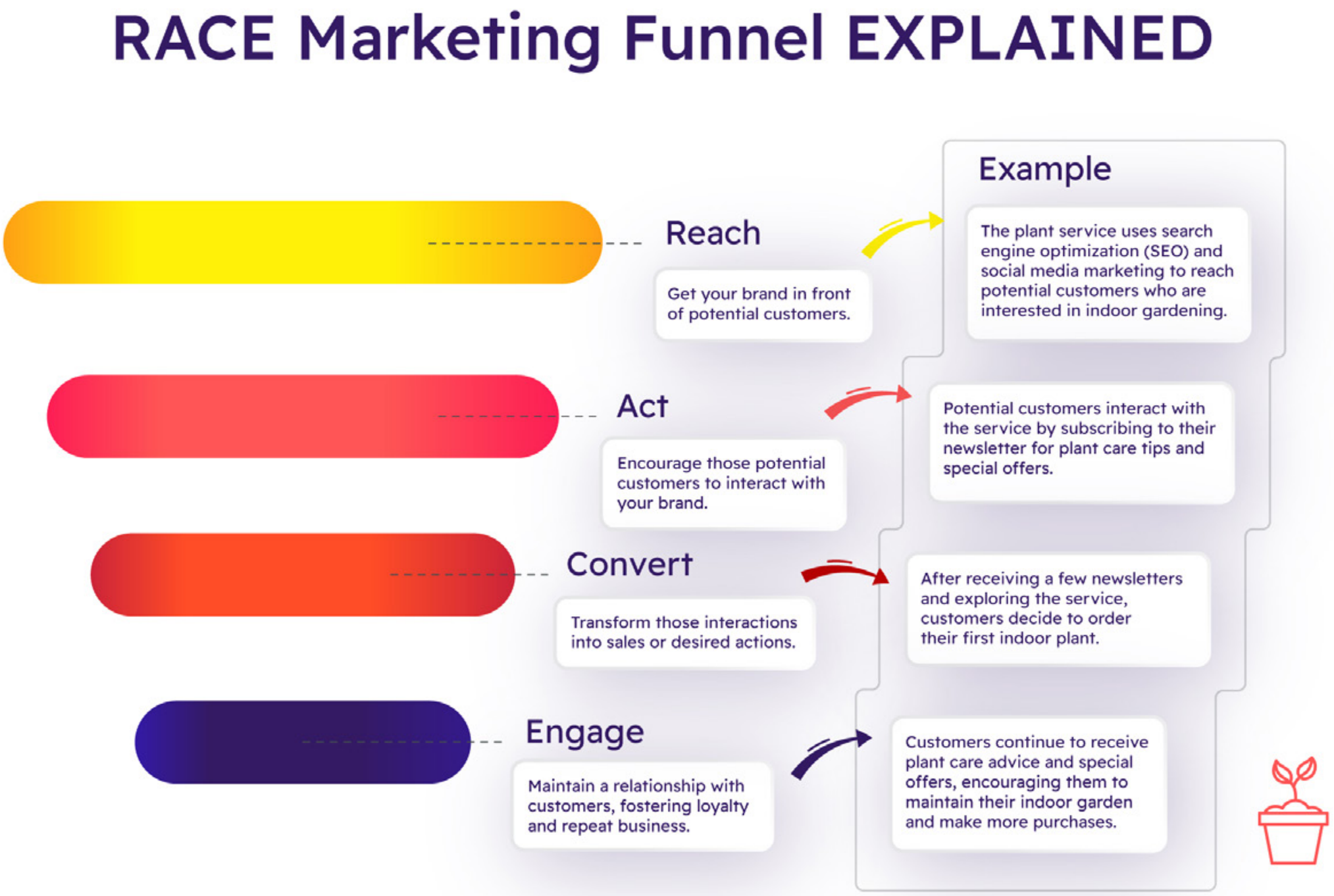
Your marketing strategy should not be something you do once and then stop attempting to prove it works. Similar to the Bullseye method, it must be used repeatedly. At various times as your firm grows, you will need to analyze and adjust your channel mix. Every six months, you should retake the Bullseye to keep your plan current and new.

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RACE MODEL

The RACE model is a framework for the strategic development of multichannel communication plans or digital marketing initiatives.

In order to foster relationships and boost customer loyalty, the model is divided into four stages, each of which is targeted at customers at a particular stage of the customer lifecycle.



It was developed by Dave Cheffey of Smart Insights to assist marketers in fusing digital marketing with more conventional marketing initiatives.

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WHAT DOES RACE STAND FOR?

The four phases of a marketing framework are grouped together under the name RACE. Reach, Act, Convert, and Engage are these phases.
Although each stage is a continuous process, they all have the same goal: to drive leads down the pipeline toward becoming supporters of your company or brand.
But there is a step that comes before all the others: planning.

PLAN

You must start your digital marketing approach with planning and goal-setting. The longer your plan is in place, the more likely it is to change, which is a good thing. However, when you first start out, you do want to make sure your goals are SMART.

If you’re unfamiliar with the term, SMART goals are ways to define measurable objectives for campaigns and projects that lay the groundwork for success.

REACH

In this stage of branding, called awareness, you concentrate on initiatives that will increase your target audience’s online visibility and, as a result, traffic to the numerous website portals (websites, microsites, or social media pages) that you have created. Reviewing media can be done from a bought, owned, or earned standpoint. From this, traffic-driving goals can be established.

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ACT

Act is short for interact, according to Smart InsightsAt this point in the RACE framework, you want your website's or social media page's visitors to engage with you in some way. Before bringing them to full conversion, this is the first level of involvement. This could involve providing contact information asking for a quote or further information (business-to-business), but it could also be as straightforward as learning more about a company or its products, looking for a product, subscribing to a newsletter, or reading a blog post. All of these actions fall under your conversion funnels' top-level goals in analytics. 'How do you begin the conversation and persuade them to give you their time - and occasionally their contact details' is a wonderful way to put this in your mind.

CONVERT

This entails persuading your visitors to take the crucial last action that converts them into paying customers, whether the payment is made through an offline channel (such as a potent business lead) or an online Ecommerce transaction. This is the last objective in your conversion funnel, and it's what ultimately determines how your online business model is funded. These initiatives will be driven by conversion-based objectives.

ENGAGE

In order to increase customer loyalty, you should concentrate on creating a long-term relationship with first-time purchasers. This should eventually encourage return business and perhaps advocacy. To increase customer lifetime value, a variety of communications can be employed both online and offline, including your website, social media sites, email, and other direct encounters. Interaction (such as shares on social media or interaction) and repeat sales percentage are the focus of objectives and KPIs. Customer satisfaction ratings are yet another metric that correlates with engagement.

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SHOULD YOU CHOOSE THE RACE MODEL?

The RACE model encourages you to set attainable targets and enables you to break down your digital marketing approach into manageable activities.

Because of this streamlining, it is simple to see where your plan is strong and where it is weak, allowing you to swiftly make adjustments and advance your overall strategy.

It’s crucial to keep track of all the adjustments you make so that you can evaluate your progress and change course if necessary.

The most important thing to keep in mind is that this isn’t a one-stop shop; like with any other model, it will require time and monitoring to see any meaningful results from it. However, the RACE framework is a quick and easy way to boost your ROI.

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LEAN CANVAS MODEL

One of the most crucial things you can do as an entrepreneur is to translate your idea(s) from your thoughts into a concrete form so that you may share it with others. This formerly typically meant a thorough business plan, which would take weeks or even months to produce.

Quickly developing potential business models, product launches, and marketing campaigns is made easier with Lean Canvas. The most significant feature of the tool is the ability to communicate models and ideas more effectively by using Lean Canvas as a visual guide.

Without a doubt, a well-researched business plan is vital, but only at the appropriate point of your company's development (often when you're in the growth or investment phases). The issue with business plans for startups and entrepreneurs is that they're a waste of time.

In this instance, the following quotation from Steve Blank best expresses the idea: "Business Plan: a document investors make you write, but they don't read."

The elimination of waste, which includes time, processes, inventories, and more, is a core tenet of the Lean methodology.

It's time to present Lean Canvas because, as a lean company, you need a speedier approach to get ideas out of your head, stay lean, and reduce waste.

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Lean Canvas uses the same nine building elements but with a few adjustments to make them more appropriate for a lean startup. The Lean Canvas is the ideal one-page format for outlining potential business models since the blocks lead you logically from your customers' concerns to your unfair advantage (typically the most challenging block to address).



EXPLORING THE 9 KEY COMPONENTS OF THE LEAN CANVAS

1. PROBLEM

Each customer segment (CS) you consider working with has a unique set of issues that require resolution. Try putting one to three of your company's most urgent issues in this box. You lack a product or service to offer if there is no problem to fix.

2. CUSTOMER SEGMENTS

The issue and customer segments can be seen as being inextricably linked; without considering a CS, you cannot consider their issues, and vice versa.

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3. UNIQUE VALUE PROPOSITION

The UVP is located in the center of the canvas. A value proposition is a declaration of expected benefits. It's the main reason a potential customer should work with you. Thinking about why you are unique and why your CS should buy from you or invest time in you will help you understand this. For more information, see Useful Value Proposition Examples (and How to Create a Good One).

4. SOLUTION

The golden egg is figuring out the problem's solution! You won't get this right now, but that's okay since that's what Lean is all about. The phrase "get out of the building" was invented by Steve Blanks, the inventor of the lean startup movement. And Blank is saying that the problem is not at your office; it is in the streets. So interview your target market, probe them, and apply what you discover. Keep in mind that the Build-Measure-Learn loop is how the Lean Startup validates learning.

5. CHANNELS

You can communicate with your CS using channels. And keep in mind that in the beginning, it's crucial to put learning first rather than scaling. Consider which channels will provide you with sufficient access to your computer system while also providing you with sufficient educational opportunities. You don't have to be present on every channel; you only need to be where your customers are. Channels can be email, social media, CPC advertisements, blogs, articles, trade events, radio & TV, webinars, etc.

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6. REVENUE STREAMS

Depending on the type of company model you have, how much you charge customers will vary, but it's extremely normal for startups to charge less or even give their products away for free in order to establish traction. However, there may be a few issues with this. The key is that it essentially postpones or evades validation. Asking someone to spend money is very different from getting them to sign up for something for free. The notion of perceived value is another.

7. COST STRUCTURE

List all the expenses involved in launching this firm in this section. How much will building/creating the landing page cost? What is your monthly operating expense total or burn rate? How much will the interview with your target market cost? What is the price of market research papers? Etc. A rough estimate of the break-even point can then be determined using these expenses and possible revenue streams.

8. KEY METRICS

Every company, regardless of size or industry, will utilize a few essential indicators to track performance. The simplest way to assist with this is to picture a funnel that flows from the wide open top through several stages to the narrow end, from top to bottom. The ARRRR (also known as Pirate Metrics) model by Dave McClure is a useful tool for this.

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9. UNFAIR ADVANTAGE

The hardest question to answer is this one. Try to keep this in mind, though, as having an unfair advantage might be helpful when looking for partners and investors. The best way to define unfair advantage is this, according to Jason Cohen: “ In order to succeed in business, you need an edge that can’t be replicated or purchased.” Insider knowledge, a dream team, receiving expert recommendations, current customers, etc., are examples of unfair advantages. Consider what you have that no one else can buy rather than adding something like “commitment and passion” as an unfair advantage (since it is not).

HOW TO FILL LEAN CANVAS?

Spending 15 to 20 minutes putting that thought on paper is the goal here. Some people enjoy projecting the PDF onto a wall so they may write their ideas in the boxes using sticky notes. However, you can directly draw your ideas for a business model into a notebook with the help of Lean Canvas. The important thing is to test now that you have your first Lean Canvas. It is advised that you test each iteration of the initial canvas and try as many as you can before deciding on a successful business plan. Seems like a lot of work? Indeed, it is. However, going through this process will help you save money, time, and effort. Consider this: creating a product or service that no one wants is the worst thing an entrepreneur could do!

It’s your responsibility as a business owner to put ideas down on paper so that others can see them and contribute to developing the problem solution. The traditional company plans to take too much time to produce and frequently lacks validated learning, making them irrelevant during the ideation stage. Business plans are better suitable for when you already have a customer and want to grow.

Use the Lean Canvas to capture your ideas during the brainstorming phase and apply lean principles to test your hypothesis outside the building.

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PRAGMATIC MARKETING FRAMEWORK

The pragmatic marketing framework serves as a common language and guide for all product teams in order to develop products that are both financially successful and customer-focused. It displays a product creation and selling roadmap within a doable timeframe.

In this framework, the marketing strategy is regularly assessed. Making sure the activity satisfies customer needs is the goal. A step-by-step breakdown of the pragmatic marketing process is provided below:

Market: The first step is to understand the problems of the market. To do this, it is necessary to determine urgent requirements and challenges by interviewing current and potential customers. The market enables marketers to comprehend the factors influencing consumer opinions and capitalize on a product's distinctive features to increase profitability. It also entails figuring out what the rivals are selling and analyzing their advantages and disadvantages. In order to best exploit the product, the market also comprises performing an analysis of the company's assets (technical assets, expertise, and patents).

Strategy: Product opportunities are mapped to determine target market segments in order to understand the market. Aligning distribution channels with the preferences of the market is another aspect of this stage. In addition to the target market for the products, the goal is to establish a portfolio of all the goods that the company will sell. A product roadmap is then developed to specify the key outputs that should be anticipated from the product creation process.

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Business: This step entails creating a business plan and pricing techniques, which aid in establishing a market investigation that is unbiased. Additionally, a profitability analysis of the product is performed. Its objectives are to assess and track the product's overall performance on the market and to guarantee the product team's innovation throughout the product development process.

Planning: Planning describes a product's functioning and various aspects during the purchasing process. That entails gathering information and summarising the target market's purchasing process. In this step, the buyer and user personas are also defined. These are members of the target market who exhibit the ideal customer traits for a given good. Programs: The program's step entails creating a marketing strategy to use communication tactics to spread awareness of the impending products. It also involves initiatives for both customer acquisition and customer retention. To ensure that people buy the product and stay loyal to it in the future, schedules and budgets are made.

Readiness: The major goal is to define the organization's selling procedures by learning how its target market prefers to purchase its goods. This entails creating tools that the sales staff can employ at different points in the sales process. The sales force can deliver programs to promote the goods with the support of readiness, finally.

Support: The last step is creating presentations and demos that are uniform and can be used in multiple marketing campaigns. The event support component of this phase also offers information about the market for events like webinars, trade exhibitions, and conferences.

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JOBS-TO-BE-DONE: A FRAME-WORK FOR CUSTOMER NEEDS

Imagine if your company's R&D managers, marketers, strategists, and developers all had a clear knowledge of what a need is and which unmet consumer needs exist. This level of synergy and focus changes everything. The question now is how to get there.

Consumers have no interest in buying quarter-inch drills. All they want is a quarter-inch hole! People buy products and services in order to achieve goals.

There is a lot more to the Jobs-to-be-Done Theory than just these basic concepts, though. The consequences of this idea are ground-breaking.

A framework for defining, classifying, capturing, and organizing all of your customers' needs is provided by the jobs-to-be-done theory.

Using this framework, a comprehensive set of need statements may be acquired in days rather than months, and the statements themselves can be used for years rather than quickly becoming obsolete.

Obviously, the fundamental benefit of implementing Jobs's Theory is lost if you are not using it as the foundation for a needs framework.

Misalignment with client needs has been the primary cause of unsuccessful products and services throughout history. It's not shocking at all, given that 95 percent of product teams can't agree on what a customer's "need" actually is. Applying

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this needs framework, product teams can learn more about the problems their customers are trying to solve and the metrics they use to evaluate progress.

When a product team is well-versed in consumer wants and needs, they are better equipped to do the following:

- Identify the unfulfilled needs.
- Identify customer segments with certain unmet needs
- Systematically develop ground-breaking goods
- Foresee which novel ideas and products will succeed in the market.
- Coordinate marketing, development, and R&D activities to plan the methodical generation of customer value.

In order to make the innovation process predictable, organizations can use the Jobs-to-be-Done Needs Framework, which is described in greater depth below, to identify the five distinct categories of jobs that they are trying to accomplish, the three distinct types of external customers they serve, and the types of inputs that are required. These are the foundational steps in creating an outcome-oriented innovation approach.

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WHO ARE YOUR CUSTOMERS?

A corporation must first define all of its consumers before it can define all of its wants. While a B2C company would find this to be an easy task, many B2B companies find it difficult. We have done extensive research for our consulting work and have come to the conclusion that there are three general categories in which a company's customers can be placed.

- **The job executor:** This is the individual who uses the product to do the primary task.

- The product lifecycle support team is made up of several teams of individuals who provide support for the product over the course of its existence. This includes those who handle the product's installation, transportation, maintenance, upkeep, upgrading, or disposal. They carry out tasks involving the supply chain.

- **The buyer:** this individual is in charge of choosing a financial purchase.

Manufacturers of toothbrushes will find that consumers play all three roles: they buy the product, use it, and advocate for it. This scenario frequently occurs in B2C marketplaces.

Conversely, if your company sells surgical medical equipment, the surgeon will be in charge of carrying out the job. Nurses, biomedical professionals, and others may be on the product lifecycle support team, and a buying group in hospital administration is usually the buyer. The B2B industry is accustomed to this level of complexity.

The customer kinds fit neatly into these three groups, despite the fact that there are many other options. The Jobs-to-be-Done Needs Framework is built on their foundation.
This classification is useful since each sort of consumer has a unique set of requirements.

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WHAT TYPES OF JOBS ARE THEY GETTING DONE?

The five different types of tasks that the job executor, the product lifecycle support team, and the buyer are attempting to complete are identified by the Jobs-to-be-Done Needs Framework.

The task executor is attempting to complete three different tasks:

- **The core functional job:** is the fundamental task that the job executor is attempting to complete in a specific circumstance. It serves as the center of attention for defining and sustaining markets. Core functional tasks include things like fixing a rotator cuff, teaching kids life lessons, and defending against cyberattacks. Any product's objective is to assist in performing a key functional task more effectively and affordably than competing options.

- **Related jobs:** These are extra functional tasks that the job executor is attempting to complete either before, during, or after the core job execution. With knowledge of these connected tasks and which, if any, are unmet needs, a business can provide solutions that assist its customers in completing a variety of tasks, increasing the value of their purchase.

- **Emotional jobs:** These are declarations that describe how the person carrying out the core functional job wants to be seen or feels. This classification includes positions in social sectors. These suggestions are helpful in developing a value proposition that includes both practical and emotive elements that resonate powerfully with customers.

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- **Consumption chain jobs:** The team providing assistance for the product lifecycle is working to complete a variety of tasks. These tasks affect the customer experience and include product installation, setup, storage, transportation, maintenance, repair, cleaning, updating, and disposal. Depending on the type of offering being evaluated, such as hardware, software, services, and consumable offers, different sorts of consumption chain tasks must be taken into account in a market.

- **The purchase decision job:** This is the job that the purchase decision maker executes using a financial lens to determine which product or service to purchase. Here, we want to know whether financial and/or performance parameters were taken into account when choosing the product to buy. The so-called desired financial outcomes are these indicators.

THE CUSTOMER'S DESIRED OUTCOMES

The strength of the jobs theory is that the anchor point for "where" to produce value is the work that has to be done for the customer. Even though it is helpful, that anchor point does not provide adequate guidance on "how" to succeed in a market. A person's struggle to "manage their monthly spending," for instance, does not tell us just what aspect of their employment they are having trouble with.

A business must be able to identify the customer's "needs" related to completing the task at hand in order to develop a thorough understanding of the job at hand.

Customer needs can be identified when viewing a market through a jobs-to-be-done lens by investigating the customer's primary functional task as a process. According to the 2008 Harvard Business Review article The Customer-Centered Innovation Map, the core functional job can be tactically divided into phases using a job map.

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As they attempt to complete each task in the job, businesses may then utilize the work map to identify the criteria customers use to gauge success. These measures, which we refer to as “desired outcomes,” make innovation more predictable.

A desired outcome statement is a specially crafted need statement that has a special set of characteristics: desired outcomes are tied to the underlying process (or job) the customer is trying to complete, are devoid of solutions, stable over time, measurable, controllable, and structured for reliable prioritization in a quantitative customer survey.

People often use 50–150 outcomes to assess a core functional job’s performance and 10–30 outcomes for each relevant consumption chain position. These are the components that work together to make innovation predictable.

WHAT ARE THE IMPLICATIONS?

An organized roadmap for traversing the intricacy needed to comprehend all the needs in a market is the Jobs-to-be-Done Needs Framework. This framework indicates what inputs are required, how they should be classified and organized, why they should be gathered, and how they should be used, taking into account the deluge of consumer data that businesses assess every day.

Without these crucial perceptions, innovation is still a game of chance, and product teams are forced to make educated guesses about the optimal course of action. Having the appropriate inputs has a profound impact. It transforms how goods are developed, evaluated, produced, advertised, and sold.

The Jobs-to-be-Done Needs Framework offers order to a practice that has previously been unorganized and chaotic.

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FLYWHEEL MODEL

In case you haven’t come across this model before, it has been described as the alternative to the sales funnel. The Flywheel Model is an alternative to the traditional sales funnel, which places less emphasis on customer satisfaction but more on generating leads through word-of-mouth and repeat business.

THE FLYWHEEL MARKETING MODEL’S BENEFITS

If you work in marketing, you likely have a thorough understanding of the marketing and sales process (sometimes known as a “funnel”). Conversion funnels are simply the means through which potential consumers are turned into actual ones. Ultimately, the end! In this context, the focus is rarely on what comes next. Fortunately, this is where the Flywheel Model can help!

The fact that the Flywheel Model encourages the continuous improvement of the customer experience even after the consumer has become a paying one is one of its most significant benefits. Take care of them from the minute they sign up for your product or service all the way up to the point where they become brand ambassadors and subject matter experts.

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THE VARIOUS COMPONENTS AND ADVANTAGES OF THE FLYWHEEL MODEL

The client is at the centre of the Flywheel Model, which shows how they are propelled to become brand advocates through the many areas of focus.

Problems in marketing, sales, and customer service can be quickly pinpointed with this model. You can identify the specific actions that are either increasing your forward momentum (the former) or slowing you down (the latter), allowing you to adjust your course accordingly.

Finally, the model describes how satisfied customers affect your marketing efforts. In a nutshell, satisfied consumers lead to increased sales.

The following are some suggestions for optimising your use of the Flywheel Model to provide an excellent service to your customers.

5 WAYS TO USE FLYWHEEL MARKETING MODEL TO DELIVER BETTER CUSTOMER EXPERIENCES

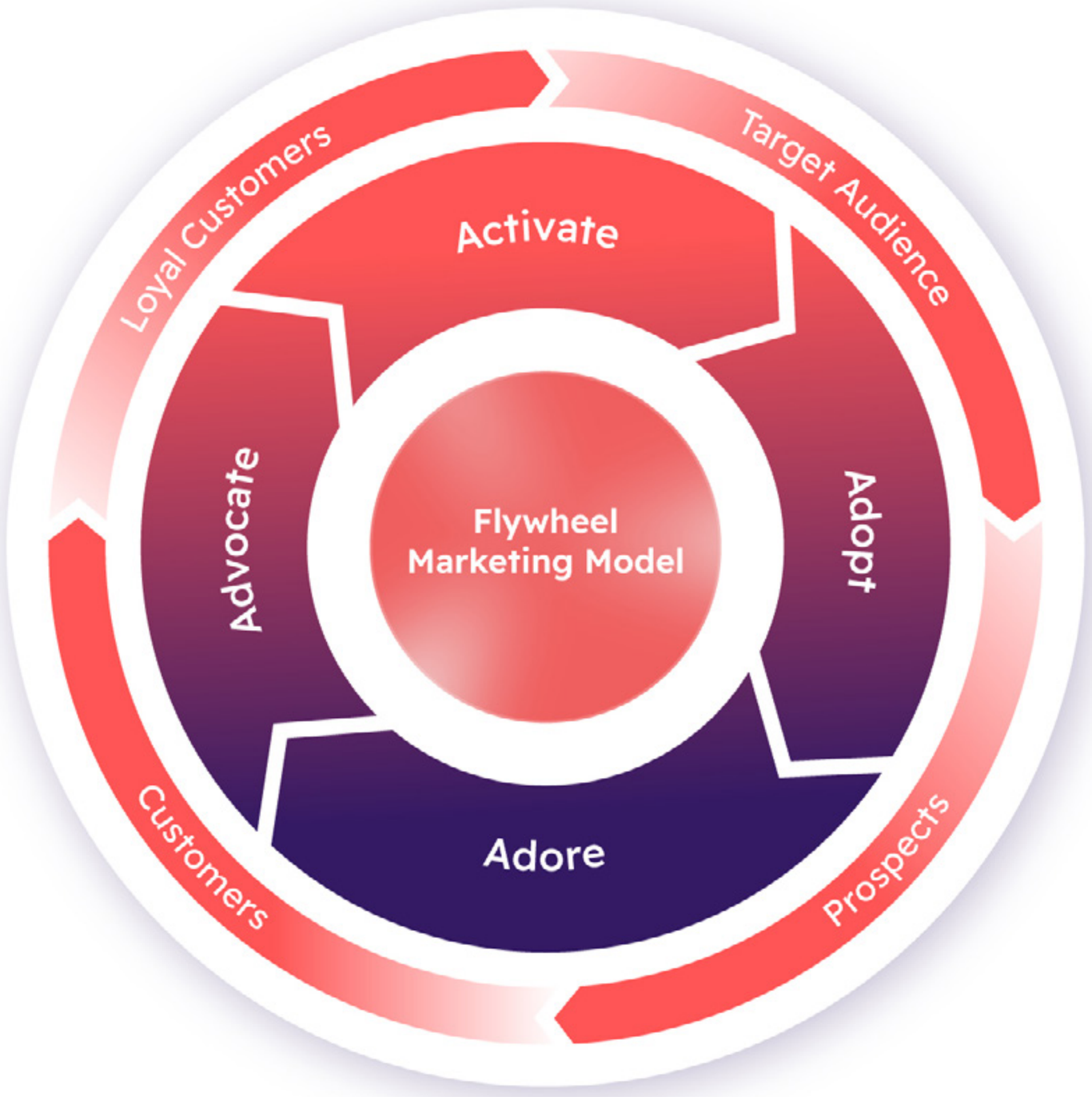
If you've come to the conclusion that your company must make the transition, one of your top priorities should be to prepare for the challenges that you'll face. Fortunately, you probably already own the materials necessary to construct your own flywheel, allowing your business to flourish. It's easy to get started with the flywheel; just return to the funnel and double-check which pieces belong in the stage.

Below, we'll go through some of the key actions you can do to maximise your customers' satisfaction by employing the Flywheel Model.

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STEP 1: REFRESH YOUR KNOWLEDGE OF FLYWHEEL PHASES

The stages of your flywheel must be assembled, of course. One or two variants of this have been observed.
The customer journey and key focal areas that help move customers forward are especially well-depicted in Appcue's version of the Flywheel Model. Here are four basic stages you may incorporate in your Flywheel Model using their model as a guide.



Stage 1: Activate

At this point, your goal should be to help the non-users (or Evaluators) transition into the new users (or Beginners).
At this point, it's all about selling your potential customers on your product or service. One effective method is to launch a high-converting website where you can demonstrate your knowledge, provide product examples, and offer valuable advice and support to potential customers. Offering free trials or permanently free tiers of service are two other options.

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Stage 2: Adopt

In the Adopt phase, you're working on strategies to keep new users engaged and make your product the first thing they think of whenever they have a need to accomplish a certain activity.

At this point, it's important to work towards turning Newcomers into Regulars, who have mastered the basics of your offering and are actively seeking out more ways in which you can add value to their lives.

In order to attract new customers and keep them as repeat buyers, you need to think of creative ways to make them feel like your product is the solution to a problem they have. Here are some potential approaches:

- Hold in-depth demonstrations and training sessions
- Feature any unique or underappreciated components

Stage 3: Adore

Adore is the stepping stone between the Regulars and Champions, the people who utilise your product or service on a regular basis because they enjoy it so much.
That it's simpler to keep existing consumers than to get new ones is a theme that resonates well with this stage.
Some examples of how to make your product irresistible to consumers are as follows:

- Publish useful information and accounts of your progress.

- Make use of surveys and comment boxes to learn what improvements your consumers would want to see made.

- Convince clients that the premium package is worth the extra money.

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Stage 4: Advocate

In this final phase, Champions play a key role in acquiring new clients by spreading the word and recruiting others from their personal networks to become Evaluators.

Testimonials, reviews, and UGC are frequently used at this point. You can also run affiliate programmes, reward schemes, and similar initiatives to encourage customer advocacy of your product(s).

STEP 2: ESTABLISH APPROPRIATE FLYWHEEL METRICS

Now that you know where to put your efforts, create measurements and targets for each phase of the flywheel.

The same model used above should have the following metrics tracked at each stage:

- **Activate:** fresh trial sign-ups, monthly first sales, or product-qualified leads.

- **Adopt:** how many customers have realised value (as a percentage of all new customers); how many customers have successfully completed onboarding.

- **Adore:** retention rates; average revenue per user (ARPU); lifetime value (LV).

- **Advocate:** joining an affiliate programme; obtaining new leads from existing clients.

STEP 3: DETERMINE WHERE YOUR FLYWHEEL IS SLIPPING AND FIX IT

Once your key performance indicators have been established, you may focus on fixing the potential sticking points.

Investigate potential bottlenecks that could slow down your lead generation, client retention, and customer churn rates.

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STEP 4: TESTS AND EXPERIMENTS WITH CRO'S

Your company's conversion rate optimisation efforts will never be complete. There are only a few core components that make up this work, so you'll be checking in on them frequently to see how they're holding up and making adjustments as necessary.

Create a variety of CRO tests and do so frequently; make this a standard operating procedure for your company. Find out which strategies work best to bring in new business, retain existing clients, and get satisfied clients to do things like make recommendations and provide testimonials.
Focus your attention on the key performance indicators and potential sources of friction that you identified in earlier evaluations by referring back to the stages of your flywheel. Try out new approaches and strategies to see if you can boost performance at each step.

STEP 5: MONITOR AND ASSESS PERFORMANCE

Just like you would monitor and assess your standard marketing and sales funnel, you should do the same with your Flywheel Model. Check in on the goals and KPIs you established at the outset of your campaign(s) and make adjustments as needed.

When compared to the marketing and sales funnel, the Flywheel Model has the advantage of ensuring that your business's wheel - acquiring consumers, maintaining relationships with them, and inspiring word-of-mouth - adds momentum and drives steady conversions.

Given the importance of maintaining forward motion, a simple indicator of whether or not your efforts are bearing fruit and your growth rate is higher than average is a must. Check up-sells and cross-sells, monitor client satisfaction, and look for potential weak spots in your organisation.

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SERVQUAL MODEL OF SERVICE QUALITY

HISTORY OF THE SERVQUAL MODEL

On the basis of the expectation-perception gap model, it can be argued that the SERVQUAL Model originated from a study conducted in 1985 by Parasuraman, Zeitham, and Berry when Managers in the banking sector started facing increased pressure to show that their services are client-focused and that ongoing performance improvement is being carried out.

Given the financial and resource constraints that banks must manage, it became crucial that customer satisfaction be appropriately fulfilled and monitored and that any gaps in service quality are identified from consumer satisfaction.

This model, therefore, help managers prioritize the service quality gaps to address in light of limited resources and identify cost-effective solutions to close those gaps. The SERVQUAL Model, which is a well-liked model for studying the quality of services, is frequently used in marketing research as well as in other fields, including hospitality and business.

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SERVQUAL MODEL OF SERVICE QUALITY AND IT'S SHORTCOMINGS

This framework can be used to identify issues with the service and find solutions. In that regard, it is a "GAP Analysis." It contrasts the service quality that was actually received with the service quality that was anticipated.

The customer's perceptions are used to gauge this experience. It is an evaluation of customer needs from the outside in light of the level of service received. As a result, the emphasis is always placed on the demands of the customer rather than the organization's view of the measuring system.

Additionally, the discrepancy between customer expectations and the actual service they receive must be considered when identifying their demands.

EXPECTANCY PATTERN

The expected pattern of service quality, or the gap between expectations and perception, lies at the heart of the SERVQUAL Model of Service Quality. The difference (the gap) between what was anticipated and what was actually experienced is a sign of quality differences.

Organizations can use the SERVQUAL Model to identify the elements that influence how the customer's expectancy pattern is created. In this way, the business can develop and plan ahead to account for this anticipation pattern.

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THE SERVQUAL MODEL OF SERVICE QUALITY DIMENSIONS

A telecommunications firm, a bank, and a maintenance company were the only ones whose services were the subject of the initial research conducted in accordance with the SERVQUAL Model of Service Quality. The aforementioned study polled consumers on how well these three businesses' services were actually received by them.

Twenty-five of the over 100 initial questions on the questionnaire were ultimately kept by the respondents because they were deemed critical to customer service. In the end, this produced the ten dimensions listed below, each of which continues to be crucial to the SERVQUAL Model:

- Reliability
- Responsiveness
- Competence
- Access
- Courtesy
- Communication
- Credibility
- Security
- Knowing the customer
- Tangibles

The degree of accuracy and integrity of the service determines how reliable it is. In the context of customer service, responsiveness means providing prompt and suitable responses to questions and concerns. Access determines whether a consumer can quickly and effectively contact the correct department, while competence refers to the expertise that an organization has.

While communication is about providing customers with timely, accurate, and clear information, courtesy is the act of striving to be courteous to consumers. The extent to which the organization's message is believable and reliable is what is meant by credibility.

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Security is designed to increase customer confidence and enable appropriate access. Knowing the consumer means taking a personal approach and being sensitive to their needs and desires. The tangibles are things that can be seen by customers, such as the staff's visibility (in work clothes or other uniforms), the decor and cleanliness of an office building, and all other facilities.

The RATER model is a scaled-down variation of the SERVQUAL Model of Service Quality. The RATER model uses five dimensions to assess service quality as opposed to the SERVQUAL Model of Service Quality's ten dimensions.

THE FIVE GAPS OF THE SERVQUAL MODEL OF SERVICE QUALITY

The level of service quality is greatly influenced by both internal organizational communication and communication between the customer and the service-providing business. Knowing a customer's expectation pattern is beneficial for businesses.

The SERVQUAL Model of Service Quality thus highlights five possible gaps between the needs of the customer and the service that a company provides.

1. KNOWLEDGE GAP

A gap occurs when a company lacks an understanding of customer expectations, which prevents them from properly contacting customers.

2. STANDARDS GAP

The company already has a preconceived notion of what the customer wants from their service. There is a high risk that the company may incorrectly translate this concept into a quality policy and associated rules if it is flawed from the start and does not match what customers truly demand.

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3. DELIVERY GAP

When a company provides service that differs from what the customer had anticipated, a gap may also develop. Additionally, improper implementation is included here. For instance, in how staff members implement policy.

4. COMMUNICATIONS GAP

The organization’s external (marketing) communications can occasionally lead to customers having unrealistic expectations. Additionally, the company occasionally communicates and makes claims that are not consistent with what it can actually fulfill.

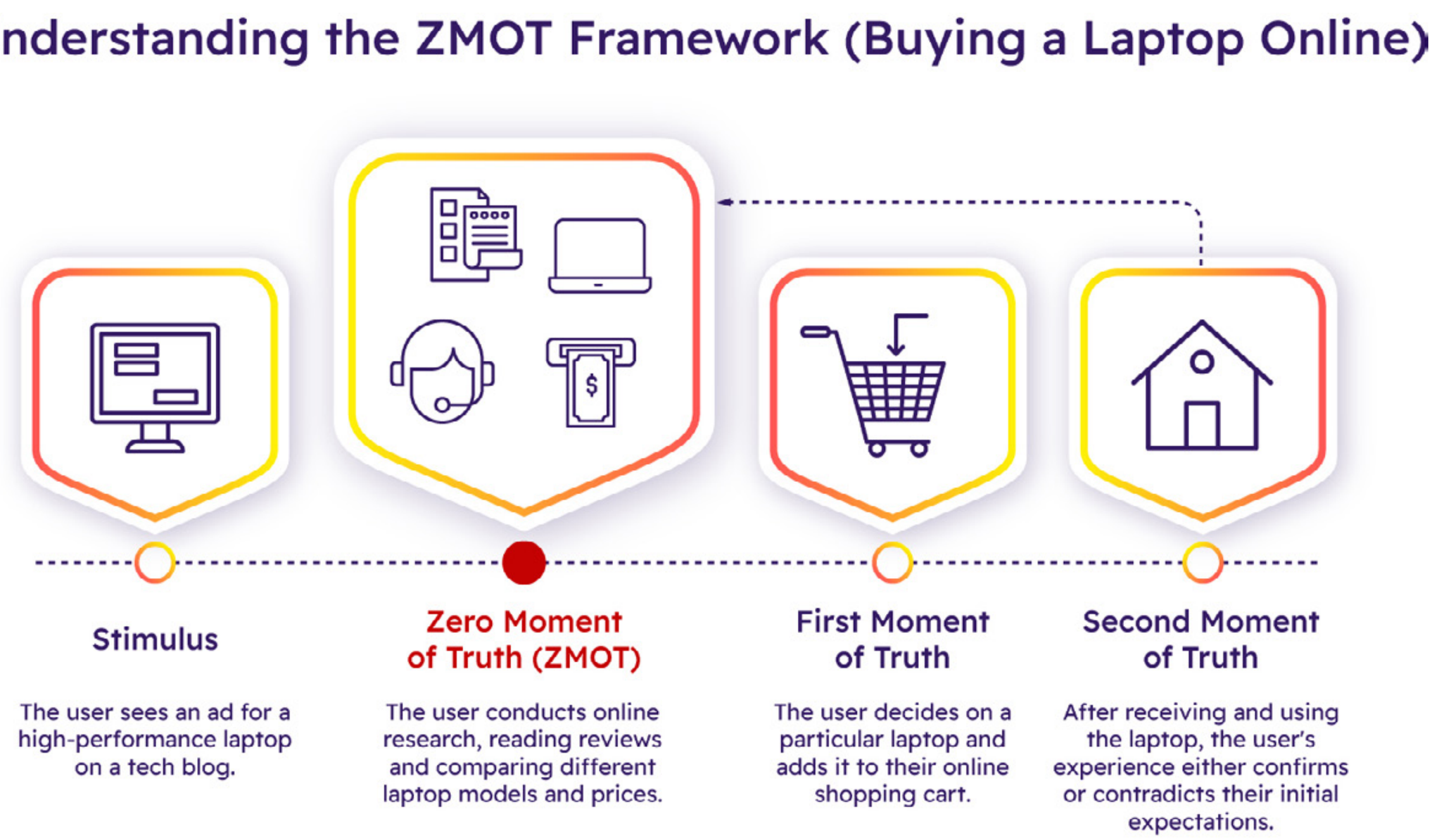
5. SATISFACTION GAP

A (substantial) discrepancy between the service a customer expects and the service they actually receive leads to dissatisfaction. This will eventually result in the biggest quality experience disparity.

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ZMOT FRAMEWORK

Jim Lecinski, a Google employee, created the phrase “zero moments of truth” (ZMOT) in 2011. The ZMOT is the decisive point in a customer’s decision-making process. This is so because ZMOT influences consumers’ purchasing decisions, so if you don’t succeed in gaining their business there, you’ve already lost the sale. The ZMOT framework is based on a collection of fundamental ideas for comprehending and making the most of the digital touchpoints that affect consumer decisions.



Recognizing the Zero Moment of Truth itself is the first fundamental. Before making a purchase, buyers actively seek information and reviews online, which ZMOT emphasizes as being of utmost importance. Marketers may strategically position their brand and have effective consumer engagement by recognizing this critical moment.

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The second tenet focuses on designing impactful online interactions. ZMOT highlights the necessity for marketers to offer worthwhile content, pertinent data, and interesting experiences during the online research phase. Marketers can affect consumer perceptions and raise the possibility that their brand will be chosen at the Zero Moment of Truth by providing interesting content and building trust.

METHODOLOGIES

The ZMOT framework includes strategies to aid marketers in effectively utilizing the digital ecosystem. An example of such a methodology is the use of a multi-channel strategy. ZMOT is aware that throughout the research process, customers interact with a variety of digital touchpoints, including search engines, social media, and online reviews. Marketers are urged to build a presence on these platforms so that customers may see and contact them while they make purchasing decisions.

The ZMOT framework's emphasis on content marketing is another essential practice. Marketers are encouraged to produce top-notch, pertinent, and educational content that addresses the needs and problems of consumers. Marketers may establish themselves as reliable sources of information and increase the likelihood of conversion by creating excellent content that attracts consumers' interest and attention at the Zero Moment of Truth.

BENEFITS

The ZMOT paradigm aids marketers in a number of important ways. First of all, it enables marketers to interact and be there with customers during critical decision-making times. Marketers may grab consumers' attention and affect their purchasing decisions by understanding the Zero Moment of Truth and optimizing their digital presence. As a result, there is a rise in conversion rates, consumer engagement, and brand exposure.

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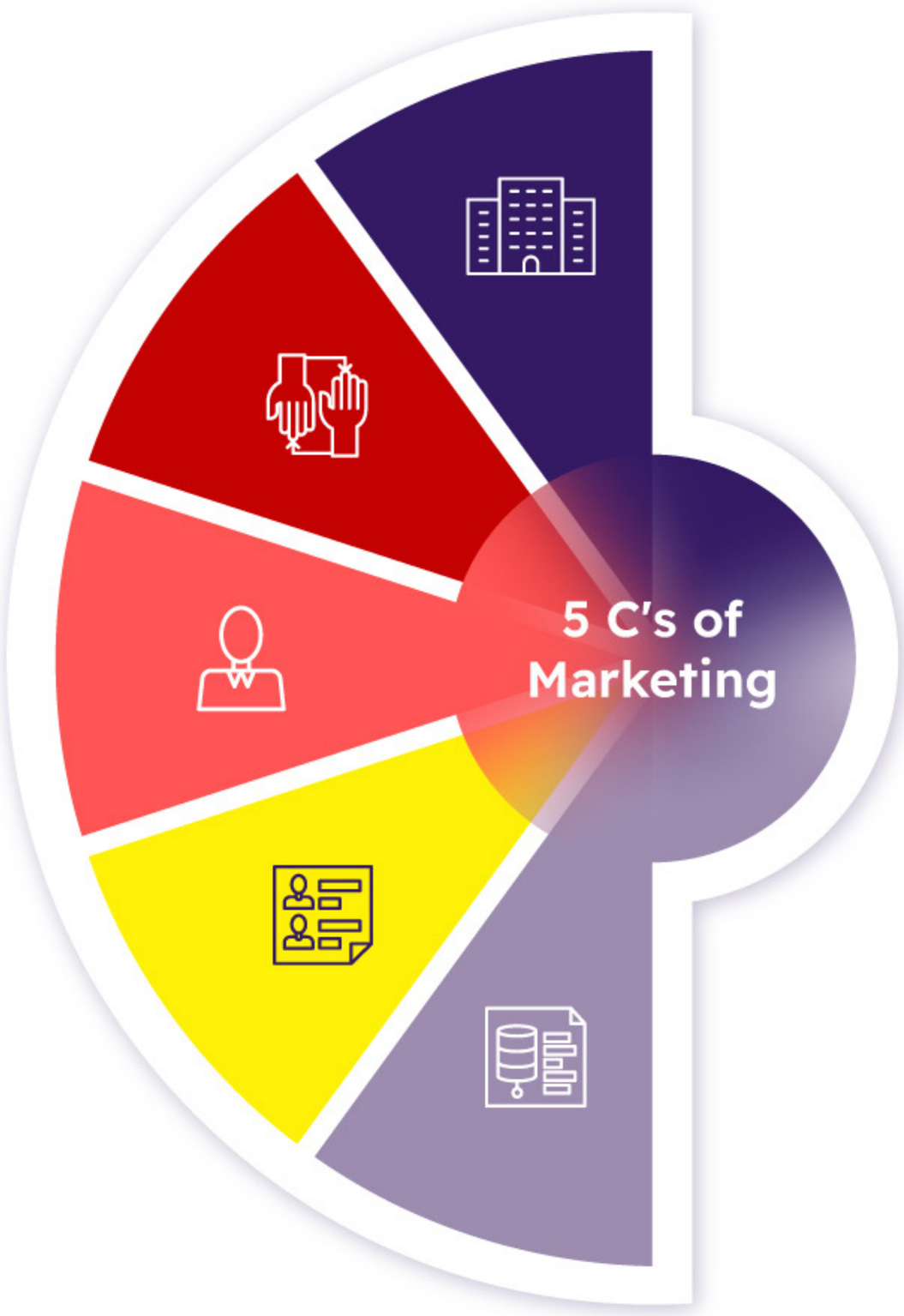
Second, ZMOT gives advertisers the ability to increase credibility and trust. Marketers may position themselves as authorities in their particular sectors by providing useful material and being visible during the online research phase. As a result, customers are more likely to pick the brand at the “Zero Moment of Truth,” and some may even become brand loyalists.

The ZMOT platform also enables marketers to compile insightful customer data. Marketers can acquire a comprehensive insight into consumer behavior, preferences, and trends by tracking and examining digital touchpoints. These insights can help with product development, customer relationship management, and marketing strategy, resulting in more successful and focused marketing campaigns.

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5C ANALYSIS

The environment in which a business operates is evaluated using a marketing methodology known as the 5C Analysis. It can shed light on the most crucial aspects of a project's success, such as the level of risk exposure to various environmental components. The five Cs are context, company, collaborators, customers, and competitors.



Company

Understand your company's strengths, weaknesses, and offerings.

Collaborators

Identify your partners, suppliers, or any other entities that help you deliver your product or service.

Customers

Know who your target customers are, their needs, wants, and how they behave.

Competitors

Recognize who your competitors are, what they offer, and how you compare.

Context

Consider the external factors like market trends, regulations, and cultural shifts that affect your business.

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COMPANY

Finding the focal company's Sustainable Competitive Advantage is crucial when using the 5C marketing framework to analyze a business. It may take the shape of brand equity, scale economies, technological advancement, etc. The VRIO (Variable Rare Imitable Organised) model can be used to determine whether a firm's assets provide a temporary or sustainable advantage in order to determine whether the focal company has a sustainable competitive advantage.

COLLABORATORS

Collaborators are organizations that enable or improve a company's capacity to offer its specific good or service in the manner in which it does. This issue mainly has to do with the supply chain of a corporation, which can range from spot contracts to quasi-vertical integration. As downstream collaborators are more clearly identified as customers in the 5C Analysis paradigm, the path of integration can only be upstream.

CUSTOMERS

The whole available market, serviceable available market, and serviceable obtainable market are the three main sizes of the prospective customer base that a business can reach with its goods or services. The market categories may be divided further based on geography, demography, and other identifying characteristics.

The broadest category of customers, known as the Total Available Market (TAM), encompasses every potential buyer of a specific good or service. The potential uses of a company's product or service are categorized in the TAM's Serviceable Available Market (SAM), a subset of the TAM. The most exact description of the market is the Serviceable Obtainable Market (SOM) sub-segment, which indicates the market segment that a company could reasonably aim for a share of.

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COMPETITORS

Other businesses that are involved in the same industry as the focus company constitute competition. Industry classification systems exist to provide a standardized means of defining an industry, such as the North American Industry Classification System.

Examining a player’s market share within the industry is a typical indicator of finding relevant players. The concentration ratio CR4, which displays the percentage of the market share held by the four biggest companies in the sector, is commonly used to express it.

But keep in mind that for some businesses, industry classification schemes might not offer a complete enough industry definition. This might happen when a company operates in several different sectors or caters to a niche market that falls beyond the usual definition of the industry.

CONTEXT

The PESTEL analysis method is most frequently used to examine the environment in which an organization operates. It offers coverage for those areas where a firm might be impacted but where it has little or no control. Contextual changes may affect the industry as a whole rather than just one specific company. Therefore, a benefit enjoyed by such adjustments may not be converted into a competitive advantage for the target company or vice versa.

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THE NET PROMOTER SCORE

The most often used metric for gauging customer loyalty and happiness is the Net Promoter Score. The Net Promoter Score approach is intended to determine a consumer's propensity to promote a business to others, going beyond simply gauging their level of customer satisfaction.

UTILIZING THE NET PROMOTER SCORE

The NPS question asks respondents to rate how likely they are to recommend the company to others on a scale from 0 to 10.

Customers are divided into one of three groups based on the number they select: "Detractors," "Passives," or "Promoters."

BREAKDOWNS OF SCORES:

0 – 6: Detractors: This group is made up of dissatisfied clients who are unlikely to do business with you again. Detractors may make customers less likely to support your company; thus, it's crucial to pay special attention to this group.

You may provide this group of customers insights that will enable you to comprehend why their buying experience was unfavorable, turning this knowledge into useful information you can utilize to enhance your company.

You can compute another NPS 3-6 months after making the necessary adjustments to address those pain areas to see if the modifications you made were successful.

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7–8: Passives: This group of consumers is made up of those who had no problems with their customer service but who weren't really impressed enough to recommend the business.

Passives are "take it or leave it" customers who may repurchase your product or service, but if a competitor offers a lower price or a more enticing extra feature, they'll swiftly switch over.

Because of this, Passives can quickly transform into a Detractor by default. The positive aspect is, however, that they can also quickly transform into a Promoter.

9 – 10: Promoters: This category indicates that you are succeeding since a significant portion of your promoters are referring customers to your business. Making your customers' experiences as positive as possible will help you attract more Promoters because they are the most cost-effective form of advertising.

If the majority of your clients are Promoters, there is still work to be done. You can learn more about what you can do to enhance your satisfied consumers' shopping experiences by studying this group of clients. Learning how to calculate NPS can assist avoid Promoters from becoming Passives.

The NPS scale can be compared to an online review's four-star rating system, but it offers a more comprehensive (and accurate) way to gauge customer satisfaction.

https://www.b2binternational.com/what-we-do/customers/net-promoter-score-nps/

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HOW TO DETERMINE YOUR NET PROMOTER SCORE

Let’s imagine you conducted an online survey with a 0–10 scale and an NPS question, and you got 100 replies from users. How do you use the results? Is it as straightforward as averaging the answers? I guess not quite. But it’s nearly that simple.

Based on how respondents are categorized—from Detractors to Promoters—the NPS system assigns you a percentage. To compute the percentage, perform these steps:

- Create an Excel spreadsheet with all the survey replies.
- Analyze the responses from Promoters, Passives, and Detractors.
- Add up all of the answers from each group.
- Take the group total and divide it by the total number of survey replies to determine the percentage.
- Your NPS score is obtained by subtracting the percentage of Detractors from the percentage of Promoters.

The formula for Net Promoter Score (NPS)

(Number of Promoters — Number of Detractors) / (Number of Respondents) x 100

As an illustration, suppose your survey received 100 responses.

10 replies (Detractors) fell between 0 and 6.
20 replies (Passives) fell between 7-8.
70 replies fell between 9 and 10 (Promoters).

The percentages that result for each category are 10%, 20%, and 70%, respectively.

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To sum up, take 70% (Promoters) and subtract 10% (Detractors), which gives us 60%. Your NPS is simply 60 because a sample Net Promoter Score is always displayed as just an integer rather than a percentage. (And sure, since your score can be between -100 and +100, you can have a negative NPS.)

Although carrying out these calculations could seem intimidating, the effort is well worth it. Numerous studies have shown that the NPS system and corporate growth are related. In fact, research show that raising Net Promoter Scores increases revenue for businesses in all industries. So, the NPS is a simple approach to employ if you're seeking a more systematic way to gauge the strength of your brand. Additionally, you can measure your score against others in your field if you want to contextualize it.

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THE CONTENT MARKETING MATRIX

As a marketer that is constantly looking for methods to provide more value to customers through your firm, you understand how to create a powerful digital experience through content marketing, as well as how to employ inbound and content marketing strategies to develop your business. Great. Now that innovation time is upon us; you are constantly coming up with new ideas. The team believes they are excellent, and perhaps this marketing thing is beginning to make sense. But all that passion vanishes with a single glance at your stats.

Your bounce rate is at an all-time high, your customers aren’t responding to your clever ideas, and hardly anyone is responding to your call to action.

What went wrong if everything you did was correct?
It’s easy. Not all good ideas lead to good outcomes. Because merely having outstanding ideas isn’t enough when it comes to content marketing. A content marketing matrix, also known as a content matrix, can be used to ensure that these fantastic ideas are pertinent to your target audience.

WHAT IS A CONTENT MARKETING MATRIX?

A content marketing matrix is a technique for planning that can help you organize your content ideas and inventory to suit particular customer needs at various points in the buyer’s journey.

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Based on a customer's stage of the purchase process, it helps highlight the content that is most pertinent to them. Similar to matchmaking, but with customers and content instead of partners.

For instance, a content marketing matrix would inform a pet store owner not to serve information like "Best Food Choices For Growing Dogs" to consumers who are still choosing what kind of pet to acquire.

A content marketing matrix is a planning tool that helps marketers come up with suggestions for the most intriguing content formats for their target clients.

However, simply understanding what a content marketing matrix is doesn't qualify you as an expert. Like any good marketer, you undoubtedly have a lot of questions right now, but that's okay because we have the answers.

HOW DOES THE CONTENT MATRIX ACTUALLY OPERATE?

Let's discuss how a content marketing matrix truly functions now that you understand what it is and how it relates to your content inventory.

We'll be examining the key components of a content matrix and assisting you in comprehending each one and how it relates to your business or brand.

Choosing your content's purpose according to the Four Quadrants. The four main goals of content are demonstrated by the content marketing matrix: to entertain, educate, inspire, or convince.

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THE CONTENT MARKETING MATRIX AXES



To Entertain: Everyone enjoys a positive atmosphere! It's possible that content made with your target audience in mind won't directly promote the product. However, it may enthuse and elicit a favorable response in a way that causes individuals to feel emotionally attached to your business or brand.

To Inspire: Inspirational material taps into your target audience's emotions but in a way that encourages them to make a purchasing choice.

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To Educate: This is a favorite among marketers in general because it offers a wonderful opportunity to show off their subject-matter expertise. Content that is intended to educate is typically more reasoned, with the goal of offering answers to a problem that the target audience is facing.

To Convince: Persuasive content is typically where all the effort pays off. Its goal is to persuade your target market to make the last purchase-related move. Facts, figures, and analytics are frequently used in content in this quadrant to illustrate the advantages of your product or service and to appeal to the logical interests of the audience.

WHAT ADVANTAGES DOES THE CONTENT MARKETING MATRIX OFFER?

You've given a piece a lot of thought. You've written it with skill, gotten editing advice, and perfected it. After hitting "publish," you could be shocked to discover that your essay didn't do well. Since "content types fall within defined scopes of purpose," Struto hypothesizes that "one outside of its designated scope could be the reason it didn't work."

Future content ideas can be mind-mapped, and you can also look at how your competitors are using these kinds of materials.

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SERVICE-DOMINANT LOGIC

A theory called “service-dominant logic” is based on the idea that goods and services only become valuable when customers use them. This viewpoint has gained popularity as a means of comprehending the interactions between establishments and their customers. Understanding service dominance can help you implement its principal in your company and create a customer-first strategy. This section explains service-dominant logic, its ten guiding principles, how the framework has evolved over time, and some practical applications for your company.

WHAT IS SERVICE-DOMINANT LOGIC?

A worldview that sees all interactions within an economy as service-to-service exchanges is known as service-dominant logic or S-D logic. The notion was put forth in the early 2000s by Robert F. Lusch and Stephen L. Vargo. The goods-dominant logic, which holds that a product’s worth derives from the resources that companies utilize to generate it, is opposed by the service-dominant approach. It’s a viewpoint that holds that all products serve consumers in some way and that a product’s value is derived from interactions with consumers.

Customers are seen as co-creators of value under the service-dominant worldview, which holds that people contribute more than simply money to corporate interactions. It has a customer-centered perspective. Businesses can focus on the customer and their requirements rather than just the product by using a service-dominant strategy.

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TEN UNDERLYING ASSUMPTIONS OF S-D LOGIC

The ten basic assumptions of S-D logic proposed by Lusch and Vargo are:

1. The essential tenet of exchange is service.

In an economy, all transactions are service-to-service transactions. Value is jointly created and received by the provider and the customer. The knowledge and abilities that the company offers as a service are derived from its products and can be used by the customer to enhance their quality of life.

2. The essential premise of commerce is hidden by indirect transactions.

The service-to-service trade is obscured by the employment of intermediary sources of value, such as money. Although direct exchanges, in which one person gives a service to another in exchange for another service, are uncommon in reality, the basic idea of exchange is still in place. Service exchanges take place through intricate webs of institutions, institutions, money, services, and services.

3. Goods are a means of distributing services.

Products create intrinsic value through the services they deliver, not through ownership. Delivering services is the purpose of products, and it is the services that provide the customer value. For instance, a toothbrush that a consumer buys has value because of the service it offers when the customer uses it. The toothbrush itself does not have value.

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4. Operant resources are the fundamental sources of strategic benefit

Operational resources are a business's expertise and knowledge. The utilization of operant resources, in accordance with S-D logic, is what provides a business with a competitive edge. Customers gain from this whether it produces a conventional service or a material good.

5. Every economy is a service economy.

S-D logic sees all economic activity as service-oriented because it holds that all economic trades are exchanges of services. All economies are, therefore, service economies. Numerous contemporary organizations are getting more specialists in the services they offer. As a result, it is easier to see how economies are founded on services.

6. The customer is always a co-creator of value

The conventional view that customers are merely recipients of value is deviated from S-D reasoning. According to the S-D logic perspective, customers contribute to value creation. Consumers add value through their interactions with the services that businesses offer, and this value helps businesses understand their customers better, innovate, and offer more valuable services.

7. The company can only present value propositions; it cannot deliver value.

Although businesses work hard to create goods and services that appeal to their target market, they don't actually give their customers anything of value. This is so that businesses can only claim to produce value, according to the S-D logic viewpoint. The value of their product or service is only delivered when a customer uses it.

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8. A service-centered perspective is naturally relational and beneficiary-oriented.

This claims that the S-D reasoning is consistently customer-focused. The consumer is at the center of service-dominant ideas because they are predicated on the idea that all interactions are service-to-service and that value is co-created. S-D logic highlights relationships between businesses and their customers, which is a relational concept.

9. Resource integrators are social and economic actors all at once.

Every party engaged in the creation and exchange of service is referred to as an actor in S-D logic. Lush and Vargo contend that the term “actor” emphasizes the significance of each participant more than terms like “provider” and “customer.” Service domination acknowledges that everyone participates in the creation of value and that all economic players are part of a bigger system.

10. The person who gets something always and uniquely decides what it’s worth.

In other words, the value of a service or good is always determined by the beneficiary. The beneficiary’s interactions with the service and the benefits they stand to get from using it determine a service’s value. The extent of a product’s or service’s value is decided by the customer, not the service provider, in accordance with service-dominant ideals.

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PRODUCT STRATEGY AND MANAGEMENT

PRODUCT LIFE CYCLE

The term “product life cycle” describes the period of time between the introduction of a product to the market and its removal from the shelves. Management and marketing professionals use this idea as a decision element when determining whether it is suitable to enhance advertising, lower prices, enter new markets or change the packaging. Product life cycle management is the process of planning out how to consistently support and sustain a product.

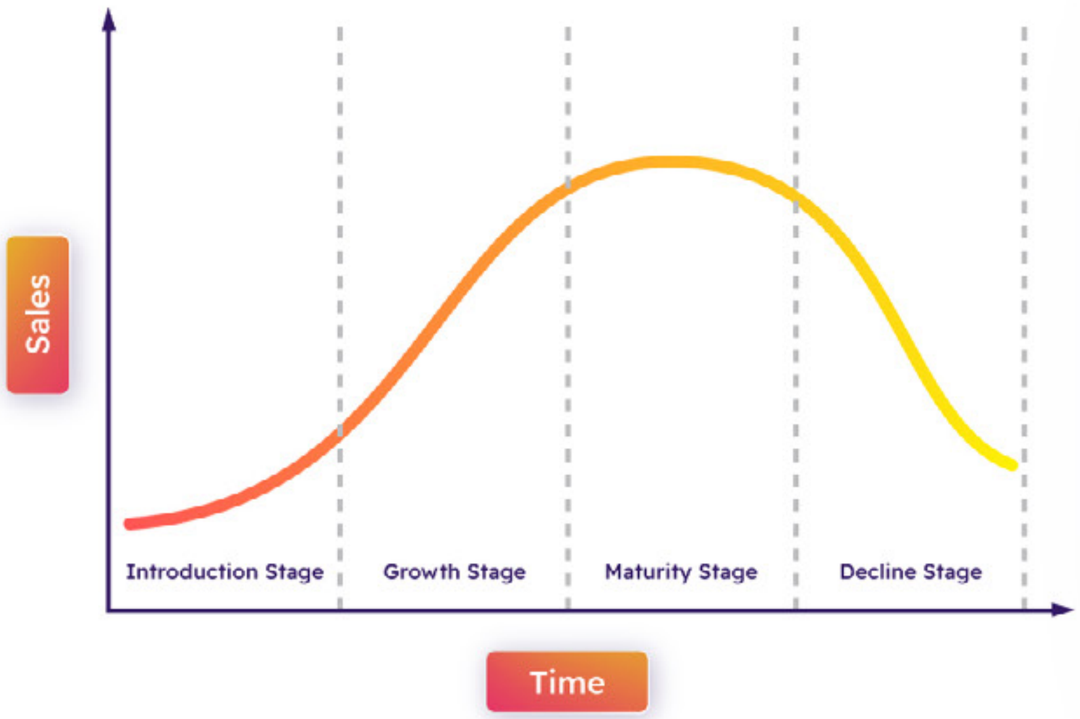
HOW THE PRODUCT LIFE CYCLE WORKS?

Products have life cycles just like individuals do. Four stages make up a product’s life cycle: introduction, growth, maturity, and decline.

A concept becomes a product, but under the constraints of contemporary business, it is unlikely to advance until it has undergone research and development (R&D) and been determined to be practicable and potentially profitable. The product is then created, advertised, and launched. Although the product has not yet been made available to customers, some product life cycle models include product development as a stage.

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Product Life Cycle



Example:

Introduction Stage:

A mobile phone model is launched with unique features like a high-quality camera or long battery life. Marketing efforts are high to create awareness.

Growth Stage:

Sales begin to increase as more consumers become aware of the phone and its features. Positive reviews lead to increased demand.

Maturity Stage:

Sales peak as the phone model gains market acceptance and starts facing competition from other newer models.

Decline Stage:

Sales start to decline as newer models with more advanced features are launched by the same or other companies. The company may decide to discontinue the model or sell it at a reduced price.

The four commonly recognized stages of a product's life cycle are explained below.

INTRODUCTION STAGE

Customers are first exposed to the new product during the introduction phase. In general, a business must make a sizable expenditure in marketing and advertising aimed at educating consumers about the product and its advantages, especially if the function of the item is mostly unknown. There is frequently little to no competition for a product during the debut stage because rivals may only be getting a first glance at the new offering. However, because sales are typically lower at this point, there may not be enough special pricing to encourage customer interaction, and the sales approach is still being scrutinized; businesses still frequently have poor financial outcomes.

GROWTH STAGE

The product then enters the growth stage if it is a success. This is characterized by a rise in demand, an expansion in supply, and a rise in production. Depending on the industry and the product, a company's product may spend a different period of time in the introduction phase before experiencing rapid growth.

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The product gains in popularity and recognition throughout the growth phase. If a product is subject to intense competition, a corporation may nonetheless decide to invest extensively in advertising. However, rather than focusing on bringing the products to the market, marketing initiatives are probably designed to set their product apart from competitors. Based on customer input, a business may potentially improve the functioning of a product.

Sales and revenue increase during the product life cycle's growth phase, which has a positive financial impact. As competitor items are introduced into the market, competition grows, potentially driving the company to drop its prices and endure smaller margins.

MATURITY STAGE

The most lucrative period of the product life cycle is when the costs of manufacturing and marketing start to fall. Some observers refer to the maturity stage as the point at which sales volume has "maxed out" due to the product's market saturation, increased competition compared to earlier stages, and declining profit margins.

A corporation may start thinking about how to reinvent its product or adopt new approaches to capture a wider market presence depending on the good. This entails gathering additional customer feedback and learning more about their demographics and wants.

The competition is fiercest during the maturity period. Competition for customers is typically at its strongest since rival businesses have had enough time to launch competing and improved products. A corporation aims to keep its product in this mature stage for as long as feasible as sales levels stabilize.

While a mature product has to be differentiated, a new product needs to be explained.

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DECLINE STAGE

The product can lose market share and start to deteriorate as competition rises as other businesses try to replicate its success. Due to market saturation and the availability of substitute products, product sales start to decline, and the company may decide not to pursue further marketing initiatives since customers may already have made up their minds about whether or not to remain loyal to the company's products.

If a product is completely retired, the corporation stops developing support for it and stops all marketing efforts. As an alternative, the business might elect to redesign the item or release an entirely new model for the following generation. The corporation may decide to reenter the product life cycle by releasing the new version to the market if the upgrade is significant enough.

How a product is marketed to consumers depends on where it is in its life cycle. A mature product needs to be distinguished from its rivals, whereas a fresh product needs to be explained.

ADVANTAGES OF USING THE PRODUCT LIFE CYCLE

Marketers and business developers can more clearly comprehend how each product or brand fits into a company's portfolio thanks to the product life cycle. This makes it possible for the business to internally reallocate resources to particular goods based on where those products are in the product life cycle.

A business might decide, for instance, to reallocate market staff time to items that are about to reach the launch or growth stages. As the product develops, it might also need to spend more on hiring engineers or customer support representatives.

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Due to its tendency to encourage innovation and discourage the use of outmoded items, the product life cycle generally has a favorable effect on economic growth. Companies that employ the product life cycle may become aware of the need to make their goods more effective, safer, efficient, quicker, cheaper, or more suited to customer needs as the products progress through the life cycle stages.

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TARGET MARKET

A target market is a population that has been chosen because of similar traits like age, income, and lifestyle as the most probable candidates to purchase a product.

When a business creates, packages, and advertises its product, determining the target market is a crucial step in the decision-making process.

HOW DO YOU DEFINE YOUR PRODUCT'S TARGET MARKET?

One of the steps in making anything new is picturing the types of people who might buy it.

Both a need and a problem must exist for a new product to be developed, and the need or issue is usually not the same for every customer. Most times, the target market is a small group of people that share similar interests, problems or hobbies, e.g., cat lovers, plant lovers, eco-friendly advocates etc.

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WHAT ARE THE 4 TARGET SEGMENTATION?

Consumers are divided into four main groups by marketers.



- **Geographic Segmentation:** This type of segmentation divides the market according to different geographical units. It could be by area, nation, city, or even neighborhood.

- **Demographic segmentation:** This method involves dividing the market based on various demographic factors. These factors could include age, gender, income, occupation, education, religion, or stage of a family's life cycle.

- **Psychographic Segmentation:** This process involves dividing the market based on certain psychological aspects. These can encompass factors like personality, values, attitudes, hobbies, or lifestyles of the consumers.

- **Behavioural segmentation:** This type of segmentation divides the market based on the behaviors of the consumer. Factors for consideration could be the knowledge, attitudes, uses, or reactions of the consumer to a product.

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EXAMPLE OF A TARGET MARKET

You can utilize each of the four target markets to think about a new product's target market. For instance, it is believed that there are 100,000 Italian restaurants throughout the country. They obviously have a lot to offer.

However, a corner pizzeria might primarily—though not exclusively—attract a younger, more frugal customer, whereas an establishment with an old-fashioned white tablecloth might be favored by local families and older residents. A more recent establishment across the street might serve an upmarket and fashion-conscious customer that will travel a considerable distance for the restaurant's cutting-edge menu and posh wine list.

Each time a restaurant has been a success, a smart businessperson has carefully assessed the ideal target market for the establishment and modified the food, the setting, and the advertising tactics to appeal to that market.

TARGET MARKETS: WHY ARE THEY IMPORTANT?

Nowadays, very few goods are designed to appeal to all tastes. The Aveda Rosemary Mint Bath Bar, which retails for $23 per bar in Aveda beauty stores, is aimed at the upscale and environmentally conscious woman who is willing to spend more for quality. Cle de Peau Beaute Synactif Soap has a suggested retail price of $110 per bar and is targeted at wealthy, style-conscious women who are willing to spend more for a luxury item. An eight-pack of Dial soap, which is well-known for working, can be found on Amazon for about $5. One of the most important factors in the success of selling a good or service is knowing who will find it appealing and who will ultimately buy it. Its user base could eventually grow as a result of additional marketing, advertising, and word-of-mouth. That is why companies invest a lot of time and money into determining their first target audiences and then use special promotions, social media campaigns, and targeted advertising to further their reach.

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PRODUCT-MARKET FIT

When a company's target customers purchase, use, and spread the word about the product in sufficient quantities to support the product's growth and profitability, the situation is said to be in product-market fit.

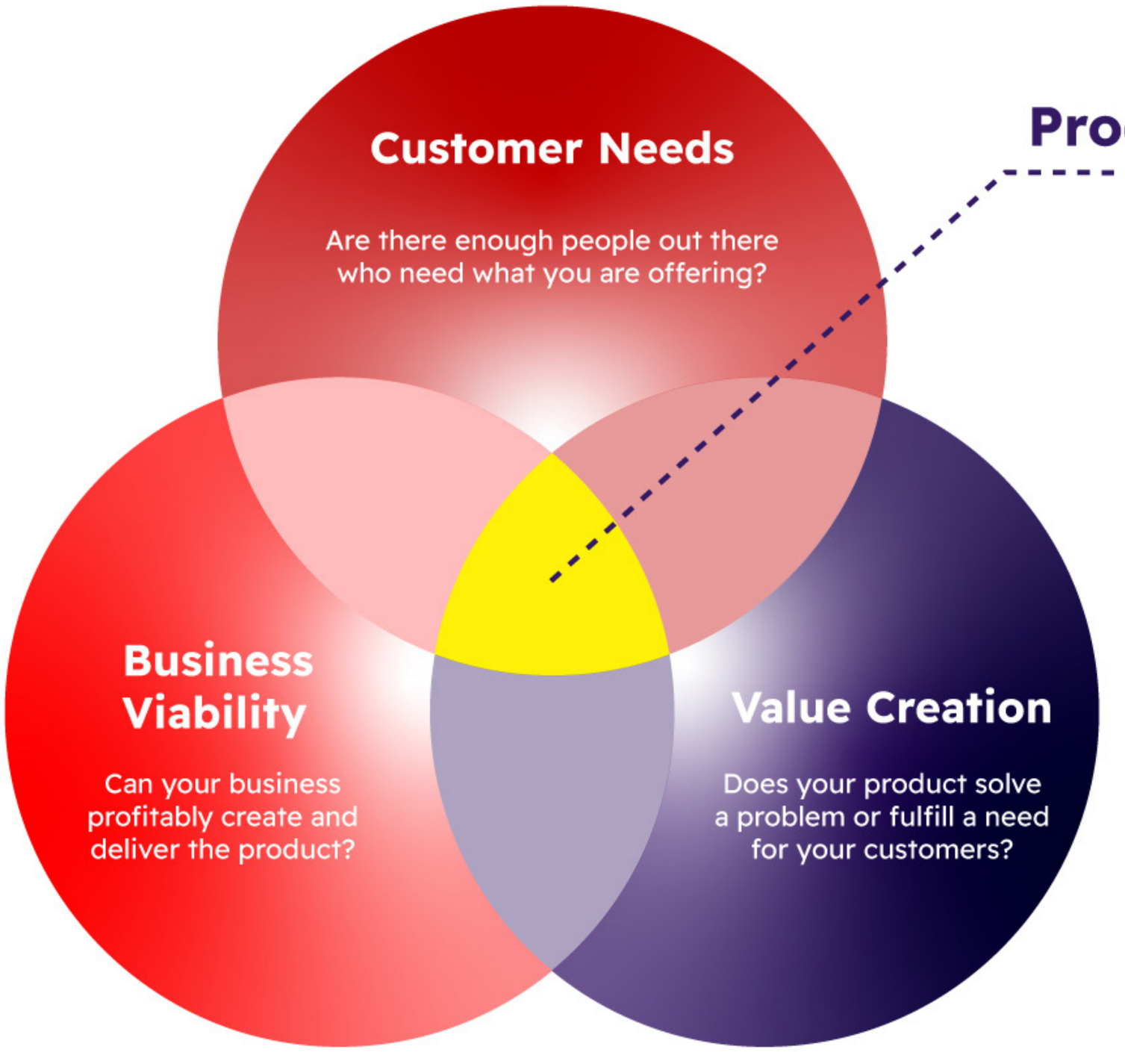
Finding a good market with a product that can fulfill that market, according to businessman and investor Marc Andreesen, who is frequently credited with creating the concept.

WHY IS IT IMPORTANT?

According to Facebook's VP of Growth, Alex Schultz, the main issue he sees with the businesses he consults is that they don't have product-market fit even though they believe they have. Why is obtaining it so crucial, then? Why do many VCs require proof of product-market fit before investing in a business? Why does Andreesen think that every startup's life should be divided into the two phases known as before product-market fit (BPMF) and after product-market fit (APMF)?

The answer is straightforward: Your team cannot afford to concentrate on other crucial strategic goals like growth or upselling existing customers before you produce a product that you can validate enough people are ready to pay for.

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If you haven’t initially established that your product has a sufficient market to support itself and make a profit, those attempts may even be detrimental.

WHO IS IN CHARGE OF ENSURING PRODUCT-MARKET FIT?

The concept is typically connected to product management and marketing. In actuality, the firm as a whole must share responsibility for achieving it. The organization achieves this significant milestone with the aid of the departments of sales, business development, support, finance, and all others.

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HOW IS THE PRODUCT-MARKET FIT INDEX CALCULATED?

Any organization cannot determine when it has achieved product-market fit using a single set of indicators. However, venture capitalist Andrew Chen provides some indicators that a business is moving in the correct path with its offering:

- Does a certain group of potential customers indicate they will switch to your product when you survey them or let them test it out?
- Will some customers who have turned down competing items in the market try yours?
- Do users appropriately group your product with the appropriate rival products during user testing?
- Do users exhibit knowledge of the unique selling points or differentiators of your product?
- How do your core KPIs stack up against those of your rivals, such as user retention rates?

A combination of qualitative and quantitative indicators can be seen in Chen's signals. This is intentional. You should combine both of the success measurement techniques your team employs. For instance:

Quantitative:

- NPS score
- Churn rate
- Growth rate
- Market share

Qualitative:

- Word of mouth. (According to Andreesen, if your customers recommend your items to others, they essentially turn into sales representatives for your products.)

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- The frequency of calls from the media or industry analysts has increased, and your product and business are receiving greater press.

HOW CAN YOUR PRODUCT ACHIEVE IT?

There is no one approach to achieving product-market fit, just as the best way to measure it will vary depending on the organization. The following high-level approach is recommended to assist your team in getting going.



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1. **Choose your target market:** Determine the group of people most likely to benefit from and buy your product.

2. **Identify the customer's unmet needs:** Understand what your target market needs, and how your product can fulfill those needs.

3. **Make your value proposition clear:** Define the unique value your product provides, that sets it apart from other products in the market.

4. **Name your minimum features for a product (MVP):** Outline the essential features that your product must have to solve the customers' problems.

5. **Create your MVP:** Develop a simple version of your product that includes the identified minimum features, and is ready to be tested in the market.

6. **Test out your MVP with real users:** Launch your MVP to a small segment of your target market, and gather feedback to validate if your product meets their needs and expectations.

Then, using the results of those user tests and surveys, employ metrics like those mentioned above by Andrew Chen to assess your progress.

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COMPETITOR ANALYSIS

Conducting a competitor study is a crucial part of your job as a product manager. Making informed judgments regarding product development, pricing, marketing, and sales tactics helps you comprehend the competitive landscape. How then, can you analyze your competitors? To get you started, consider the following stages, instances, and resources:

1. IDENTIFY YOUR COMPETITORS

Start by determining who your rivals are. This can be achieved by studying industry reports, conducting market research, and examining your target market. While your direct rivals provide services or goods that are identical to yours, your indirect rivals provide different approaches to the same issue. In addition to Google Search, the following instruments can be used to identify competitors:

IBISWorld Industry Reports, Euromonitor International Industry Reports, Gartner Magic Quadrant, Forrester Wave, and Statista Industry Reports are a few examples of market research reports.

Also industry associations, including the Product Development and Management Association (PDMA), the Association of International Product Marketing and Management (AIPMM), the Silicon Valley Product Group (SVPG), and the Product Management Festival can help.

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2. COLLECT DATA

It’s crucial to learn more about your competition when you’ve recognized them. This may include things like their target market, pricing policies, marketing techniques, product offerings, customer reviews, and market share. There are several resources for information, including industry journals, competitor websites, social media profiles, and consumer reviews. Among the resources that can be used to aid with information collection are:

- SimilarWeb, a platform for market intelligence that offers information about website traffic, audience demographics, and online activity;

- Owler, a platform for competitive intelligence that offers news, information, and insights on businesses;

- SEMRush, a digital marketing tool that offers information on content marketing, PPC advertising, and SEO.

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3. ANALYSE DATA

It’s time to analyze the information once it has been gathered. In order to understand how your competitors are positioning themselves in the market, look for patterns, trends, and insights.

How to conduct Competitive Analysis?

	Your Business	Competitor 1	Competitor 2
Product/Service Quality	5	2	1
Pricing	4	7	4
Market Presence	9	8	7
Customer Service	2	1	5
Distribution Channels	2	9	2
Brand Reputation	7	6	9
Social Media Presence	8	6	3
SEO Optimization and Position	3	4	3
Company Size	9	3	6

Determine their advantages and disadvantages as well as any market gaps you might exploit. The following are a few templates that can aid in competitor analysis:

- A company’s market position, the introduction of a new product or feature, strategic planning, or the competitive environment can all be evaluated using a SWOT analysis;

- Porter’s Five Forces analysis can be used to determine possible areas for strategic change, analyze a company’s competitive environment, assess the attractiveness of a market or industry, and determine the effect of outside variables on a company’s profitability;

- Value Chain Analysis: Can be used to analyze the effectiveness of a company’s supply chain, determine opportunities for cost reduction or value creation, pinpoint areas for process improvement, or determine how competitive a company is in its industry.

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4. USE THE INSIGHTS

Utilize the insights from the data analysis to guide the creation of your products as well as your pricing, marketing, and sales tactics. Develop a strategy to explain these differences to your target audience. Find ways to set your product apart from those of your competitors. Among the resources that can be used to construct a plan are:

Aha! is a tool for product management that can assist you in creating a product roadmap based on the knowledge gathered from competitor analysis. You may employ Aha! to design a visual roadmap outlining your product development strategy, complete with milestones, features, and goals. Aha! You can monitor your progress, work together as a team, and communicate your roadmap to stakeholders.

Another tool for product management, Product Plan, can assist you in using the information from competitor analysis to guide your product plan. A visual product roadmap displaying your product vision, strategy, and important objectives may be made using Product Plan. Additionally, a Product Plan enables team collaboration, progress tracking, and sharing of your roadmap with stakeholders;

With the aid of the project management platform Trello, you may arrange your assignments and undertakings in accordance with the learnings from competition analysis. Trello may be used to construct a board that details your product strategy, including your objectives, assignments, and deadlines. Trello also enables team collaboration, progress tracking, and sharing of your board with stakeholders;

FigJam is a collaboration tool that can assist you in developing your product strategy visually and collectively using insights from competitor analysis. Making mind maps, user personas, customer journey maps, and other visual representations of your product strategy is possible with FigJam. You may share your work with stakeholders, discuss it in real-time with your team, and get feedback on your concepts with FigJam.

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5. MONITOR AND UPDATE

Monitoring your competitors and periodically updating your analysis is a procedure that goes along with competition analysis. Keep an eye on their new product introductions, price changes, and marketing initiatives, then modify your plans as necessary. The following are a few monitoring-related tools:

- Google Alerts is a free program that can assist you in keeping tabs on your rivals by emailing you whenever they are referenced in the press, blogs, or social media. You can configure alerts to receive updates every day or every week for particular keywords or themes. You can monitor what your rivals are doing using Google Alerts and search for methods to differentiate your offering from theirs

- Social Mention is a tool that can help in keeping tabs on the mood, engagement, and mentions made on social media sites by your rivals. Using Social Mention, you can keep an eye on the social media profiles, hashtags, and keywords of your rivals and follow their activity over time. You can examine how your rivals perform on social media with Social Mention to see where your social media approach needs to be improved;

You may monitor and control your competitors' social media activity with the help of Hootsuite, a social media management platform. Hootsuite lets you maintain tabs on competitors' social media accounts, track your own performance, and monitor mentions. You can schedule social media posts with Hootsuite as well as interact with your audience and track your return on investment.

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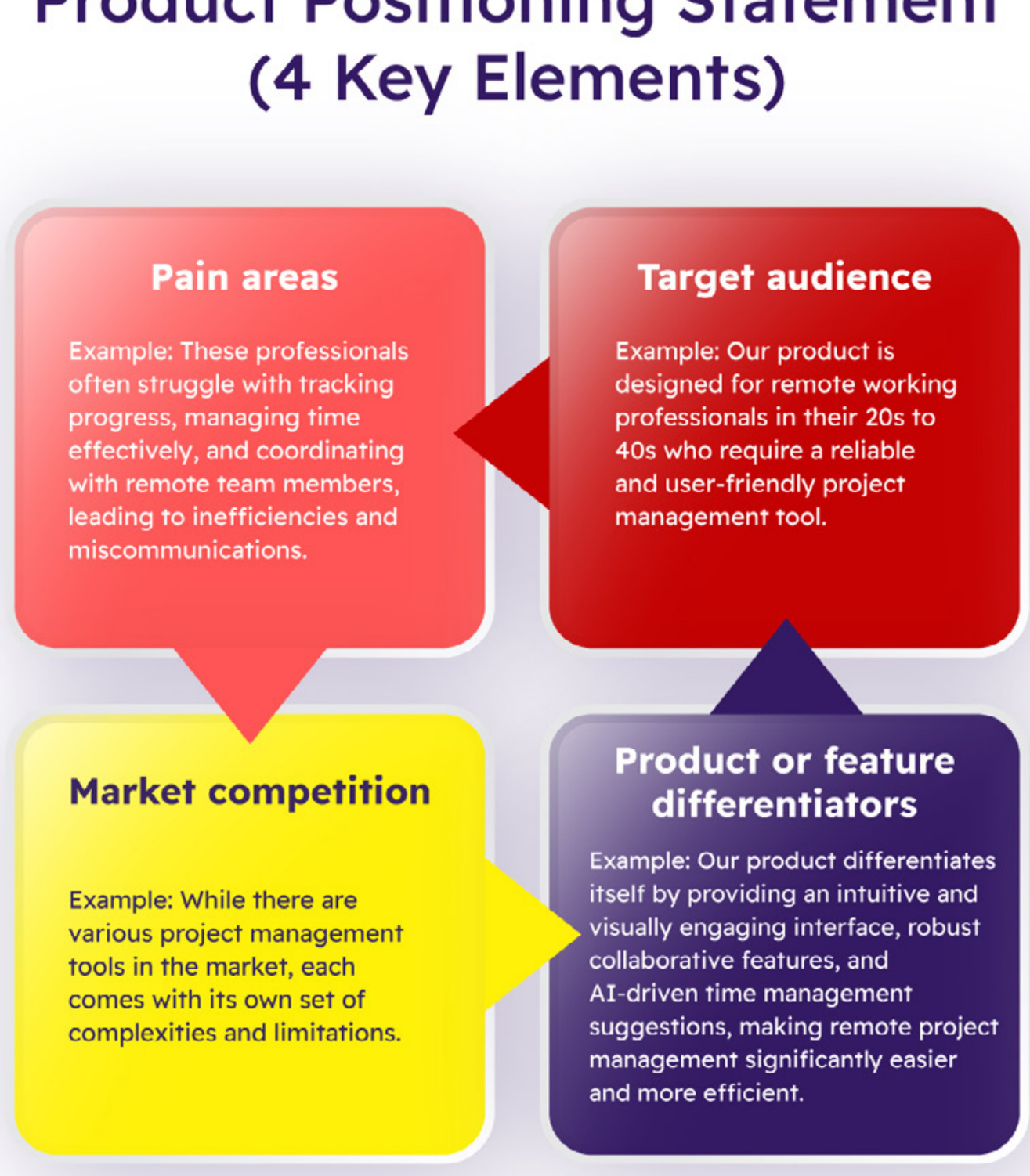
In conclusion, it is essential for product management to conduct a market share study. Positioning your product for market success requires recognizing competitors, collecting relevant data, analyzing that data, and using the insights gained to inform your strategy. In order to stay ahead of the competition and meet the ever-evolving demands of your target market, you must constantly update your analysis and monitor your competitors closely.

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PRODUCT POSITIONING STATEMENT

A product's positioning can make or kill it. When done properly, it has the potential to open up new markets, create significant value for your business, and significantly grow user bases. However, even the most exciting new feature or product can fail if product placement is a little incorrect. Target audience, pain areas, market competition and alternatives, and product (or feature) differentiators are all included in a thorough product positioning statement.

Product Positioning Statement (4 Key Elements)



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A product positioning statement's main goal is to make it easier for customers to find and select your product over rivals. The company's brand is represented by the product positioning statement, which also describes who the company will serve and why.

Deep research, large data, and several stakeholders are all brought together throughout the process of developing a product positioning statement. It entails forcing a strong relationship between the reason a product was produced and what was built by eking out a shared understanding of that reason.

The unique dual function of being both the foundation and the soul of your product line is played by product positioning. The foundation that unites your business and customers around a shared meaningful story reveals where you can succeed in a crowded sector. — Meghan Keanery Anderson, VP of Marketing at Jasper.ai

If you've ever tried to create a product positioning statement, you know how difficult it can be. However, when done successfully, there are both external and internal rewards.

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FOUR PARTS OF A PRODUCT POSITIONING STATEMENT

Let’s begin by going through the four components of a product positioning statement.

When a blank page is looking back at you, it can be extremely scary to create your first product positioning statement. Don’t worry; even seasoned product specialists and marketers still have difficulty with it. However, the task becomes much simpler to comprehend if you can divide the procedure into its essential parts.

Four components make up a product positioning statement:

- The audience
- Their problem(s)
- The competition/alternatives in the market
- The differentiated benefits

“Your positioning statement is more than just a blank-filled nonsense sentence. Your positioning statement should be well-thought-out in every detail and serve as the cornerstone of your whole approach. The group you play in, your audience, your differentiation, your pain areas, etc. To ensure that you will succeed in the market, every component of that needs to be refined. — Mary Sheehan, Head of Lightroom Product Marketing at Adobe

We’ll utilize Monday.com, a workflow platform, as an example to show each component and why it’s so crucial.

1. FIRST PART OF A PRODUCT POSITIONING STATEMENT: TARGET AUDIENCE

A target audience is who you are seeking to reach with your goods; this won’t surprise many people. However, do not disregard this step because you believe it to be simple. The foundation of your product positioning statement will be established by defining the target market.

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When determining your target audiences, there are several aspects you could take into consideration, such as user behavior, organizational traits, geographic information, and consumption patterns.

It’s crucial to choose traits that your business can truly use for targeting rather than choosing them just for the sake of it. For instance, that is not a useful attribute if there is no method to determine how frequently someone drives or if you think there is no connection between the driving frequency and your product. It is merely noise.

Our best guess for Monday.com’s target market is directors and vice presidents for newly remote businesses with more than 200 people. You may reasonably learn all of this information about a target audience in an economical manner. There may be different audience segments at times. Separating the user base into buyer and user groups is the most widely used implementation of this.

Example of a Product Positioning Statement: Figma
The user of the design tool Figma, for instance, is probably a product designer at a software company. The head of product design or the head of product, however, could be the buyer. Most of the time, each target segment requires its own strategy. Therefore you should think about developing a positioning statement for each one.

While working with AdRoll (now NextRoll), Mary Sheehan, Head of Lightroom Product Marketing, saw the difficulty of separating the customer from the user.

If you don’t know who the final customer is, no matter how much user testing you undertake, your launch will fail, according to Mary Sheehan.

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2. SECOND PART OF THE PRODUCT POSITIONING STATEMENT: **PAIN POINTS**

The customer pain points are the second component of a product positioning statement. A pain point is a source of friction in the daily lives of the target audience that a product or service seeks to alleviate. To understand how motivated a user is to use a product, it is essential to comprehend this pain point.

Understanding whether the consumer is aware of your pain point is a crucial component of defining it. You might wish to spend some time promoting awareness if, for example, your company creates new categories.

3. THIRD PART OF THE PRODUCT POSITIONING STATEMENT: **ALTERNATIVES AND COMPETITORS**

The third section of the product positioning statement addresses market rivals and alternatives.

Your comprehension of the market category's competitive environment is influenced by it. The present alternatives to your product should be identified, and a point of view on their advantages and disadvantages should be developed. This is one of the finest ways to identify and improve your grasp of your category.

Consider direct competitors while considering product alternatives. For instance, there is a direct rivalry between Uber and Lyft. Alternately, consider how customers find solutions. For instance, a person could choose to drive himself, utilize public transportation, or walk to get from point A to point Z.

Asana and Trello, which are well-known but pricey per seat, as well as nearly-free choices like Google Sheets (which lacks automation), are direct competitors to Monday.com. Most customers use a free or expensive digital solution to alleviate this frequent pain point.

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For example, if your product is an AI writing helper, the primary alternative for writers today is to write independently. However, even if you think you are a true category inventor, it's crucial to still grasp the status quo, which may very well be "doing nothing." Quite literally, they must choose whether to use a tool or not, not which instrument to employ.

4. FOURTH PART OF THE PRODUCT POSITIONING STATEMENT: **PRODUCT DIFFERENTIATORS**

Your product differentiators are the focus of the fourth and final section of a product positioning statement. Product differentiators are the features that distinguish a product from competitors while simultaneously addressing the stated pain point.

In the end, you need to understand what features of your product would convince a customer to choose it over competing options.

Three factors contribute to product differentiation:

- What drives the differentiation
- The benefits of differentiation
- The level of differentiation

Differentiators make it easier to connect a customer's problem with the attributes or solutions you are offering. It expressly explains why, rather than merely doing it generally, your solution works better for their particular pain spots.

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BCG MATRIX

Business models are centered on offering successful goods or services now, but a sound business plan also considers the future. The Boston matrix, sometimes referred to as the growth-share matrix or the BCG matrix, was developed by the Boston Consulting Group and offers a method for evaluating products based on growth and relative market share. Since 1968, businesses have utilized the BCG model to help them understand which goods will help them take advantage of chances for market share expansion and provide them with a competitive edge.

The BCG matrix model, which was created more than 50 years ago, is still a useful resource for businesses looking to assess their potential.

WHAT IS A BCG MATRIX?

An analysis of a company's products using a BCG matrix is a tool for long-term strategic planning. Companies can use the matrix to find new chances for growth and choose their future investment strategy.

Most companies sell multiple products, but not all of them are profitable. The BCG matrix gives the company a way to compare the success of different products, making it easier to decide which ones to prioritize and which to discontinue. Furthermore, it can assist firms in finding a new product to introduce to the market. On the basis of market growth and relative market share, the matrix is split into four quadrants. Below, each of these quadrants is covered in further detail.

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WHAT ADVANTAGES DOES A BCG MATRIX OFFER?

The BCG matrix is a straightforward framework that can be used by all businesses to assess their products. Anyone may understand from the matrix which of the company's items is doing the best. The matrix not only provides a high-level overview of how products are doing, but it also aids in determining the key elements that determine whether a product is successful or not. It also enables you to compare your products with one another.

The BCG matrix is also a helpful tool for identifying new market opportunities and getting rid of underperforming items, which may ultimately save your business a lot of money.

WHAT ARE THE LIMITATIONS OF A BCG MATRIX?

The BCG matrix has the drawback of not taking into consideration any variables outside market share and growth. As a result, it won't provide you with a complete picture of the reasons why your items are successful or unsuccessful. The BCG matrix is a terrific place to start, but it is not sufficient to determine a company's destiny on its own. It frequently won't give you enough details to deal with challenging business issues.

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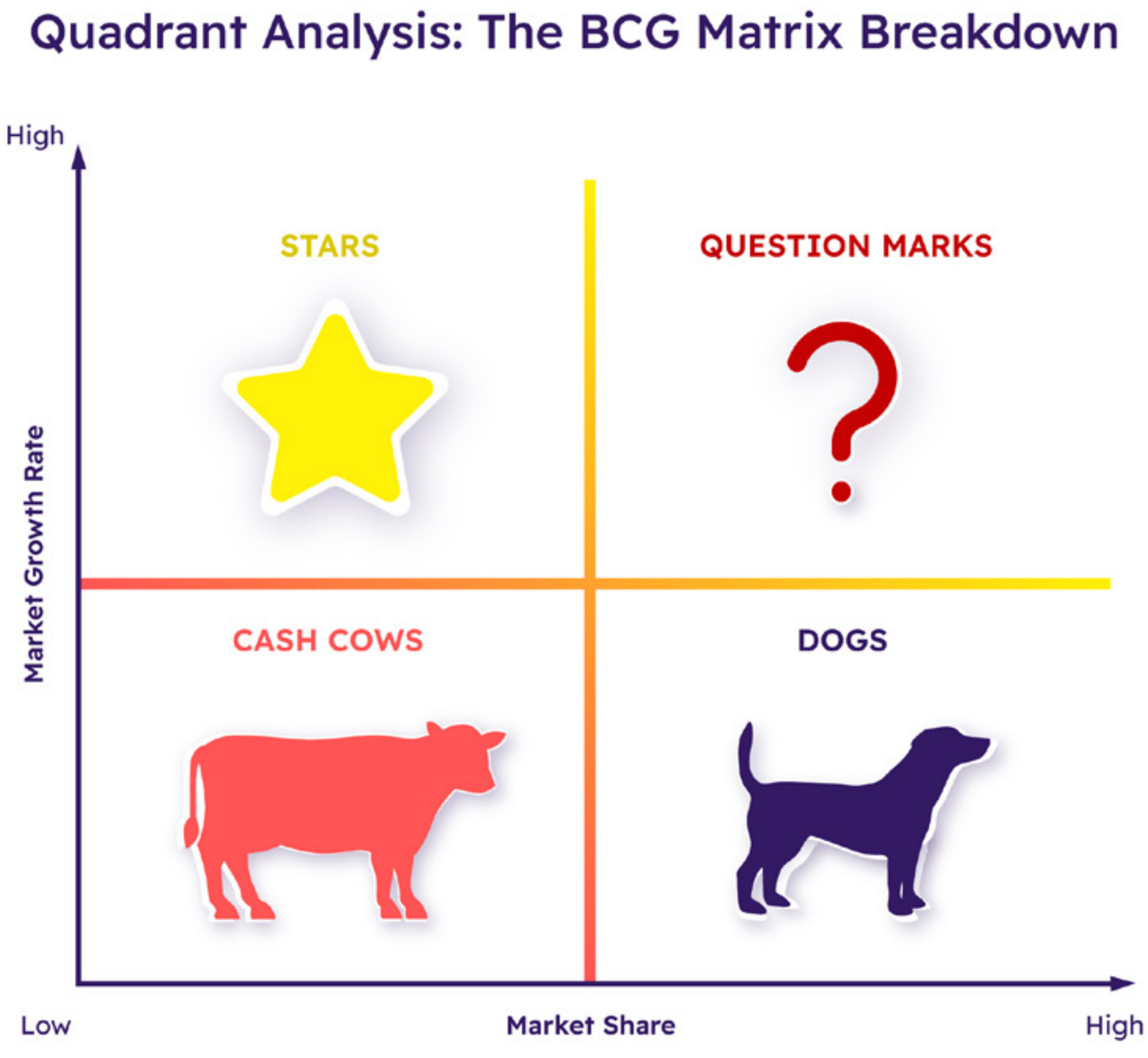
HOW DO YOU CREATE A BCG MATRIX?

Let’s look at how to create your own matrix now that you are familiar with what a BCG matrix is and some of its advantages and disadvantages. You’ll need information on your items’ or services’ relative market share and growth rate in order to analyze your business.

You must do an unbiased analysis of your competitors and include market growth over the next three years while assessing market growth. For this kind of study, Porter’s Five Forces is one helpful paradigm, but if your market is highly fragmented, you may want to use absolute market share. Next, either draw a BCG matrix yourself or use an online BCG matrix template program. Some are supplied without charge, while others need a subscription or are included in another charting program.

BCG QUADRANT

A four-quadrant matrix makes up the BCG quadrant. Stars (upper left), Question Marks (upper right), Cash Cows (lower left), and Dogs (lower right) are the designations for the four quadrants.



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You may determine the border between each quadrant by putting each of your items in the proper box according to where they stand in terms of market share and growth. This will depend in part on how your business stacks up against the competition. Here is a breakdown of each quadrant of the BCG matrix.

THE STAR

Stars are the businesses, units, or products that have the highest revenue and best market share. Oftentimes, monopolies and first-to-market items are also referred to as Stars. Stars, however, need a lot of money because of their rapid rise. In most cases, this has the same financial impact on income and expenditure. If stars continue to succeed until a market's rapid development slows, they may eventually turn into cash cows. The investment in stars is a fundamental component of a BCG growth strategy.

CASH COWS QUADRANT

A market leader known as a "cash cow" makes more money than it spends. Cash Cows are companies or goods with a large market share but little potential for expansion. Cash Cows provide the resources needed to transform a Question Mark into the industry leader, pay for the business's operating expenses, finance R&D, pay off debt, and provide dividends to shareholders. To sustain the current level of production, businesses are encouraged to either invest in cash cows or passively "milk" the benefits.

DOGS QUADRANT

Dogs are a unit or product with a small market share and slow growth rates. They are also referred to as pets occasionally. They usually achieve financial parity, neither spending nor earning much money. Dogs are typically seen as cash traps since businesses tie up money in them despite the fact that they seldom generate any revenue. The divestiture of these business units is highly likely.

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QUESTION MARKS QUADRANT

Despite having a small market share, certain areas of a firm offer great development potential. They spend a lot of money and produce little in return. Using question marks costs a business money. These business units have the potential to become Stars in a market with strong growth, nevertheless, as a result of their quick expansion. Businesses are urged to sell Question Marks if they do not have the potential for growth or to invest in them if they do.

HOW DO YOU USE THE BCG MATRIX TO STRATEGIZE?

Knowing where each product stands will allow you to evaluate each one fairly and plan the direction of your company. You can determine which goods to prioritize and which to eliminate entirely using the BCG matrix.

HERE ARE FOUR WAYS TO STRATEGIZE FOR YOUR COMPANY USING THE BCG MATRIX:

Increase your investment in Stars and Question Marks if your objective is to concentrate on innovation. By investing more in something, for instance, you might be able to turn a Question Mark into a Star and then, subsequently, a Cash Cow.

Keep a product in the same sector and don’t do anything to it if you can’t put more money into it. A Cash Cow has the benefit of being an established product that requires less work to maintain.

By lowering your investment and obtaining the most cash flow possible from a product, you can raise its general profitability. Use this tactic most effectively with Cash Cows. Redirect the money used to purchase a product to another project. Dogs respond well to this tactic.

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The long-term growth of any product is impossible to forecast because consumer preferences are always shifting. As market conditions change, you should frequently update and improve your BCG matrix. You should be prepared to leave if the stakes are raised since, for instance, a product that was a Question Mark could change suddenly into a Dog. The ultimate goal is not to achieve success in any one industry but rather to establish a diverse portfolio. You need goods in all four quadrants of your BCG matrix to ensure a steady stream of revenue and a prosperous future for your business.

WHAT IS THE ROLE OF CASH FLOW IN THE BCG MATRIX?

Making the most of the BCG matrix requires an understanding of cash flow. Bruce Henderson, the founder of BCG, stated in 1968 that the following four guidelines should direct your approach to producing cash flow strategies:

- Market share affects the profits and money made. Strong market share and strong margins go hand in hand.

- You must invest in your assets if you want to expand. Growth rates affect the extra cash needed to hold shares.

- A large market share must be acquired or earned. Market share acquisition necessitates a further escalation or investment.

- No market for a product can expand indefinitely. When growth slows, you must capitalize on the chance; if you wait, you will miss out. Cash that cannot be invested in that product serves as the payback.

That final principle is more crucial than ever right now. Markets today move faster than they did fifty years ago, and BCG has since issued updated suggestions for how to interpret and use matrix data. Keeping a steady supply of question marks positions you to capitalize on the upcoming trend. Contrarily, cash cows must be milked effectively because they could lose popularity and profitability more quickly.

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WHAT IS A REAL EXAMPLE OF THE BCG MATRIX?

Looking at a real-world BCG matrix example might be beneficial for making sure you comprehend a BCG analysis. The Coca-Cola Company, which owns many more beverage lines than just its name-brand product, is a well-known BCG matrix example.

Diet Coke and Minute Maid are represented by Question Marks in the Coca-Cola BCG matrix example since they have a small yet potential market. Because they dominate the markets in Europe and the United States, respectively, and exhibit no signs of stopping expansion, its bottled water brands Kinley and Dasani are Stars. Its name-brand beverage has a large market share and low growth, making it a Cash Cow. However, Coca-Cola is also a Dog since legislation restricting soft drinks, in addition to a change in public opinion, has reduced soda sales.

The real-world BCG matrix example from the Coca-Cola firm demonstrates a crucial lesson: A product may occasionally fit into more than one quadrant.

Tip

Sentiment research is one of the finest techniques to increase sales. You can use sentiment analysis to find out what customers think of your products and brand. To take into account political, economic, social, and technical variables, you can also perform a PEST analysis.

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THE GE-MCKINSEY MATRIX

The BCG matrix is a fantastic tool, but not every firm should use it. As the product life cycle advances, several businesses discover that they don't have items in each quadrant or a consistent product flow between the quadrants.

Some consultants recommend switching to the GE/McKinsey matrix, which evaluates goods based on the strength of the business unit and the industry's attractiveness rather than market share, the complexity of which may be beyond the control of a single corporation. Comparing the two models can unearth information that can help your business flourish. The GE-McKinsey Matrix, often known as the General Electric Matrix or the Nine-Box Matrix, is a portfolio analysis tool employed in corporate planning to evaluate strategic business units or product lines.

This matrix combines the competitive strength of a business unit and the industry attractiveness. A company might accordingly manage its business units. After that, it can decide where to invest, keep a position, harvest, or sell.

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ORIGINS

General Electric (GE) hired McKinsey & Company in 1970 to advise on managing its enormous and intricate portfolio of strategic business units. This framework was established by McKinsey, not GE, to assist GE in managing its corporate-level strategic choices.

The GE-McKinsey Matrix uses several variables to determine the two dimensions, unlike the BCG Matrix, which has received much criticism for using only one single dimension for analysis.

- Industry attractiveness, and
- Competitive strength

INDUSTRY ATTRACTIVENESS

This element relates to how easily the business unit can generate profits in the sector. Consider the company's long-term growth potential, industry scale, profitability, entrance and exit hurdles, etc., while assessing it along this dimension. Consider the influence of suppliers and buyers as well as any additional environmental elements that might affect an industry's appeal.

Also, consider the price, labor needs, and evolution of your product or service. All these factors must be considered while concentrating on the distant future. This is because investments require a long-term commitment as opposed to a short-term one.

Industry Attractiveness, the vertical axis of this matrix, is split into three categories: High, Medium, and Low. The profitability of an industry determines how attractive it is to businesses looking to enter and compete there. The industry is more appealing the bigger the profit potential. The amount of competition in an industry now and anticipated changes to the competitive environment will impact its profitability.

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When assessing an industry's attractiveness, consider long-term trends rather than immediate changes.

COMPETITIVE STRENGTH

Consider how a business unit performs in relation to its industry rivals when assessing it in this dimension. Among the elements that can assist a company in determining its competitive advantage in an industry are:

- The market share it holds
- Possibility of market share growth
- Brand recognition
- The company's margins of profit
- Customer satisfaction and loyalty
- Uniqueness of its products or services

If the company has a competitive advantage, consider whether that advantage is long-lasting or simply fleeting. Determine the length of time the company can exploit its position in the industry if it has a durable competitive advantage.

Competitive Strength, the horizontal of this matrix, is split into three categories: High, Medium, and Low. This factor evaluates how competitive a company is in relation to its rivals. This dimension shows how well-positioned the company is to compete in that market. A company has an advantage over its competitors because of its strengths. These advantages are frequently referred to as durable competitive advantages, firm-specific advantages, or unique selling points (USPs). It's crucial to consider a company's ongoing competitiveness over the long term in addition to its competitive position today.

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STRATEGIC IMPLICATIONS

A corporation has nine potential strategic postures based on the three degrees of industry attractiveness and competitive strength (High, Medium, and Low). The options for strategic actions are as follows:

- The Grow/Invest strategy
- Earnings strategy and selectivity, and
- Harvest/Divest approach

The Invest/Grow segment is the ideal place for a business to be. If a company operates in a moderately to highly attractive industry and holds a moderately to highly competitive position within that market, it can find itself in this situation. Such circumstances offer tremendous growth possibilities. A firm needs resources, such as capital and assets, to expand. These investments are required to boost capacity, expand the consumer base through marketing, or enhance the products through R&D. In addition to organic growth; a company might opt to expand outside through mergers and acquisitions (M&A). Again, carrying out M&A activities will demand investments.

Resource limitations that prevent a business in these segments from expanding and achieving or sustaining market leadership are the most significant problems.

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SELECTIVITY/EARNINGS STRATEGY

This tactic is also known as the “Hold” tactic. A company in the selectivity/earnings category is a little trickier. In an appealing industry, the business is either in a low to moderately competitive position or it is in an excessively competitive position in a less appealing industry. The forecast for the firm is a key factor in deciding whether to invest. It can anticipate strengthening its competitive position or moving to a more desirable sector.

The company should think carefully before making a competitive move. The majority of your investments as a business should go into the Invest/Grow portion. Next, strengthen your competitive position using the remaining selectivity/earnings area investments. You should carefully monitor the development and improvements and adjust your strategy as necessary.

HARVEST/DIVEST STRATEGY

This business should use this technique if it:

- enjoys a low level of competition
- works in an unpleasant field, or
- a hybrid of the two

The prospects of these companies are not particularly bright. The tactical options to take into account are:
Sell the company units to a buyer interested in a fair price to divest the assets. This is often referred to as a carve-out.

CHOOSE A HARVEST STRATEGY

It is not strange to consider selling the company unit to another market participant with a stronger competitive position. The purchaser may be more qualified to make it successful. Another option is for the buyer to use synergies to produce value by merging different tasks. The company may spend the funds from the divestiture under the Invest/Grow part in another area of its portfolio.

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Harvesting describes when a business unit receives just the right funding to remain viable. In other words, whatever is left gets cashed by the company. This is a very short-term viewpoint. Such companies eventually liquidate their assets and leave the market.

SUMMARY

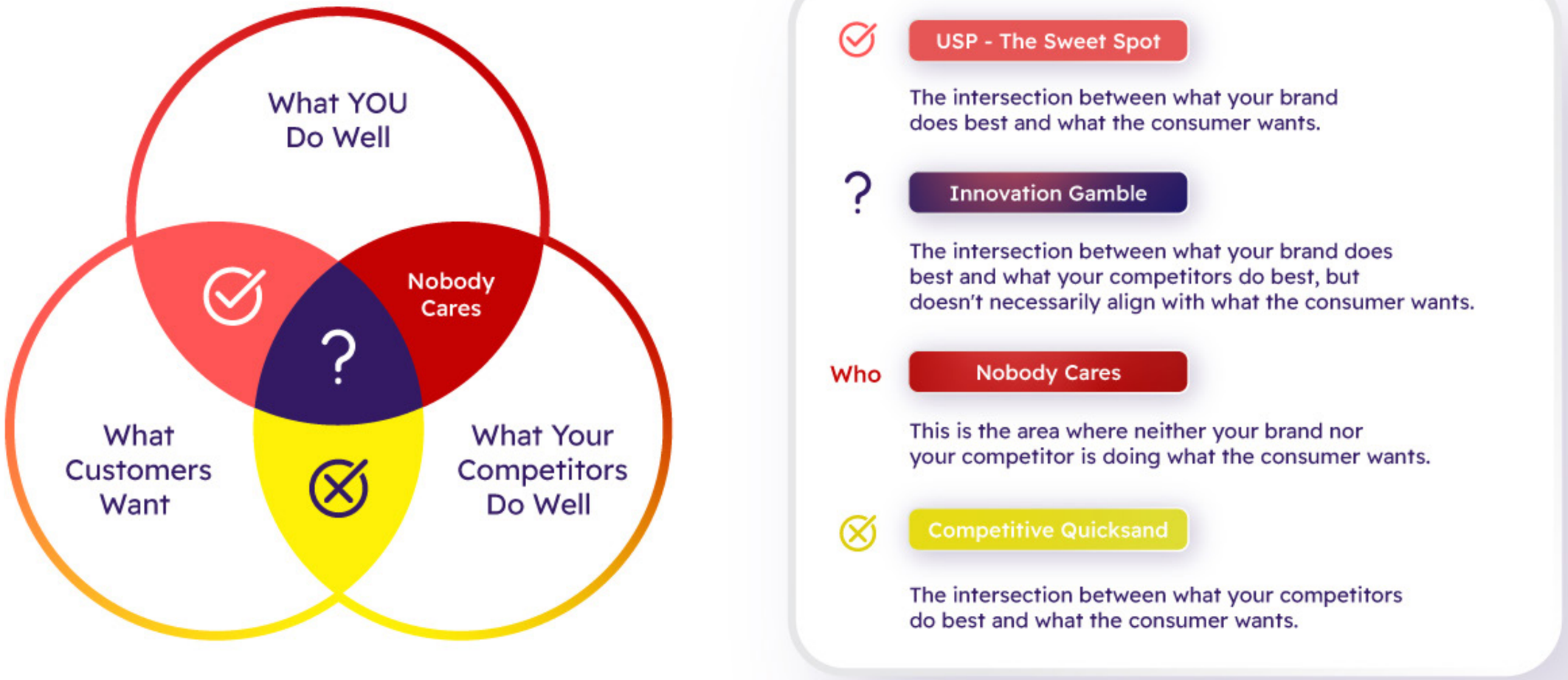
While market attractiveness refers to the level of industry rivalry, a company's competitive strength refers to its capacity to compete successfully in the long run. The GE McKinsey Matrix is a good substitute for the BCG Matrix since it has the benefit of using two variables that combine several elements. Brand equity and industry structure are two such elements, but it isn't easy to measure them and combine them into a single figure that can be represented on the nine-box matrix. However, this model offers corporate strategists in portfolio management a great place to start when making investment choices.

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PRODUCT POSITIONING

IDENTIFYING UNIQUE SELLING PROPOSITION

Every company requires one distinct attribute to stand out from competitors and connect with customers.
A unique selling proposition, or USP, distinguishes your brand and product from the rivals. A USP should drive your marketing message since it encourages repeat business. Understanding your consumer, rivals, and products will help you identify your USP.



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You might have a terrific product or service that stands out from the competition in your industry. You won't be successful if you can't relate to your intended audience. To make sure that your brand and offers are well-received by your audience, it is crucial to define and market your unique selling proposition (USP).

The majority of marketers see USPs as a means to differentiate your business. Even though this is true, a USP goes beyond just a differentiator. It's a crucial choice for small business marketing that can define your company's personality.

HOW DO YOU DEFINE A UNIQUE SELLING POSITION?

A USP, or unique value proposition, is the distinctive quality that distinguishes a company's goods or services from those of its rivals. It is a brief explanation of why present and potential customers should select your solution.

Finding your USP may appear simple at first glance, especially since it may be anything: a unique product feature, a memorable customer experience, a stirring account of your company, or even great shipping. However, the range of options makes it more difficult to identify a USP.

Your USP should contribute to developing a strong brand for your company that appeals to customers in ways other than through the promotion of your goods or services.

A brand slogan or marketing statement can serve as a USP. It will take up residence in your company's identity and play a significant role in its decisions, operations, and corporate culture.

It's simple to understand, and FedEx offers a great USP example: "When it absolutely, positively has to be there overnight." However, its most appealing quality is how well it embodies FedEx's corporate vision, showcasing its commitment to offering quick courier services.

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HOW TO IDENTIFY YOUR USP?

There is no one-size-fits-all solution for a USP. Businesses in related and diverse industries have distinctive USPs that stand out to buyers. Even while each USP is distinct, most businesses follow a similar procedure to come up with them. The following four steps can help you identify your USP.

1. CONNECT WITH YOUR CUSTOMERS.

Since their activities result in sales for your company, your consumers are your USP's most trustworthy and important information source. Knowing them only on a surface level is insufficient. You must comprehend the motivations underlying their behavior to identify your USP.
The following questions to better comprehend your customers:

- Why do they keep coming back and doing business with you?
- Why do they cease making purchases from you?
- Which customer segments purchase your goods with similar preferences?
- Which segments of your consumer base have radically differing tastes for your products?

Utilise customer relationship management metrics and other technologies to interact with customers and analyze their behavior. Find out what makes people want to do business with you.

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Tip

To effectively assess the behavior and preferences of your target market, use customer surveys and other market research methods.

2. TO INFORM YOUR USP, DETERMINE WHAT MAKES YOUR BRAND UNIQUE.

The word “U” in USP stands for unique, which is what your brand’s USP is mostly based on. Why your customers choose to purchase your goods can be understood by identifying what makes your brand distinct and different from others in the same sector. It lets you concentrate on these distinctive components and change them into more lucrative and valuable success ingredients.

3. WHEN DECIDING ON YOUR USP, ASSESS YOUR COMPETITORS.

Understanding the market in which you operate is much improved by studying your competitors. Look at the advertisements or marketing messaging they utilize rather than the things they sell. You may describe the unique selling proposition of each business and how they set themselves apart from one another using this.

You may determine how your rivals want to be seen by looking at their advertisements. This is an essential stage in figuring out your USP and considering the market for your company.

4. FOLLOW MARKET TRENDS TO CREATE YOUR USP.

You may already be aware of your customer’s preferences and what distinguishes your brand from your rivals. However, this knowledge won’t be useful if you don’t follow current market trends, such as those in technology, marketing, retail, and other areas.

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Depending on what's popular, consumer preferences can change quickly. Therefore you need to be ready to adapt your marketing and sales strategies to consider these changes. If not, you risk having your market penetration attempts be ineffective.

EXAMPLES OF USP'S

Here are some great instances of USP statements that, in the view of their target audiences, capture the competitive advantages of these brands.

The M&M's slogan is "Melts in your mouth, not in your hand."This unique USP statement clarifies why M&Ms are superior to other chocolate candies. Despite the USP's seeming simplicity, it has been strong enough to win the support of many individuals.

Making this kind of USP statement involves risk, especially if your product doesn't live up to its claims. However, M&Ms succeeded, and consumers ardently supported the company. Canva's mission statement reads, "Empowering the world to design."

Leading design platform Canva is living up to its USP. For people of all ages, Canva has emerged as the preferred design tool. Compared to rival products like Photoshop and Procreate, its interface and features are simple to use. The support Canva has garnered in the design community is reflected in its USP.

"SoundCloud is the first place to hear new music. Start your journey with your first music uploaded to SoundCloud. Many musicians, like Billie Eilish, Lizzo, and Post Malone, began their careers as musicians thanks to SoundCloud, a website that enables new musicians to submit their music and share it with other musicians and fans all over the world. SoundCloud's USP statement sounds genuine and not merely a motivating catchphrase in light of the success of its musicians.

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When users know that customers have successfully used a product or service, they are more willing to try it. SoundCloud conveyed this information in a single line.

Overall, Know the competitive edge of your business. Your organization naturally possesses your brand's unique selling proposition. It offers a good chance to look at the actions of your customers and business to see what makes you unique. The time and resources that many brands invested in creating their USP are largely responsible for their current success.

There isn't a set formula to define your brand's USP, but online resources and successful cases can assist and motivate your effort. You'll be able to develop a strong USP to support your future success the sooner you recognize your company's unique advantage.

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WHAT IS PRODUCT POSITIONING?

The “product positioning” exercise is a marketing strategy that requires groups to decide where they want their product to sit in the market.

Your product’s positioning may be that it is more reasonably priced than the competition, that it is faster than the competition, that it is more feature-rich than the competition, that it is ethical, luxury, that it is revolutionizing the industry, etc. The goal of product positioning is to convey a certain image of your product to potential buyers. You’ll need to show how this solution outperforms the others in solving your consumers’ concerns.

WHY IS THE POSITIONING OF A PRODUCT IMPORTANT?

According to an old proverb, if your product is for everyone, it truly isn’t for anyone. To get a competitive edge, brands should seek to target particular consumers.

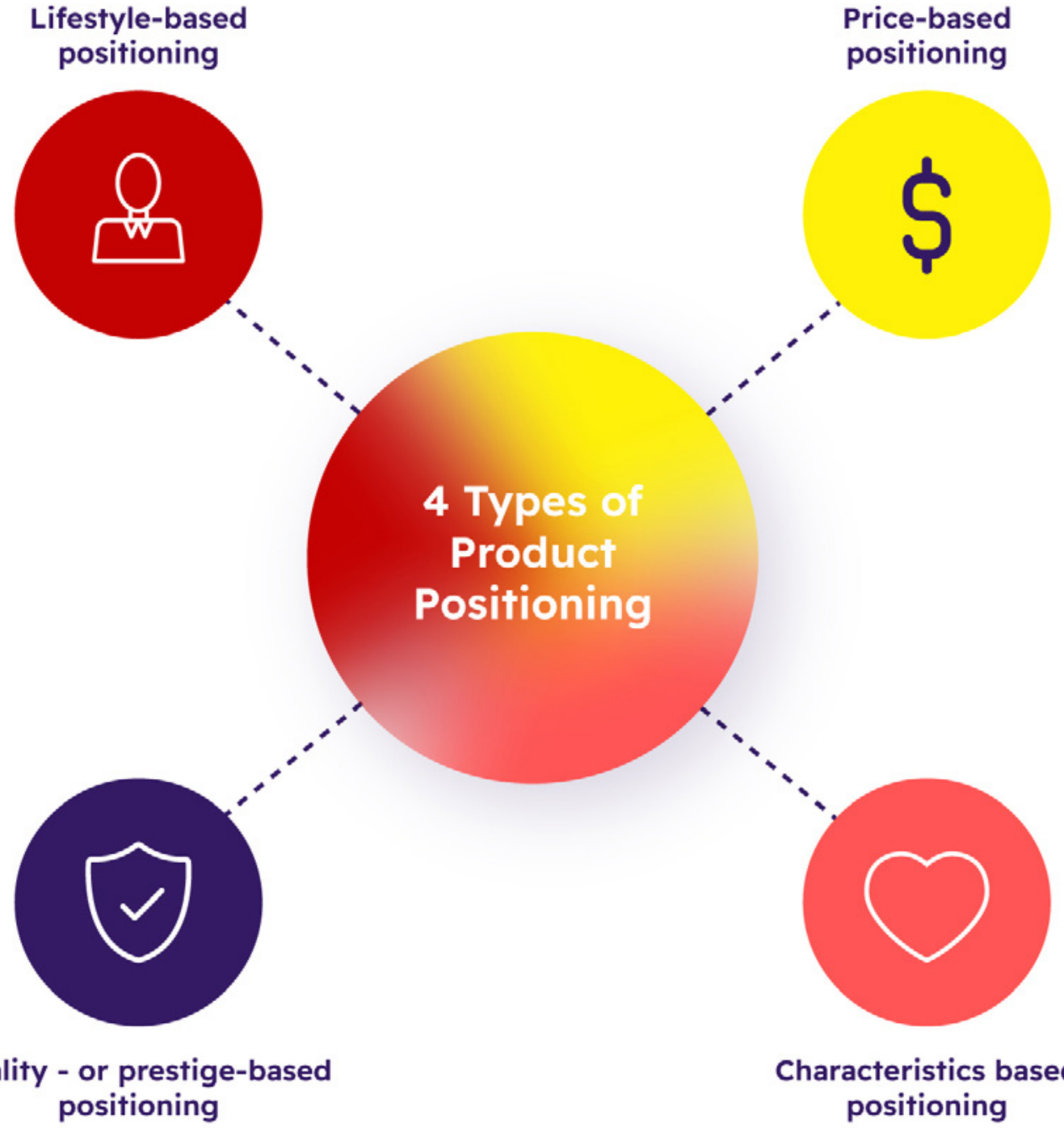
The same is true with product positioning. Based on how you promote and explain the advantages of your product, you can influence how customers view it.

You can communicate with your ideal customer directly with more accurate targeting. Users’ questions and major pain areas should be addressed in your product positioning.

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WHAT ARE THE TYPES OF PRODUCT POSITIONING?

As we discussed above, there are various kinds of product positioning; which one you select will depend entirely on the preferences and requirements of your target audience.



The following placement techniques are most frequently used:

PRICE-BASED POSITIONING

One of the first things buyers look at when evaluating their options is a product's price. Cost is crucial in both the business-to-business and business-to-consumer sectors, but a product's pricing also tells you a lot about where it stands in the market.

Offering your products at a price that is competitive with or less expensive than those of your competitors is known as price-based positioning. Most frequently, customers buy these goods exclusively on the basis of price, without weighing their options or even evaluating them.

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In the grocery market, where brands directly compete on cost reductions, one can find the best illustration of price-based positioning.

LIFESTYLE-BASED POSITIONING

Associating their product with a specific usage or way of life allows brands to further establish their market position. An example of a finance app is one that promotes itself as a tool for building personal wealth through high-risk trading and investments, appealing to a certain fast-paced lifestyle, or as a tool for helping families save money each month. Although features of products may be the same or comparable, the advantages of employing those features will be described (positioned) differently.

CHARACTERISTICS BASED POSITIONING

Reliability, performance, efficiency, sustainability, beauty, and originality are all qualities that contribute to a product's distinctive positioning. When you position your goods based on these attributes, you encourage customers to form an opinion about your brand based on the benefits your product can provide. Just take a look at how automakers like Volvo and Toyota represent themselves: Volvo is about safety, and so on.

QUALITY OR PRESTIGE-BASED POSITIONING

Recall how we claimed that using price as a positioning tool was possible. Prestige positioning is when brands avoid price competition and instead use their higher prices to imply that their goods are of a better caliber or status. Even though a watch is always a watch, Rolex has cemented and permanently guarded its position in the premium watch industry.

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POSITIONING MAPPING

Businesses have a purpose to employ effective techniques in order to compete in the market. Marketers employ strategic positioning to give their goods or services the best possible chance of succeeding in such a cutthroat environment. If you work in marketing, knowing how to execute strategic positioning can help you increase sales and make your company more competitive. The eight steps you can use to construct a positioning map are discussed in this section, along with how to create one.

CREATING A POSITIONING MAP

It's important to clarify what a positioning map is before we look at how to make one. A positioning map, also known as a perceptual map, is a technique used to determine the mental locations in prospects' and customers' brains where your company's products will have the greatest impact. In this situation, the company can expect to have a sufficient number of potential consumers to turn a profit. A perception map is a graphic depiction of brand perceptions in the industry in which your company operates.

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The following eight steps can be used to develop a positioning map for your company:

1. DRAW A POSITIONING MAP

Before you start utilizing a positioning map, you should get out some paper and a pen. On your page, doodle a vertical line or the Y-axis. The X-axis or a horizontal line should now be drawn halfway across the vertical line. Four quadrants make up the box you have. A digital positioning map can be produced with word processing or presentation software.

2. PICK TWO FEATURES TO EMPHASIZE

Pick two qualities that describe your products. It is best to pick two characteristics that are significant too, meaningful to, or desired by your target audience. If your company sells healthy items, for instance, your horizontal axis may be “healthy,” with the left side of the line denoting “unhealthy” or “low health” and the right side denoting “very healthy”. The taste of your products could be another quality. Your vertical line can stand in for “taste,” with the bottom end of the line denoting “not tasty” and the top end denoting “very tasty”.

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3. INCLUDE YOUR COMPANY AND ITS COMPETITORS

The circles that stand in for each of your rivals can now be added. Put them in the quadrant that most accurately reflects how they and your consumers perceive them. Create a circle that represents their market share to give your positioning map more context. For instance, the circle can be made larger the larger their market share is in comparison to other competitors. To show your position on the positioning map, add a circle now. Your market share in relation to your competition will determine how big your circle is.

It's important to be objective while adding your company and its rivals. The advantages of one's own brand are frequently overstated, while the advantages of rival brands are frequently understated. It may be useful to use an impartial third party to more precisely determine which qualities your customers regard most highly and in what order. A quantitative survey can be used as another method to find out how your customers feel about your brand and that of your rivals.

4. ANALYSE YOUR BRAND POSITIONING CHART TO IDENTIFY ANY GAPS IN POSITIONING

The placement map you made can offer some insightful information. It might provide you with a clear image of the competitive market that your company competes in and might assist you in determining your place within it. The outcomes of your positioning map enable you to visualize your brand in relation to your rivals using a two-attribute matrix. Finding your company's positioning gap is the goal of the positioning map.

You might evaluate your positioning map in the following ways, using the earlier example of nutritious food:
In the quadrant indicating "healthy and tasty," does the positioning map show a gap with little competition? If so, you might have discovered where to position your brand most effectively.

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Even though there may be no competition in the quadrant denoting “tasty but unhealthy,” you should still consider whether this is the best place for your business to be positioned.

You can determine if there is a positioning discrepancy in the quadrant “very healthy, but not tasty.” Think about whether or not this is a lucrative market to be in.

The final quadrant, which stands for “not-so-healthy and not-so-tasty,” can be empty. Customers are not likely to want to eat something that is both unhealthy and unappealing.

5. FOR FURTHER INSIGHTS, CONSIDER ALTERNATE FEATURES

Imagine that the initial iteration of your positioning map did not provide you with information on a desirable positioning gap or niche. The qualities you utilized in your initial placement map could then be swapped out for one or the other. Select qualities that matter to your customers or prospects to achieve the greatest results. The possibility for your market share increases as the attribute becomes more important to your customers, yet it may also make you more competitive. A positioning map can be used to identify a lucrative market sector that your company can control in the eyes of its customers.

Your product or service will determine any other features you utilize. You might think about including special elements from your product or service in your positioning map. The usual factors to take into account include usability, service accessibility, financing possibilities, speed, frequent upgrades, fuel economy, color, beauty and style, sexiness, strength, reliability, or environmental friendliness.

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6. PUT TOGETHER A POSITIONING STATEMENT

You can develop a positioning statement once you've determined where your brand will perform best. Such a statement is one or two sentences long and describes how your brand's offerings are different from those of your rivals. Consider the following inquiries as you create your positioning statement:

- Who are you trying to reach?
- Which category do your goods or services fall under?
- Which of your products or services has the most benefit?
- Do you have any evidence for that advantage?

7. CREATE YOUR TAGLINE

A tagline or slogan can be developed after a positioning statement. This can also be used to contact potential customers on the outside. A tagline is a streamlined form of your positioning statement that you can use in marketing campaigns to communicate your special offering to customers and other stakeholders.

8. TRY OUT DIFFERENT MARKETING POSITIONS

Once you've written your positioning statement, test it out and play around with it. Obtaining customer input on whether your positioning statement accomplishes its goal is advantageous. To test your positioning statement, the ideal approach is to do both qualitative and quantitative research. Your research can take the form of surveys, polls, focus groups, and in-depth interviews. Your marketing positioning can be strengthened, and your marketing strategies can be modified based on the results of your tests.

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CHOICE OF MARKETING CHANNELS

FACTORS INFLUENCING THE CHOICE OF A MARKETING CHANNEL

When choosing a marketing or distribution channel, extensive and methodical research is required. It has an impact on the channel's intermediaries' plans in addition to the marketing plan and organizational objectives. The place aspect of the marketing mix, which encompasses the distribution system, necessitates management time and effort as well as expenditures for modifications. Choosing the appropriate route is, therefore, crucial in order to prevent any future alterations. The following are the elements that affect the selection of the channel:

TARGET MARKET COVERAGE

Target market coverage is the ability to reach and provide services to customers who are located in a company's target market. Companies of all sizes must decide precisely how they will market their goods and services to consumers. Smaller businesses typically concentrate on localized, smaller markets, but larger businesses are required to meet consumer demand in more expansive, even worldwide, marketplaces. Numerous factors must be taken into account when a corporation decides which channel would best serve consumer needs.

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Target market coverage is the first element that has a significant impact on channel selection. Businesses must assess the scope of their target market and their financial resources to make sure they are adequately covered. For instance, a tiny neighborhood bakery might only advertise in nearby towns, which would make up a relatively small portion of its target market. On the other side, Kohlberg & Company, the owner of Sara Lee and Thomas' trademarks, has access to a far wider market because of this.

Businesses have to choose between an intensive, selective, or exclusive distribution strategy depending on the size of their target market and the goods and services they sell.

PRODUCT-RELATED FACTORS

There are product-related elements that can affect channel decisions in addition to goal market penetration and customer requirements. Unit value, perishability, and the size and weight of a product are examples of product-related factors. These elements may have an impact on the choices that businesses make regarding distribution.

The following factors are related to products: unit value, volume and weight, perishability, standardization, technical nature, and life cycle stage.

UNIT VALUE

Decisions regarding channel length can be influenced by a product's unit value or the price that a business charges for one unit or item. The number of middlemen in the marketing channel is related to the channel length. For instance, nonperishable goods like crackers, bandages, and tissues, which have a low unit value, will have a considerably shorter distribution channel than goods with a high unit value, like vehicles, boats, and airplanes. Companies look for a shorter distribution channel because of the difficulties and expenses associated with transporting bulky or uncomfortable products. There are businesses that specialize in transporting more costly and sophisticated goods.

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PERISHABILITY

The perishability of a product refers to how likely it is that it will go bad, deteriorate, or expire if not used right away. The perishability of a product also affects channel selection. For instance, the marketing channel for Tropicana, a company that makes orange juice, differs greatly from the Ritz Crackers channel for Nabisco. Because orange juice needs to be kept cool throughout the distribution process, Tropicana chooses channel options that let it maintain the quality of the product. For businesses that produce perishable goods, one of the most crucial aspects is working with channel partners that are specialists in handling, storing, and moving perishable goods. Perishability can affect channel length in addition to the unit value. Because these products have a short shelf life, businesses that sell perishable goods like milk, cheese, and meat need a shorter distribution channel.

DIMENSION AND WEIGHT

The volume and weight of a product affect channel length in a similar way to its unit value. The density and heaviness of one unit of a product determine its bulk and weight. To prevent problems that can occur when a product is handled by too many intermediaries, businesses that sell bigger, heavier items are more likely to adopt a direct or short distribution channel. For instance, because they are large and heavy, hot tubs or personal spas are more likely to sustain product damage during transportation. In addition, fewer middlemen are frequently used between the producer and the consumer to reduce the high expenses of distributing hot tubs.

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STANDARDIZATION

Decisions about a product's channel also depend on its standardization. Standardized products are identical in terms of how they are produced. The quality of standardized items is constant and uniform. Grain and corn are two examples of standardized agricultural products. Due to these products' standardization, consumers cannot distinguish between them. Compared to customized products, standardized products have a larger channel length. Depending on the needs of the customer, customized items are modified. They often need a narrower distribution network. Before choosing a channel, businesses must consider the effects of standardization.

PRODUCT'S TECHNICAL NATURE

Products supplied in the tech sector are frequently more complicated and call for an onboarding procedure. For instance, the customer relationship management company Salesforce provides businesses with a cloud-based program that enables them to handle millions of contacts or individuals as they progress through the sales cycle from lead to prospect to customer. Products with a technical component frequently have a short channel length, which means there is no middleman between the business consumer and the manufacturerBusiness-to-business (B2B) distribution is used when selling a product that requires onboarding, implementation, training, support, and maintenance. If your business uses Salesforce, you may consult with a dedicated CRM expert who will oversee your account and ensure you're getting the most out of the platform.

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PRODUCT LIFE-CYCLE STAGE

Channel decisions may also be influenced by a product's life cycle stage. The phases of a product's existence, from launch through peak sales to eventual decline, are together referred to as the "product life cycle.". For instance, businesses may choose more cautious channel choices during the debut period of a product's life cycle, when earnings and consumer awareness of a product are low. Businesses may increase distribution as a product moves into its growth stage to satisfy customer demand. A business must make sure that its distribution strategy matches shifting consumer demand as the product moves towards the maturity stage and eventually the declining state.

COMPETITIVE ENVIRONMENT

The channel choice is also influenced by the channel that the rivals choose. A business can choose the same channel that its rivals have chosen. For instance, the majority of e-commerce shopping apps select comparable distribution networks. Companies occasionally choose wholly different marketing strategies than their rivals. For instance, unlike typical salons where customers must go to receive treatments, Urban Company offers personalized services that are available at the doorstep of the customers.

COMPANY RESOURCES AND CAPABILITIES

Among the most crucial elements affecting the channel selection are:

Financial Stability: A corporation can readily choose direct routes if its finances are stable. However, indirect methods should be used if a company is not financially sound.

If a business wishes to have complete control over distribution, it will choose short or direct channels. But if a business does not want to have control over the distribution, it should select indirect routes.

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OFFLINE MARKETING CHANNELS

In the fast-paced digital world we live in now, it's easy to forget how important offline marketing platforms are. In contrast, offline marketing is still an effective approach to engage with potential customers in a more direct and personal way, despite the benefits of online marketing. In this chapter, we will examine various crucial offline marketing channels, such as physical stores, direct mail, telemarketing, trade exhibitions, and events, and how companies may use them to successfully reach their target market.

RETAIL OUTLETS

Retail establishments, whether they are physical stores or pop-up shops, offer businesses a fantastic chance to demonstrate their goods or services to customers. The benefit of retail establishments is the opportunity to provide an engaging in-person experience. Businesses can build stronger relationships with their consumers by using eye-catching displays, engaging demos, and knowledgeable salespeople. Retail establishments can entice impulse buys and foster brand loyalty by putting merchandise in useful places and running alluring promotions.

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DIRECT MAIL

Direct mail is still an effective offline marketing channel, despite the rise of digital communication. Businesses can interact with prospective customers in a memorable and tactile way by sending actual mail items like postcards, catalogs, or personalized letters. The correct audience targeting and the creation of captivating content is essential to the success of direct mail operations. Businesses can successfully stand out in the recipient's mailbox and make a lasting impression by using well-designed, eye-catching materials and using personalized messaging.

TELEMARKETING

Telemarketing can still be a successful offline marketing tool when used with regard to the receivers' wishes, despite its reputation for being obtrusive when done improperly. Businesses can nurture leads, carry out market research, and even create revenue by employing telemarketing to forge sincere connections. Training telemarketers to be polite, informed, and sympathetic to the needs and interests of the prospects they deal with is the key to success.

TRADE SHOWS

Trade exhibitions offer businesses a distinctive and dynamic venue to present their goods or services to a highly focused audience. These gatherings bring together experts in the field, potential customers, and business partners, cultivating an environment that is conducive to networking and lead creation. Businesses must design visually appealing booths, give engaging demonstrations, and offer compelling marketing materials to get the most out of attending trade shows. Participating in pre-show and post-show promotional activities can also aid in generating buzz and maintaining interest long after the event has ended.

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EVENTS

A great strategy to raise brand recognition and strengthen customer connections is to host or take part in events that are catered to the wants and needs of the target market. Workshops, seminars, product launch parties, and charity fundraisers are all examples of events. Offering participants value, whether through instructional materials, entertainment, or special deals, is the key to effective event marketing. Businesses may boost brand loyalty and drive referrals by creating satisfying experiences and connections.

In conclusion, offline marketing channels shouldn’t be overlooked, even though internet marketing channels unquestionably play a significant part in today’s digital landscape. Retail locations, direct mail, telemarketing, trade exhibits, and events provide businesses with distinctive chances to touch with customers personally and leave a lasting impression that digital encounters frequently find difficult to match. Building stronger brand awareness, fostering deeper customer relationships, and eventually promoting growth and success in their respective industries may all be achieved by businesses by using these offline marketing channels in a comprehensive marketing strategy.

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ONLINE MARKETING CHANNELS

Online marketing channels are now a crucial component of effective marketing strategies in the digital age. Businesses have a special chance to contact their target audience through various internet channels because billions of people spend a lot of time online. In this chapter, we'll look at a number of important types of online advertising, such as affiliate marketing, influencer marketing, social media marketing, search engine optimization, pay-per-click advertising, and content marketing. Let's delve in and see how companies may use these channels to communicate with their customers and increase their online presence.

EMAIL MARKETING

One of the most direct and efficient ways to interact with customers is still through email marketing. Businesses can deliver customized communications to their inboxes by compiling a subscriber list of those who are interested in their products or services. Emails that are personalized and well-written may nurture leads, advertise goods or services, and increase conversions. Successful email marketing strategies emphasize the provision of useful content, the use of automation to send messages at the right time, and mobile device optimization to reach people on the go.

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SOCIAL MEDIA MARKETING

The way individuals connect, share, and find new content has been completely revolutionized by social media platforms. Businesses can use these channels to interact more personally with their target market. Businesses may increase brand recognition, encourage consumer loyalty, and increase website traffic by producing and disseminating appealing content. Each social media network has distinct user demographics and characteristics that enable businesses to target their tactics at particular groups. Understanding your target audience, blogging often, and interacting with your followers to foster a feeling of community are all crucial.

CONTENT MARKETING

Content marketing focuses on creating and distributing content with the intention of attracting and retaining a specific demographic. Businesses can position themselves as sector authorities and gain the audience's trust by publishing blog posts, articles, videos, infographics, and other content. Understanding the problems faced by the target audience, offering answers, and delivering material in diverse formats to suit different tastes are the key components of effective content marketing. Businesses can increase their online visibility and organic traffic by optimizing their content for search engines.

SEARCH ENGINE OPTIMIZATION (SEO)

Businesses can significantly increase their visibility in search engine results pages (SERPs) with the aid of SEO. Businesses can rank higher in pertinent search queries, garnering organic visitors, by optimizing their website's structure, content, and technical components. Researching keywords, optimizing web pages on-page, constructing links, and providing a great user experience are all components of effective SEO techniques. In order to maintain an advantage in the market, it is crucial to keep up with the ever-changing algorithms and practises of search engines.

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PAY-PER-CLICK (PPC) ADVERTISING

When using pay-per-click (PPC) advertising, businesses only need to pay for the clicks that are made on their advertisements when they show on search engine results pages (SERPs) and other websites. Strong targeting capabilities are available to target particular demographics, interests, and geographic areas on platforms like Google Ads and social media advertising networks. Thorough keyword research, attractive ad copy, optimized landing sites, continual monitoring, and optimization are all essential components of effective PPC campaigns.

AFFILIATE MARKETING

A performance-based marketing tactic known as affiliate marketing enables companies to collaborate with affiliates who market their goods or services. Each time an affiliate generates a sale or new lead, they receive a commission. As affiliates use their own online platforms to advertise products, such as websites, blogs, or social media profiles, this marketing channel increases its reach. Businesses gain from greater brand recognition, a larger customer base, and more sales without having to pay upfront marketing expenses.

INFLUENCER MARKETING

Working with important people who have a sizable online following and authority in a certain field is a key component of influencer marketing. Businesses can access influencers' engaged audiences and use their influence to market goods and services by collaborating with them. Various types of influencer marketing efforts, such as sponsored

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EMERGING MARKETING CHANNELS

Emerging channels provide organizations with exciting new options to interact with their target audience in creative ways in the always-changing world of marketing. New marketing channels that make use of mobile devices, virtual reality (VR), augmented reality (AR), and voice search have arisen as technology progresses. We will investigate how companies may use these cutting-edge marketing channels, such as voice search optimization, VR/AR marketing, and mobile marketing, to remain ahead of the curve and interact with their customers in fresh and useful ways in this chapter.

MOBILE MARKETING

Mobile marketing is rapidly becoming an essential method for connecting with customers as more and more people access the internet through their smartphones and other mobile devices. Mobile marketing encompasses a wide range of strategies, such as text message marketing, in-app adverts, and mobile-friendly websites and applications. Businesses can provide seamless user experiences, grab users' attention on the go, and use location-based targeting to send pertinent and timely offers by optimizing their online presence for mobile devices. Businesses may interact with their customers through mobile marketing whenever and whenever they choose, giving them individualized experiences that are tailored to their particular requirements.

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VIRTUAL REALITY/AUGMENTED REALITY MARKETING

Recent advancements in virtual reality (VR) and augmented reality (AR) technologies have created new opportunities for immersive marketing experiences. While AR superimposes digital features on the actual world, VR transfers users to virtual realms. These technologies give companies a chance to design dynamic, captivating experiences for their audience. Product demos, virtual showrooms, interactive storytelling, and even gamification may all be done using VR/AR marketing. Businesses can build memorable brand experiences that have a long-lasting effect on their customers by utilizing VR and AR.

VOICE SEARCH OPTIMIZATION

Voice search has become incredibly popular as a result of the emergence of voice assistants like Siri, Alexa, and Google Assistant. If you want your digital content to rank higher in voice search results, you'll need to optimize it for that format. To account for the distinctive features of voice searches, such as longer, conversational questions, businesses must modify their SEO methods. Successful voice search optimization includes a number of critical strategies, including writing website text in natural language, writing material for highlighted snippets, and answering frequently asked queries succinctly and directly. Businesses may increase their exposure and serve the increasing number of people who prefer voice-based interactions by integrating voice search.

It's crucial to keep a few important factors in mind when organizations investigate these new marketing platforms. In order to use these channels to their full potential, it is first important to keep up with the current trends and technologies. Second, in order to adjust marketing techniques, it is crucial to comprehend the target audience and their preferences. Finally, businesses may improve their strategy and optimize results by testing, monitoring, and analyzing the performance of campaigns in these new channels.

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In conclusion, new marketing avenues like voice search optimization, VR/AR marketing, and mobile marketing provide organizations with exciting chances to interact with their customers in fresh, immersive ways. Businesses may remain ahead of the competition, provide distinctive brand experiences, and strengthen their relationships with customers by utilizing these channels. Businesses must remain flexible and agile as technology develops in order to be prepared to adopt the subsequent wave of developing marketing channels that will determine the success of future customer interaction and brand building.

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KEY PERFORMANCE INDICATORS (KPIS) FOR CHANNEL PERFORMANCE

Key performance indicators (KPIs) must be in place to gauge the performance and impact of marketing channels when determining their efficacy. Businesses can learn more about the effectiveness of their channels and make data-driven decisions to improve their marketing strategy by measuring certain KPIs. In this chapter, we'll go over some of the most important metrics for measuring your channel's performance, such as sales revenue, customer lifetime value (CLV), conversion rate, customer retention rate, Net Promoter Score (NPS), social media engagement, web traffic sources, email open and click-through rates, and return on investment (ROI). Let's examine each of these KPIs and their corresponding algorithms to comprehend how they affect determining channel performance.

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SALES REVENUE

A core KPI, sales revenue, measures the overall amount of revenue produced through a particular marketing channel.

$$\text{Sales Revenue} = \text{Average Sale Value} * \text{Number of Sales}$$

The average purchase value or average revenue per customer is multiplied by the total number of units sold or the total number of customers to determine sales revenue.

Businesses can determine the direct effect of a channel on revenue generation and analyze its profitability by tracking sales revenue.

CUSTOMER ACQUISITION COST (CAC)

Customer Acquisition Cost (CAC) is a metric used to describe the typical expense associated with acquiring a new customer through a certain marketing channel.

$$\text{Customer Acquisition Cost (CAC)} = \frac{\text{Total Cost of Sales and Marketing}}{\text{Number of New Customers Acquired}}$$

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Divide the overall marketing and sales costs related to acquiring customers through a channel by the number of customers obtained to arrive at CAC.

Businesses can assess the success and cost-effectiveness of their marketing channels for customer acquisition by tracking CAC. Businesses may assess the profitability of customer acquisition and make educated judgments about resource allocation to optimize marketing tactics by comparing CAC to CLV.

Businesses can use CAC as a KPI to gain important insights into the financial effect of their marketing channels and use that information to inform their channel and budget allocation decisions.

CLV: CUSTOMER LIFETIME VALUE

Customer Lifetime Value (CLV) is a statistic that gauges the entire value a customer is anticipated to produce throughout the course of their relationship.

$$CLV = (\text{Average Purchase Value} * \text{Purchase Frequency}) * \text{Customer Lifetime}$$

To determine CLV, multiply the average purchase value by the typical frequency of purchases and then multiply that number by the typical customer lifetime.

Decisions about customer acquisition and retention strategies are guided by CLV, which aids firms in understanding the long-term value of customers gained through a particular channel.

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CONVERSION RATE

The conversion rate measures the percentage of visitors or leads who proceed to become paying customers.

$$\text{Conversion Rate (\%)} = \left(\frac{\text{Number of Conversions}}{\text{Total Number of Visitors}} \right) * 100$$

To calculate the conversion rate, divide the total number of conversions by the total number of leads or visitors, then multiply the result by 100.

Monitoring the conversion rate is pivotal in identifying areas for improvement and provides insights into a channel's efficacy in stimulating customer actions.

CUSTOMER RETENTION RATE

The customer retention rate is a valuable metric that quantifies the proportion of customers who remain engaged over a specified period.

$$\text{Customer Retention Rate (\%)} = \left[\frac{(\text{Number of customers at the end of the period} - \text{Number of new customers acquired during the period})}{\text{Number of customers at the start of the period}} \right] * 100$$

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To calculate the customer retention rate, begin by subtracting the number of new customers acquired during the period from the total number of customers at the end of the period. Then, divide this result by the total number of customers at the start of the period. Multiply the outcome by 100 to express the customer retention rate as a percentage.

Regularly tracking the customer retention rate provides businesses with insights into a channel's effectiveness at fostering customer loyalty, thereby enabling the identification of strategies for improving customer retention.

NPS (NET PROMOTER SCORE)

When customers are asked whether they would suggest a business, good, or service to others, the Net Promoter Score (NPS) is calculated. Customers are classified as promoters, passives, or detractors based on their responses to a rating scale from 0 to 10.



Subtract the percentage of critics from the percentage of promoters to arrive at NPS.

NPS offers information on customer sentiment and can assist businesses in determining how a channel affects brand loyalty.

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SOCIAL MEDIA ENGAGEMENT

The amount of contact and engagement people have with a brand's social media material is measured by social media engagement. Metrics like likes, comments, shares, and mentions show how engaged the audience is. Monitoring social media engagement enables businesses to determine how well their social media platforms are doing at promoting their brands, forging relationships with customers, and creating buzz.

WEB TRAFFIC SOURCES

Web traffic sources assist companies in determining the avenues that bring customers to their websites. Businesses can assess the efficiency of each channel in bringing website visitors by analyzing metrics, including organic traffic, referral traffic, direct traffic, and paid traffic. To increase online traffic and conversions, firms can use this information to allocate resources and improve their marketing tactics.

EMAIL CLICK-THROUGH AND OPEN RATES

An email's open rate indicates how many people really saw the message, while the click-through rate indicates how many people actually interacted with the message by clicking on a link or responding to a call to action.

The open rate is calculated as the number of emails viewed divided by the total number of emails sent multiplied by 100. Divide the number of clicks by the total number of emails delivered, then multiply the result by 100 to get the click-through rate.

Businesses may evaluate the success of their email marketing efforts and make content, subject lines, and call-to-action elements more engaging and conversion-friendly by tracking email open and click-through rates.

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ROI: RETURN ON INVESTMENT

By comparing the net profit made to the cost of investment, return on investment (ROI) analyses the viability of a marketing channel.

$$\text{Return on Investment (ROI)} = \left[\frac{(\text{Net Profit} - \text{Cost of Investment})}{\text{Cost of Investment}}\right] * 100\%$$

Divide the result by the cost of investment, then multiply the result by 100 to determine the return on investment (ROI).

ROI enables organizations to evaluate a channel's financial impact and determine how well it produces a profit. Businesses can obtain important insights into the efficiency of their marketing channels, make data-driven choices, and spend resources effectively by tracking these KPIs for channel success.

It's crucial to keep in mind that the choice of pertinent KPIs may vary depending on corporate objectives, the sector, and certain marketing tactics.

These KPIs can help firms optimize their channels, boost marketing effectiveness, and accomplish their overarching goals through routine monitoring and analysis.

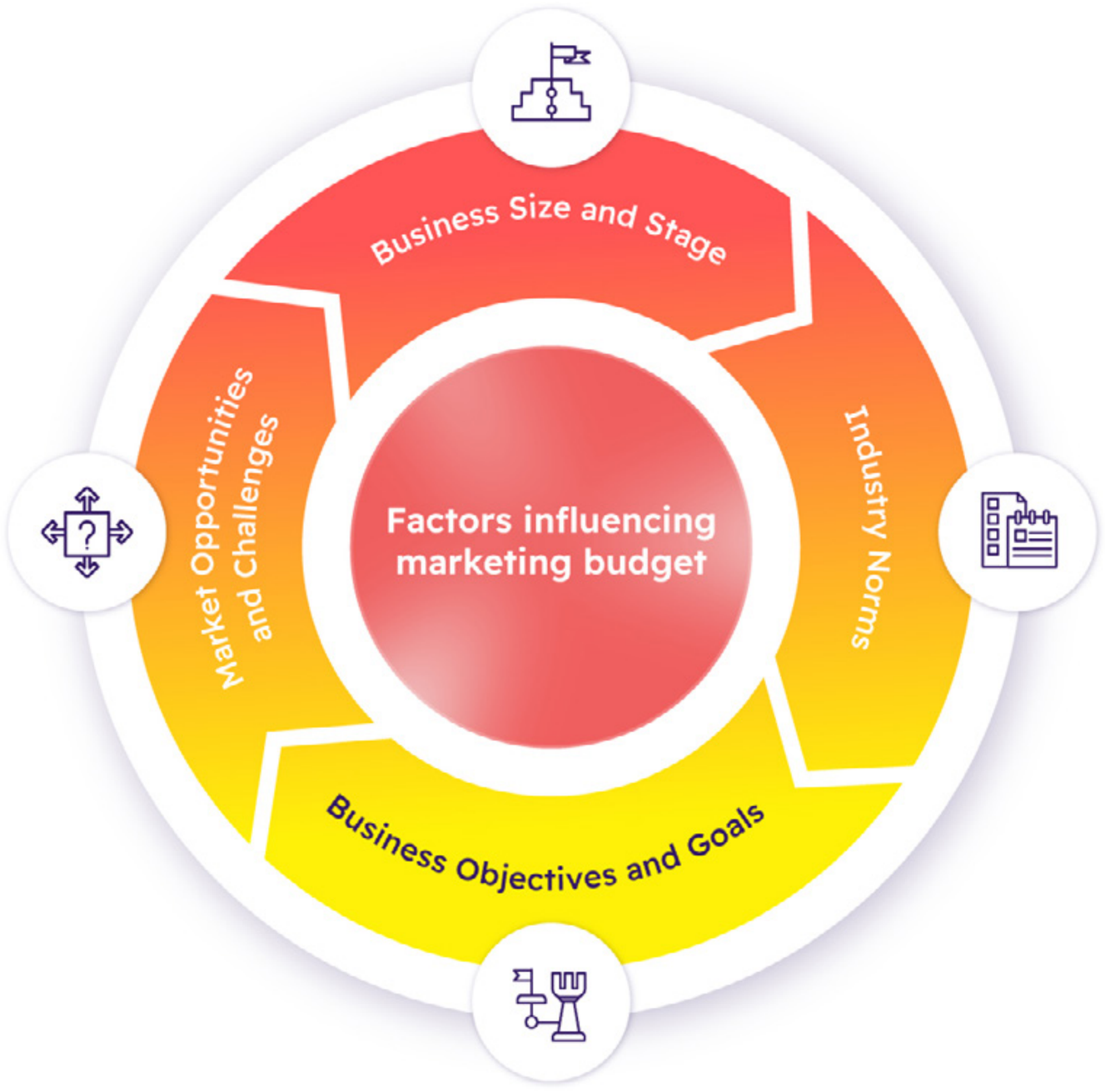
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MARKETING BUDGETING

For organizations to use resources strategically and accomplish their marketing goals, they must have a well-planned and managed marketing budget. In this chapter, we'll examine the numerous facets of marketing budgets, including the variables that affect them, how to build one up, and how to allocate it. Businesses may maximize their return on investment by understanding these components and making informed decisions about their marketing expenditures.

FACTORS INFLUENCING MARKETING BUDGET

A marketing budget's size and allocation are influenced by a number of variables. Businesses must comprehend these elements in order to create a budget that fits their particular needs.



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Here are some important things to think about:

A. BUSINESS SIZE AND STAGE

The marketing budget is heavily influenced by the size and stage of the business. Startups and small firms may devote a larger portion of their income to marketing in order to increase customer acquisition and brand recognition. Established companies may allocate a smaller portion, but they concentrate more on market expansion and customer retention.

B. INDUSTRY NORMS

Industry standards and norms offer important information about average firm marketing expenditures. Businesses can better grasp the competitive environment and allocate budgetary resources by investigating industry-specific data.

C. BUSINESS OBJECTIVES AND GOALS

The marketing budget is directly impacted by business goals and objectives. A company seeking quick growth or market expansion might need to spend more on marketing than a company aiming to hold onto its current market share.

D. MARKET OPPORTUNITIES AND CHALLENGES

The marketing budget may be impacted by market opportunities or challenges. It might be necessary to make additional investments to take advantage of new market opportunities, and it might be wise to reallocate your budget in order to strategically manage market problems.

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SETTING A MARKETING BUDGET

Setting a marketing budget can be done in a number of ways. Businesses should select a strategy that fits their objectives and situation. Here are a few typical approaches:

A. PERCENTAGE OF SALES METHOD

The fixed percentage of anticipated or previous sales revenue is allotted to the marketing budget using the percentage of sales technique. This approach offers consistency and permits modifications based on variations in revenue.

B. COMPETITIVE PARITY METHOD

The competitive parity approach entails basing the marketing budget on the industry standard or competitors' spending plans. This approach guarantees that a company maintains its competitiveness within its industry, but it can necessitate more investigation and benchmarking.

C. OBJECTIVE AND TASK METHOD

The objective-and-task approach entails allocating the marketing budget in accordance with the tasks that must be completed to fulfill a set of marketing objectives. Based on the expected cost of the necessary marketing activities, a budget is given to each target.

D. ZERO-BASED BUDGETING METHOD

Businesses must begin the budgeting process anew using the zero-based budgeting strategy, justifying every spending. This approach promotes a thorough assessment of marketing initiatives and prioritization according to their expected outcomes.

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ALLOCATING THE MARKETING BUDGET

Businesses must decide how to allocate the marketing budget effectively once it has been decided. Here are some typical strategies to take into account:

A. THROUGH MARKETING CHANNELS

The process of allocating the marketing budget by channels entails dividing up the budget according to the predicted efficacy and reach of each marketing channel. This makes sure that resources are distributed equally across all available channels.

B. THROUGH MARKETING ACTIVITY

The process of allocating the marketing budget by activity entails classifying marketing initiatives (such as social media, content production, events, and advertising) and allocating financial resources to each category in accordance with their significance and projected effects.

C. BY PRODUCT OR SERVICE LINE

Setting aside specific amounts of the marketing budget for the promotion and marketing of particular goods and services is known as allocating the budget by product or service line. This enables organizations to concentrate their efforts on boosting sales for each product or service.

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D. BY GEOGRAPHIC MARKET

When allocating the marketing budget by region for enterprises with numerous geographic markets, different budgetary amounts are given to each market based on its size, potential for growth, and level of competition.

E. BY CUSTOMER SEGMENT

In order to target various consumer groups based on demographics, behaviors, or preferences, the marketing budget must be allocated by customer segment. With this strategy, organizations can better target certain customer segments with their marketing initiatives while increasing overall engagement and conversion rates.

Businesses can develop a well-rounded marketing budget that maximizes the impact of their marketing efforts across numerous channels, activities, products, services, geographic regions, and customer segments by combining these allocation strategies.

It is significant to remember that allocating funds from the budget is a continuous process rather than a single choice. The marketing budget is kept flexible and efficient by routinely assessing the success of marketing campaigns and modifying the budget allocation based on current data and insights.

Overall, careful consideration of a number of aspects, such as business size and stage, industry norms, business goals and objectives, market possibilities and obstacles, is required when designing and maintaining a marketing budget. The particular circumstances and goals of the organization will determine the best approach for setting the budget, whether it be the percentage of sales method, competitive parity method, objective and task method, or zero-based budgeting method.

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Businesses can strategically allocate resources and optimize their marketing efforts for the greatest outcomes by allocating the marketing budget to marketing channels, marketing activities, product or service lines, geographic markets, and customer segments.

Businesses may make informed decisions, maximize the impact of their marketing campaigns, and accomplish their overarching company goals by implementing a thorough and data-driven approach to budgeting. The marketing budget is kept current and in line with the ever-changing marketing environment by routinely assessing and modifying it based on performance measures. A properly managed marketing budget is an important factor in marketing success and supports a company's long-term expansion and success in a cutthroat industry.

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INTERNATIONAL MARKET

Businesses have great chances to reach new customers, tap into a variety of markets, and accelerate growth by expanding into the global market. However, success in the international sphere necessitates a thorough comprehension of the subtleties and complexity of international marketplaces. This chapter will examine the different aspects—including cultural, economic, legal, and political considerations—that companies must take into account when entering the global market. We'll also look at the current argument over localization vs. standardization and what that means for success globally.

CULTURAL FACTORS

International business initiatives can succeed or fail in large part due to cultural differences. Every nation has its own distinct social norms, conventions, and traditions that have an impact on how people behave in public and do business. In order to customize marketing messages, product offerings, and even business agreements to resonate with the target audience in each region, it is essential to understand cultural differences. Businesses must modify their strategies in order to respect cultural sensibilities and preferences while also making sure that their brand remains authentic and relevant across a wide range of cultural contexts.

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ECONOMIC FACTORS

The introduction into and growth of overseas markets can be significantly impacted by economic variables. Pricing tactics, profit margins, and overall financial success may be impacted by exchange rates, inflation, and the state of the economy in the target market.

Additionally, variations in consumer spending habits and purchasing power might affect market demand and product placement. Making educated judgments and maximizing possibilities in global markets require detailed market research to evaluate the economic environment and customer behavior.

LEGAL AND POLITICAL FACTORS

For an international company initiative to be successful, navigating the legal and political environment of foreign nations is essential. Businesses must abide by the specific laws, rules, and trade policies that apply to each nation.

Protection of intellectual property, requirements for product safety, and tax laws are all legal factors. Additionally, the political environment can affect market stability, trade ties, and corporate operations. In order to reduce risks and ensure legal compliance, it is essential to work with local legal specialists and stay current on political and legislative changes.

LOCALIZATION VERSUS STANDARDISATION

Selecting between standardization and localization techniques is one of the important considerations that organizations must make while operating in the global market. Standardization is the practice of providing the same product or service to several markets while optimizing volume and cost. To fit the unique demands and tastes of each market, localization requires modifying products, services, and marketing plans.

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Maintaining a healthy equilibrium between standardization and localization is essential. While standardization can improve brand consistency and facilitate processes, localization enables businesses to customize their goods to meet the needs of a variety of customers and cultural situations.

In conclusion, the potential for growth and expansion when entering the foreign market is enormous. But to be successful in international markets, one must have a thorough grasp of the political, legal, economic, and cultural forces that influence customer behavior and business practices. Businesses can better navigate the global landscape by adjusting to cultural nuances, taking into account economic trends, abiding by local regulations, and being mindful of political influences.

Additionally, market penetration and long-term success will be impacted by the strategic option made between standardization and localization. Businesses can succeed in the global market and create solid, long-lasting connections with international customers by taking a well-informed approach and making a commitment to comprehending and respecting other markets.

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MARKET ENTRY STRATEGIES

Businesses must carefully analyze their market entry strategy when entering new markets. These tactics decide how businesses will enter overseas markets, reach customers, and build a presence there. Various market entry tactics, such as direct exporting, indirect exporting, licensing, franchising, joint ventures, strategic alliances, and foreign direct investment (FDI), will be discussed in this chapter.

Each technique has its own advantages and factors to take into account, enabling firms to customize their strategy to meet their individual needs and objectives.

DIRECT EXPORTING

Selling goods or services directly to customers in international markets is known as direct exporting. Establishing distribution channels, managing logistics, and maintaining customer connections are all required for this strategy.

Businesses can maintain direct ties with their customers and keep a larger portion of their earnings thanks to direct exporting, which provides them with total control over their overseas operations. However, it also necessitates large expenditures on marketing initiatives, infrastructure, and market research.

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INDIRECT EXPORTING

Indirect exporting is collaborating with middlemen like distributors, agents, or trade firms to promote goods or services abroad. On behalf of the exporting company, these middlemen manage the distribution, marketing, and sales procedures.

Particularly for companies with limited resources or market knowledge, indirect exporting can be a cost-efficient and less hazardous entry approach. But it can mean having less control over marketing and customer interactions.

LICENSING

By issuing licenses to foreign companies to create and sell their goods or utilize their intellectual property in exchange for royalties, corporations can use licensing as a market entry strategy.

By using this tactic, companies can benefit from the licensee's local expertise and resources while lowering manufacturing and distribution-related risks and expenses. Expanding a brand's reach and entering new markets fast can both be accomplished through licensing. However, companies need to maintain and safeguard their intellectual property rights with care.

FRANCHISING

Giving a franchisee the authority to run a company in a foreign market using a recognized brand and business model is known as franchising. As long as the necessary finance and operational support are provided by the franchisees, franchising enables firms to grow quickly with little initial investment.

This tactic benefits from knowledge of the local market and lowers the risks connected with direct operations. However, guaranteeing quality control and upholding brand consistency across numerous franchise locations can be difficult.

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JOINT VENTURES

In a joint venture, you partner with a local business in the target market to create a unique business that you both jointly own and run. By sharing risks and expenses with the local partner, this method enables enterprises to leverage local knowledge, distribution networks, and resources.

By combining the qualities of both partners, joint ventures can provide businesses with a competitive edge and make it easier to enter new markets. However, in order for a collaboration to be successful, cultural differences, competing interests, and coordination issues must be properly controlled.

STRATEGIC PARTNERSHIPS

In order to accomplish goals that benefit both parties, strategic alliances entail developing partnerships or collaborations with other businesses, whether they be domestic or foreign. These relationships could be in the form of joint distribution channels, research and development alliances, or marketing partnerships.

Businesses can broaden their reach and take advantage of shared expertise thanks to the complementary resources, capabilities, and markets that strategic partnerships give them access to. However, efficient coordination and communication are needed to align strategic goals, uphold confidence, and control the alliance’s dynamics.

FDI: FOREIGN DIRECT INVESTMENT

By purchasing or constructing subsidiaries, branches, or manufacturing facilities, foreign direct investment entails establishing a physical presence in a foreign market. Businesses can build local supply chains, have direct control over their operations, and customize their goods and services to meet the demands of the market thanks to FDI.

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Long-term advantages of FDI include increasing market share, brand recognition, and access to local talent. However, it necessitates substantial financial resources, market research, legal observance, and knowledge of regional laws and commercial customs.

Every market entry strategy has unique benefits and considerations, and the choice of strategy is influenced by a number of variables, including market conditions, corporate objectives, the resources at hand, and risk tolerance. Before deciding on the best market entry approach, organizations must carefully consider these variables and do in-depth market research.

It is important to keep in mind that organizations occasionally combine market entry methods to take advantage of the advantages of several avenues. For instance, a business can use indirect exporting or licensing to test the market and achieve early momentum before establishing a joint venture or foreign direct investment to fortify its position and expand operations.

When assessing market entry methods, keep the following additional factors in mind:

Market Research: Before choosing a market entry strategy, in-depth market research is crucial. Businesses can make better judgments if they are aware of the demographics, tastes, cultural quirks, competitive landscape, and regulatory environment of their target markets.

Risk assessment: There are inherent risks associated with entering overseas markets, including political unpredictability, currency fluctuations, and cultural differences. To avoid potential hazards, it’s essential to assess the degree of risk involved with any market entry approach and create backup plans.

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Legal and Regulatory Compliance: For a successful market entry, it is essential to adhere to local laws, regulations, and business practices. Legal issues, such as those relating to intellectual property rights, licensing contracts, and international trade rules, must be carefully navigated by businesses.

Partner Selection: Picking the correct partner is crucial for strategies like joint ventures and strategic alliances. A more harmonic and effective partnership will result from aligning corporate goals, principles, and vision with the prospective partner.

Marketing and Adaptation: For products to be accepted in foreign markets, it is crucial to tailor marketing initiatives and product offerings to meet regional preferences and cultural conventions. Businesses should be ready to modify their plans as necessary to account for varying consumer wants and behaviors.

Human Resources and Talent: A solid local workforce with a thorough understanding of the market is essential for successfully implementing the selected market entry plan. Putting money into training and talent development guarantees a workforce with the skills to deal with local difficulties.

Long-term Commitment: Market entrance plans, especially those involving foreign direct investment (FDI) or joint ventures, frequently call for a long-term commitment. To build a long-lasting presence and foster consumer loyalty, businesses must be willing to commit time and money.

Monitoring and Evaluation: It is crucial to continuously monitor and analyze the success of the chosen market entry strategy in order to make the required adjustments in a timely manner and achieve optimum success. To monitor progress, key performance indicators (KPIs) tailored to each plan should be defined.

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Ultimately, a successful market entry strategy should be in line with the overall goals, capabilities, and risk tolerance of the company. Some companies may choose to enter the market gradually, beginning through indirect exporting or strategic alliances before thinking about more significant commitments like FDI or franchising. Others can decide to use many tactics at once to diversify their market exposure and investigate other chances.

Businesses must continue to be flexible and sensitive to shifting market conditions since market entry is a dynamic and constantly changing process. A well-considered market entry plan will position businesses for development, sustainability, and success in international markets as those markets continue to change.

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UNDERSTANDING CONSUMER BEHAVIOR

Consumer behavior is the study of people's decisions and actions in relation to the acquisition, use, and disposal of goods and services. The significance of consumer behavior, numerous forms of consumer behavior, and the various steps in the consumer decision-making process will all be covered in this chapter.

WHY IS CONSUMER BEHAVIOR IMPORTANT?

Understanding consumer behavior is essential for firms to create powerful marketing campaigns and establish enduring connections with their target market. Businesses can adjust their products, messages, and customer experiences to fit the wants and wishes of their customers by acquiring insights into the consumer's motivations, preferences, and decision-making processes. Customer satisfaction is enhanced, sales are up, and firms are ultimately successful in the long run thanks to consumer behavior analysis's assistance in predicting market trends, spotting opportunities, and overcoming obstacles.

DIFFERENT TYPES OF CONSUMER BEHAVIOR

A. IMPULSIVE BUYING BEHAVIOR

When consumers make unplanned and impulsive purchases, they are frequently motivated by present demands or emotional impulses. Through persuasive marketing strategies, eye-catching displays, time-limited deals, and impulse-buying triggers, businesses can influence impulsive purchasing.

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B. HABITUAL BUYING BEHAVIOR

The term “habitual buying behavior” refers to automatic, repetitive purchase patterns that are influenced by ingrained routines and habits. Customers frequently purchase the same goods or services without giving them any thought or attention due to brand loyalty. Businesses must maintain brand consistency and customer satisfaction if they want to keep customers who make recurring purchases.

C. VARIETY-SEEKING BUYING BEHAVIOR

Consumers who actively seek out fresh events, brands, or items to satiate their desire for novelty and excitement are said to engage in variety-seeking buying behavior. Businesses can attract consumers who are interested in the variety by providing new products, limited editions, or regular product updates.

D. COMPLEX BUYING BEHAVIOR

When consumers experience high levels of involvement and notable perceived distinctions between brands or items, complex purchase behavior results, before making a purchase, consumers conduct a thorough information search, comparison, and evaluation. Businesses must give customers comprehensive product information, professional advice, and tailored support to aid in their decision-making.

E. DISSONANCE-REDUCING BUYING BEHAVIOR

When customers suffer post-purchase uncertainty or cognitive dissonance, their purchasing behavior becomes less dissonant. By providing warranties, guarantees, and top-notch customer care, businesses can stop this behavior in its tracks and help customers feel more confident about their purchases.

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F. SOCIAL BUYING BEHAVIOR

Consumer purchase decisions that are impacted by social interactions, group dynamics, and cultural conventions are referred to as social buying behavior. Consumer choices are significantly influenced by peer judgments, social media influence, and word-of-mouth recommendations. By using influencer marketing, social proof tactics, and powerful online communities, businesses can take advantage of social buying behavior.

G. ETHICAL BUYING BEHAVIOR

When making purchases, customers that engage in ethical behavior take social and environmental concerns into account. When selecting companies or products, consumers place more importance on sustainability, fair trade, and ethical practices. Businesses may draw and keep ethical customers by exhibiting ethical principles, open supplier chains, and responsible business practices.

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THE PROCESS OF CONSUMER DECISION-MAKING

Consumers go through the following steps in the decision-making process before making a purchase:

A. PROBLEM RECOGNITION

When customers identify a need or want that is unmet or needs a solution, a problem is recognized. By finding and emphasizing consumer pain spots or by raising consumer knowledge of new items or trends, businesses can encourage problem recognition.

B. EVALUATION OF ALTERNATIVES

Consumers receive information, analyze options, compare pricing and features of various brands and goods, and gather information during this phase. Businesses can have an impact on the appraisal process by using persuasive marketing materials, endorsements, and points of differentiation.

C. PURCHASE DECISION

Choosing a certain company, item, or service and then carrying out the transaction are steps in the purchase decision stage. Price, availability, convenience, and previous experiences with the brand are all important factors that consumers consider when making a purchase decision.
By providing simple payment choices, smooth online and offline shopping experiences, and tailored recommendations, businesses can help customers make purchases.

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D. POST-PURCHASE BEHAVIOR

Consumers move into the post-buy behavior stage after making a purchase. Their happiness with the purchase and the overall experience is assessed at this point. Positive experiences can encourage repeat business, customer loyalty, and positive word-of-mouth. To avoid unfavorable reviews and significant brand damage, firms should respond quickly to customer complaints if they arise.

To build great brand experiences, organizations need to comprehend consumer needs, motivations, and preferences throughout the decision-making process. Businesses may successfully engage and influence customers at every stage of the decision-making process by matching their marketing initiatives with various consumer behaviors.

In a dynamic and intricate field, consumer behavior is influenced by many internal and external influences. Businesses can acquire a competitive edge, forge lasting relationships with customers, and encourage brand loyalty by monitoring consumer behavior and modifying marketing strategy accordingly. Additionally, continual market research and analysis of consumer behavior trends help companies keep ahead of shifting consumer expectations and efficiently serve them.

Businesses may remain ahead of shifting market demands and successfully address customers' changing wants by continuously monitoring and analyzing changes in consumer behavior. To do this, data analytics, market research, and customer feedback are used to uncover important information about consumer preferences, buying habits, and new trends.

The extensive usage of the internet and contemporary technologies has had a huge impact on consumer behavior. Consumers now have easy access to information thanks to online shopping, social media, and mobile devices, enabling them to study items, compare prices, read reviews, and make wise selections.

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Businesses can use online platforms and digital marketing to target particular consumer segments, develop individualized customer experiences, and communicate with customers in real-time. Businesses utilize a variety of tactics to interact with customers and foster brand loyalty, including social media marketing, influencer partnerships, and content development.

Businesses must modify their marketing strategies as consumers' awareness of sustainability, moral behavior, and social responsibility increases. Businesses can attract customers looking for ethical and responsible brands by using transparent supply chains, eco-friendly packaging, and support for social issues.

Consumers in the digital age need seamless, personalized experiences across various touchpoints. Customer satisfaction can be raised by implementing omnichannel marketing techniques that combine online and offline mediums like physical stores, websites, mobile applications, and social media.

Additionally, in order to comprehend consumer sentiment and successfully address their demands, firms should pay particular attention to social listening, sentiment analysis, and customer feedback. Businesses can promote positive brand perceptions and create enduring customer loyalty by actively engaging with customers and responding to their issues.
In summary, customer behavior has a significant impact on how successful organizations are. Businesses may establish targeted marketing strategies, compelling brand experiences, and long-lasting customer relationships by having a thorough understanding of the many forms of consumer behavior and the consumer decision-making process.

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Businesses can modify their strategy to stay relevant and competitive in today's dynamic business environment by keeping an eye on changing consumer preferences and market trends. Unlocking growth prospects and maintaining sustained success in the ever-changing market will require consumer-centric strategies that put customers' wants, values, and aspirations first. Businesses that embrace consumer behavior data as a strategic foundation will succeed in the quick-paced, customer-focused world of business.

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CONCLUSION

Congratulations! This is the final section of a very long book about marketing strategies. We started with the basics of marketing and progressed through developing a plan, managing products, choosing distribution channels, and assessing performance. Now that we've reached the end of the book, it's time to take stock of what we've learned and emphasise the fundamental ideas that will serve as your map to marketing success.

EMBRACING A CUSTOMER-CENTRIC APPROACH

Thorough familiarity with your target demographic is the bedrock of any effective marketing strategy. Putting the consumer first allows you to cater to their specific wants and needs through personalised products, communications, and experiences. Cultivating a customer-centric strategy requires extensive market research, the creation of buyer profiles, and ongoing interaction with your target audience. Keep in mind that thriving businesses are built on a foundation of satisfied and loyal customers.

MAKING EFFECTIVE MARKETING STRATEGIES

Marketing strategies act as road maps to direct your marketing activities towards reaching your business objectives. You can define your brand, fascinate your target market, and propel growth by combining market intelligence, competition analysis, and an in-depth grasp of your own capabilities. You need plans that can shift and adapt to the ever-evolving conditions of the market. To beat the competition and explore new possibilities, you need to constantly evaluate and refine your methods.

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MAKING USE OF THE MARKETING MIX

Careful coordination of these factors allows for the development of persuasive value propositions, the deployment of appropriate channels, and the provision of memorable experiences for customers. Integrating the various parts of the marketing mix requires careful consideration of consumer value and market dynamics. The right combination of elements will help you stand out from the competition, build consumer loyalty, and define your brand.

MANAGING PRODUCTS STRATEGICALLY

Successful product management is essential for any business. When you know what your target market wants and needs, you can create items that actually appeal to them. You may build consumer loyalty and set yourself apart from competitors by in-depth market research, innovative product development, and consistent upkeep. Your competitive edge will be strengthened, and client loyalty nurtured, if you place a premium on quality, usability, and value.

SELECTING APPROPRIATE MARKETING CHANNELS

Choosing the most appropriate marketing channels is vital for efficiently reaching and engaging your target audience. In today's digital age, it's important to have an omni-channel approach that includes both online and offline methods of communication. Consider aspects like reach, pricing, preferred channels of your target market, and the nature of your offerings when deciding which channels would work best for you. You can increase your brand's visibility and the effectiveness of your marketing efforts by taking advantage of and integrating multiple platforms.

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USING KEY PERFORMANCE INDICATORS TO EVALUATE PROGRESS

Knowledge of KPIs will enable you to monitor how well your marketing activities are doing to deliver the results you're after. You may monitor and assess the efficacy of your marketing initiatives, channel performance, customer acquisition, and retention with the use of these quantifiable measures. In order to make better-informed decisions and fine-tune your marketing tactics, it is important to regularly monitor and analyse key performance indicators (KPIs).

As we draw a close to this book on marketing tactics, keep in mind that the field of marketing is both an art and a science. To succeed, you must be able to think creatively and strategically and have an in-depth knowledge of your target audience and the market. Position your brand for long-term success and growth by adopting a customer-centric strategy, developing effective strategies, making use of the marketing mix, strategically managing your products, selecting the appropriate channels, and monitoring success using key performance indicators. Adopt a dynamic approach to marketing, be flexible to shifting market conditions, and always pursue innovation. Informed by what we've learned, we can.

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